The Ashen Rulebook

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Introduction

Pochfa sheshêp tarash nyôlwâ fêhêk
Echayâyti yi thâlâ mêzesh i khanjhi
I shayâmbô hêk i tawpanj ipish tarti
Rhôndwâ hêk talamâ yupak râykêk
Zangwô yi nhayâm.

They prayed their due as they beheld
The heavens opening in fire, on the valkyries' descent
The dead raised their rifles, held them against plate
Aloft they held their hammers, glory to await
At the end of days.

— The Song of the Deathless

Imagine a world shattered and broken, a shell of its former self. Imagine a world reduced to cinders in the fires of the final cataclysm, that yet held on. Imagine a world walked by those cursed not to die until they lay their regrets to rest. This is the world of Ashen.

The cataclysm that ended the old world left wounds in the fabric of creation itself. From these wounds seeps the Fog — the raw power of creation, unbound and without the divine reason that once shaped it. It blankets most of the world, spawning monsters, warping those who dwell in it, and saturating the land with ambient magical energy so intense it can power entire cities. Only in scattered Clears, places where the Fog has receded or been driven back, can mortals live in relative safety.

In Ashen, you play an **Immortal**, an undying warrior, veteran of the Last War. Your curse is two-fold: you remember little of your mortal life, and you cannot die until you accomplish your purpose. It is only in the dangerous and Fog-drowned wilderness that you might find release.

Playing the Game

Ashen is a role-playing game in which the players take on the role of immortal heroes who form a group (the Party) to go on dangerous adventures in an unforgiving world. Another player, the Game Master (GM) takes on a special role: to present the other players with the scenario they find themselves in and adjudicate the results of their actions. The players, in the role of their characters, take actions in the game world and drive the plot.

Most actions do not require any special rules to resolve. Many actions succeed automatically, or fail automatically, following common sense. In some cases, an action that is particularly difficult to accomplish but not impossible, or where the precise degree of success or failure can make a material difference, must be adjudicated by more detailed and impartial means. Like most other RPGs, Ashen here makes recourse to die rolls.

Die rolls in the Ashen system are made using rolls of multiple dice of varying sides; Ashen makes use of the **d4**, **d6**, **d8**, **d10** and **d12**. Most of these dice are used to generate random numbers when the game requires it, such as when rolling for damage in combat.

When a die roll is required to do so, the rules specify a number of dice plus the type of die to be rolled (usually abbreviated as *XdY*, i.e. X Y-sided dice; where the second number is left off, six-sided dice are always meant). These dice are then rolled and the numbers on their faces added up to produce a final result.

The Core Mechanic

In any situation where the outcome is in doubt, Ashen uses die rolls to decide about the success or failure of an action. Such die rolls are referred to as "checks". For example, a character trying to open an unlocked door would not need to roll any dice – they succeed automatically. If the door is bolted shut and secured with a mag-lock, however, any character attempting to breach it would need to make a check.

Making a Check

Checks are made when a character attempts a particularly difficult action, drawing on their innate abilities and training to surmount the difficulty. When called upon to make a check, you normally roll against a particular skill or characteristic. You roll as many six-sided dice as your character's rating in that skill or characteristic.

When you roll d6 in this way, they are instead used in a slightly different way from other situations in the game when dice rolls are required. Instead of adding up all the pips, you check the number rolled on every die. If the result is 4 or higher, the die is counted as a success. If the result is 6, it counts as two successes. If the result is 1, the die counts as a negative success. To refer to d6 used in this way, the rules use the term "Ashen dice".

Checks always have a difficulty, which the GM may or may not tell you in advance. If the total number of successes is greater than or equal to the difficulty number of the roll, the check is considered successful and your character accomplishes his or her goal. If not, you suffer the consequences of failure.

Bonuses and Penalties

Many abilities, items and circumstances grant a bonus or a penalty to a check. These bonuses and penalties are expressed as numbers of Ashen dice, or ±Xd for short. As an example, a catalyst might grant you a +2d bonus to cast spells of a certain type; firing a gun at very long ranges might give you a −2d penalty to the shot.

To apply the bonus or penalty, modify the size of your pool accordingly. For example, if your Marksmanship characteristic is 6, and you are firing your weapon at three increments of range, you would roll (6d base - 2d penalty) = 4d to make the shot. If, conversely, you were firing at point blank and your character had the *Weapon Focus* advance, granting them +2d to the attack, you would roll 8d.

Bonuses and penalties both stack and cumulate with each other. To expand the previous example, your character might have the *Weapon Focus* advance and take a *Precision Shot*, both granting a +2d bonus, for a total of +4d; however, your target might be heavily concealed (-3d penalty) and at three increments of range (-2d penalty); the total comes out to (2+2-3-2) = −1d penalty on the shot.

If, after applying all bonuses and penalties, your dice pool is reduced to zero dice, you fail the check automatically. This applies especially if additional penalties are inflicted after you have already declared your action.

Automatic Successes and Failures

In rare cases, checks can be modified by added automatic successes or failures. When they apply, add them directly to the result of the roll, without changing the size of your dice pool.

Example: *Alan's character, the Magician Myrddin, is in combat with a squad of ferocious Warboars. Heavily outnumbered and outgunned, the party has decided to flee. To buy time, Myrddin will attempt to cast the* Ice Storm *spell on the front row of Warboars.* Ice Storm *has a difficulty of 7 successes. Myrddin's Arcane characteristic is 8, and his bonuses to the roll grant him an additional 4, so he rolls 12 dice – they come up 5, 4, 3, 1, 2, 3, 6, 4, 6, 2, 5 and 3. The 6s grant two successes, but the 1 counts as a negative success: he has barely managed to beat the target number, but he has beaten it. The Warboars' war cries are drowned out by the howling wind...*

Rounding

Whenever a rule requires you to divide a number and the result is not a whole number, round down unless the rule specifically says otherwise.

Tracking Time

In Ashen, as in many other role-playing games, keeping track of how much time passes in the game world is essential. As the characters cannot—at least under ordinary circumstances—die, their success or failure in their quests often depends on how much time passes, and whether their enemies succeed in their goals before they can be thwarted.

However, as characters engage in various activities to fulfill their goals, the time necessary for certain milestones can vary wildly. Outside of the predictable rhythm of quiet time—when measuring time in hours and days is more than adequate—action in more hectic phases of the game can take wildly differing amounts of time. Racing to fix an airship drive might still take days, a harrowing negotiation with a crime boss might take hours, but a fight to the death mere seconds. As events in such periods can follow each other in quick succession, Ashen adopts a more abstract system of tracking time.

Game Time

Play in Ashen is structured, at the top level, into *Acts* and *Intermissions*. As the name implies, acts are where the action happens, and intermissions are the times between acts. An Act is itself divided into *Scenes*.

Acts

An act is a meaningful story unit—a period during which the characters further their goals and develop the plot. An act could be a raid on an enemy fortress, a harrowing trek across a hostile landscape, or preparing and hosting a diplomatic gathering with the leaders of other factions.

During an act, the characters' full attention is required. They must rely on the resources they've already gathered and the skills they've already learned.

Scenes

Acts are divided into *Scenes*. A scene represents a discrete event in the act. In general, a scene plays out in a single location and deals with a single issue. The archetypal example of a scene is combat encounter, but other types of plot events can also constitute a scene—a ride over a collapsing bridge, haggling with a shady merchant, or exploring a room in a ruined castle.

There are thus almost no hard and fast rules as to what constitutes a scene, with one exception—a combat encounter is always its own scene. In game terms, transitioning from one scene to the next has two effects: powers and abilities that can be used once per scene refresh, and the game can switch from *open time* to *structured time* or vice-versa.

Open Time and Structured Time

Most scenes in Ashen operate on open time—characters declare their actions in any order, and they take as long as they need to. The time tracking resolution does not usually drop below the level of minutes. However, for certain scenes, most notably combat encounters, because the action being described usually happens over the course of just a few seconds, keeping even more fine-grained track of time is necessary. These scenes operate on *structured time*.

Structured Time

A scene using structured time is divided into **rounds**, fuzzy units of time representing a few seconds—enough for every participant to take their turn acting. The order of turns within the round is determined by each participant's initiative. During their turn, under normal circumstances a character can take several actions, given by the amount of action points they have.

Initiative

In the heat of the moment, fractions of seconds can decide between life and untimely death. To model this, Ashen uses **initiative**.

Every round is divided into 100 initiative ticks. The round begins at tick 99, and proceeds by every participant taking a turn at their initiative tick, with higher initiatives going first. When the count reaches initiative 0, the round ends and a new round begins at tick 99.

To decide your initiative, you must roll it when you enter into combat. To roll initiative, roll as many D6 as your character's Initiative rating, and add up all the pips. This number is your initiative and determines your place in the initiative order.

Extreme Initiative

If a participant scores an initiative X greater than 99, their initiative "rolls over": X - 100 becomes their initiative count for all subsequent rounds. In combat, this grants special benefits related to surprise (see *Surprise* in the Combat chapter).

Actions and Action Points

In structured time, everytime you wish to do something, you must take an action to do it. Actions consume **Action Points (AP)**; every creature has a set number of AP per turn, usually 4 of them. On every creature's turn, that creature can take actions by spending action points; when a creature is out of action points, it can no longer take additional actions and must end its turn. On the

start of its turn, a creature recovers all its spent action points. Unspent ones are lost—they do not carry over between turns.

Intermissions

When an act ends, the game enters an intermission. Intermissions are essentially downtime—during an intermission, every character's Essence, Health and Focus refresh, and the characters have the opportunity to spend XP, allocate skill points, and purchase new equipment.

Characters

Characters are the lifeblood of Ashen. They are the roles the players take on when they play the game. Each character is unique: they may belong to one of several different races, have their own history (reflected in their Background) and be trained in several different skills and styles of combat.

The following sections present an overview of character creation as well as an introduction to some of the most important features of player characters in game terms. Character options are listed later in dedicated chapters.

Creating a Character

To get started playing Ashen, you must create your player character. As a first step, think about the general concept of your character: do you wish to play a sly rogue, a bookish scholar, or maybe a battle-hardened veteran?

Once you have made up your mind on what kind of character you wish to play, you can use the following sequence of steps to convert your concept into a fully-fledged Ashen character:

1. Pick a Race

The first step is to pick your character's race. Your character's race indicates a lot about their history and origin. It also sets your basic physical traits and grants you access to race-specific powers – choose wisely!

2. Determine Attributes

When you have picked your race, pick three of your attributes (see *Attributes and Characteristics*) to start at 2. The rest start at 1.

3. Allocate Skill Points

Every character begins with **10 skill points (SP)** to spend on their skills. You can use SP to learn trained skills (1 SP each) and improve any skill's rank. See the *Skills* chapter for the full cost table.

4. Buy Advances

Every character starts with some number of experience points (1000 at the beginning of the game) representing their previous combat experience and training. You can spend these points to improve your stats and learn combat powers.

5. Buy Equipment

Each character begins the game with ƒ 500 that can be used to buy gear and items for your character. Consult the *Equipment Tables* section for prices.

6. Finishing Details

Once you have completed all the above steps, you can complete your character sheet by calculating your character's statistics, which all depend on the choices made in previous sections.

Basic Rules and Common Terms

Many of the following rules make reference to some common concepts that bear explanation.

Character Statistics

Every character is largely defined in game terms by several sets of numbers. Fundamentally, a character is said to have **Attributes**, **Characteristics**, **Skills** and **Derived Statistics**.

Of these, **Attributes** are the most fundamental: they describe your character's most fundamental physical and mental characteristics. Attributes include things like a character's strength and intelligence.

Characteristics are a step down and measure a character's basic capability to move and act in certain ways. Characteristics are some of a character's most important numbers in combat. Characteristics describe traits such as a character's swiftness of foot or their skill in melee combat.

Skills are similar to characteristics, but describe a character's skill in more complex domains. They tend to be used outside of combat. Skills include a character's proficiency in map-reading, alchemy or disguising themselves.

Statistics, finally, is a catch-all term for numbers derived purely mechanically in some way from choices made in character creation and advancement. Such numbers include a character's hit points and armor rating.

Attributes, Characteristics and Skills all have **ranks**: a number from 1 to 6 representing a character's innate proficiency and training in that Attribute, Characteristic or Skill.

Characteristics and Skills also have ratings: a number that ranges between **3 and 18**. The ratings are composed of a character's ranks in that statistic, from 1 to 6, and their **attribute bonuses** to the statistic, equal to the character's ranks in those attributes. Each skill and characteristic gains bonuses from two attributes, listed below.

The values of derived statistics usually also have ratings, but there is no uniform way of calculating them.

Equipment States

Items a character owns can be in one of three states: **carried**, **equipped**, or **wielded**. Carried items are stowed in a pack or on a character's person but are not ready for immediate use. Equipped items are worn or readied on the body and available to be drawn quickly. Wielded items are actively held in hand and ready to use. For full definitions, see *Equipment States* in the Equipment chapter.

Advances and Powers

Apart from a character's numbers, the choices that most influence a character's development have to do with the advances and powers they learn over the course of the adventures.

Advances are improvements to your character's statistics and abilities purchased with the experience points you earn while adventuring. They can

grant you a variety of benefits from increasing your attributes and characteristics to improving your skill at certain actions.

Powers are extraordinary actions you can perform during combat. Powers can span the gamut from magical spells to heroic feats of skill at your weapons. They can be learnt in a variety of ways: some can be purchased as advances, others must be obtained through instruction from a master.

Legendary

Some items, powers, and advances are marked as **legendary**. Legendary things share two properties: they are *quest-bound* (they cannot simply be purchased or learned — they must be earned, recovered, or unlocked through a significant quest or story event), and they are *extraordinary* (they break or transcend the normal rules in some way).

For items, legendary also implies *uniqueness*: only one copy of a legendary item exists in the world. For powers and advances, the meaning is looser — legendary denotes rarity and distinction rather than strict uniqueness. A legendary power might be shared by a handful of powerful beings, or a legendary advance might be the birthright of a small group created for a specific purpose. What sets them apart is not that no one else can have them, but that they cannot be attained through ordinary means.

A legendary item might be an ancient weapon with a power that cannot be replicated. A legendary power might represent a character's latent ability, forgotten across lifetimes, that resurfaces only when the right conditions are met. A legendary advance might unlock a capability that no amount of ordinary training could produce.

The specific rules for legendary items, including enchantment slots, are detailed in the Equipment chapter. The key principle is universal: legendary things are not available at will. They are milestones, not purchases.

Races

The world of ashen is a wild place. Inhabited by magical and monstrous creatures, shaped by technology whose secrets of construction have long been lost, it is a realm of secrets and adventure.

The immortal warriors that walk this land are themselves the heirs of magic and technology beyond modern reckoning. From the sentient machines that are the Clockworks to the færie Echoes, the racial composition of immortals attests to their atypical nature.

There are seven races presented in the sections below. Each race is given a brief introduction, including what is known of their history, and typical ranges of physical traits for members of that race.

Most important are each race's special abilities: while your race does not modify your statistics, it does provide you with different physical and magical attributes that may make particular races better or worse suited to the type of character you want to play.

Clockwork

"The Goddess Third loved toys and tinkers, and when she took up arms, her toys marched alongside her."

You are a construct, a machine of supreme elegance, the watchmaker's art united with that of the wizard. Powered by the energy of your soul-anchor and the arcane workings of your mechanism, you were once created for love of art and science, and once reforged in your maker's tears to fight like no creature could fight.

There are two kinds of clockworks: Ironhands and Porcelains. All clockworks have the following traits:

Construct

You are a machine, and thus do not need to eat, breathe, or sleep. You are immune to poison and disease. However, you have other weaknesses instead: you are treated as a machine and are subject to all effects that target machines.

Wind-Up You are powered by the soul-anchor you carry within your body, which drives the mechanism that moves you. When the connection to the soul-anchor is interrupted, you become an inanimate object after three rounds until the connection is restored. This effect can be staved off for up to one hour by winding up your mechanism manually from the outside. After this time, you lose consciousness and winding up has no further effect until the underlying problem is fixed.

In addition, every clockwork must choose one of the following two subtypes:

Ironhands

You are a walking suit of armor, made to wield heavy weapons and crush your foes in melee. Your actual body is a magi-mechanic core that powers the limbs and weapons of your iron form.

You gain the following racial traits:

Walking Armor You cannot normally wear armor. Instead, your core is built to be fit into combat walker frames called Construct Bodies. You begin the game with a construct body available to you. If at any point you wish to switch to a new one, your core must be uninstalled from your current body and inserted into the new one. This is an operation that takes significant time – the engineer conducting it must roll Shop against the Equipment Rank of the construct body, with every roll taking one day.

Integrated Weapons

You can mount weaponry and gear to your construct body up to its total bulk rating. When you do this, you ignore the bulk rating on the mounted equipment. Your charge use is calculated as normal.

Porcelain

Where the Ironhands are brute force, the Porcelains are effortless grace. Lithe, youthful figures, they were originally crafted as companions for the reclusive Just-So. When the war came, she remade them as conduits for raw magical might.

You gain the following racial traits:

Graceful Form You move with supernatural grace. While you are animated, the magic within you disguises your nature as a clockwork until someone touches your cold skin. You are immune to effects that would trip you and you ignore movement penalties from Difficult and Treacherous terrain.

Spell Capacitor

Your inner workings are optimized to focus arcane energy into destructive force. Whenever you expend Focus, roll a D6. On a 5 or 6, you immediately regain the lost Focus.

Echoes

"High and Just-As-High were different from their sister. They were not content to play in silence by themselves, but made wonderful playgrounds for themselves, and filled them with playmates."

Echoes are fey creatures, born of the capricious goddesses of Magic, Knowledge and Fate. The sisters ruled over their own fey domains, twisted reflections of the material world. The Echoes that inhabited them are themselves images of humans, refracted through the lenses of their creator-goddesses. Though these faerie realms are long gone, the Echoes still retain some of their old power within themselves.

All Echoes gain the following racial traits:

Fey Jaunt

You gain the following power:

FEY JAUNT — PSYCHIC POWER

INNATE WARP

Cost: 6 FP
AP: Move Action, 2 AP
Effect: Select one square within your move range. You teleport to it.

Vindictive

It was said that those who made enemies of the Fairies would never escape their pursuers. When an enemy damages you, you can choose to hold a grudge against that enemy. When you next attack or use a spell power against that enemy, you gain 1 automatic success on your attack or spell check against him. You can only hold a grudge against one creature at a time.

There are two kinds of Echoes: Mirrors and Shades. Every Echo character must choose one of the following subtypes:

Mirrors

The Mirrors, children of Might-Be, the Fateweaver, are the fairest of the humanoid races. They lived in the beautiful lands of Faerie, once, and like many of its denizens, they are adept at misleading their foes.

Mirrors gain the following racial trait:

Dance of the Spring Court

The old, hidden world of the fey is dead, but you can still call up its echoes to bewilder your foes. You gain the following power:

DANCE OF THE SPRING COURT — PSYCHIC POWER

INNATE WARP

Trigger: You are targeted by an attack
Cost: 6 FP
AP: Reaction (Immediate Interrupt)
Effect: You may immediately teleport to any free space within 2 meters. This power does not stop the triggering attack; apply the rules for a missing target.

Shades

Shades were the favored companion of Once-Was, the Knower of Ways, Goddess of what is Hidden and Forgotten. They are said to have dwelt deep underground, in glorious palaces, until they rode out to hunt in the long winter nights of Faerie.

As a Shade, you gain the following racial trait:

Hunt of the Autumn Court In days of old, the goddess Came-To-Pass was worshipped as an unerring huntress. You retain some of her essence.

You gain the following power:

HUNT OF THE AUTUMN COURT — PSYCHIC POWER

INNATE UNERRING

Range: 15; one target
Cost: 6 FP per Tier
AP: 2 AP
Effect: Target one enemy within range that you or your allies can see. You place a mark upon it; while it is marked, your ranged attacks against the target ignore obscuration and partial cover. Additionally, whenever you use your Fey Jaunt power, you can choose to appear in a square adjacent to your enemy instead, even if the enemy would otherwise be out of range.

Soot-Beasts

"The Lion-Headed God of War, jealous of his brother, pawned his innocence to the Boar-Mother for creations of his own. Always itching for war, her work had the aspect of their mother, but the temperament of their father."

This diverse race of mostly green-skinned mostly humanoids has vexed many a scholar and led to the banning of many books. Optimized for life on the battlefield, many associate Sootbeasts with warlikeness and bravery. Although not all forms of them tend to display these traits, the ones presented here do.

There are two kinds of Sootbeasts: Warboars and Goldenbristles. All Sootbeasts have the following traits:

Asexual

Sootbeasts reproduce in idiosyncratic ways and therefore do not have the capacity to feel attraction to others, even (or perhaps especially) other Sootbeasts. You are immune to being seduced, even by magical effects.

Born for Battle

Bred to last in grueling campaigns that would wear down an army of any other race, you can find reserves of energy within yourself no matter how bloodied you are. Once per encounter, you can spend an action point to give

yourself a second wind. You immediately heal up to your healing rate and end all ongoing damage effects affecting you.

Indomitable

You are the pride of your hive, a son of battle. You were born to the sound of shields cracking under axes and the drum of gun-volleys in the air. You are immune to fear effects of any kind and cannot be compelled to run away from battle.

In addition, every Sootbeast must choose one of the following two subtypes:

Warboar

You are the epitome of what people picture when they hear the word "Sootbeast" spoken. Tough, strong, bristling with claw and tusk, you make your enemies tremble with your coming and your allies glad to have you by their side. As a Warboar, you gain the following racial traits:

Unstoppable, Immovable

You gain a +2 resistance bonus against effects that would move you against your will. When you make an attack or activate an effect that would move your target, gain a +2 bonus to any roll made to activate that effect.

Tide of Iron

To see your enemies falter before you invigorates you. When you kill another creature with an action, you immediately regain up to 2 AP for this turn. You cannot regain more AP than you spent on the action that triggered this ability.

Goldenbristle

Where there is brawn, there must be brain, or else the army will falter. While nothing compels an Warboar to be stupid, and nothing compels a Goldenbristle to weakness, their temperaments are by and large very different. Where a Warboar longs to drown in the tide of battle, a Goldenbristle is content to hang back; where a Warboar is happy (to a certain point) with taking orders, a Goldenbristle is charismatic and imperious, reflecting their designated role as field commanders of Sootbeast armies. As a Goldenbristle, you gain the following racial traits:

Born Leader

You have a natural talent at winning others' respect, if not loyalty, and your orders tend to be followed. You gain a +2 bonus on Command rolls to activate Command Powers.

Time to strike!

You gain a +2 bonus to your Initiative roll. In addition, once per round, you can swap places in the initiative order with one ally you can see.

Humans

"And thus it was that the first-born of the gods were doomed to spend their lives torn between themselves, for both the Boar-Mother and the Falcon-Headed Sun had laid their claims to them, and neither would relinquish theirs until the bitter end."

Humans were the first of the humanoid races, product of a Tryst between the God of Crafts, whose name is now lost, and the Boar-Mother, the great goddess of Life and Earth. When she slew her lover in a fit of jealous rage, it was the Sun God Kharu who adopted the young race to shield them from her wrath. Their natures have been divided ever since, but they are closer to the fading glory of the Gods than any other race.

Golden Apple

Your nature makes you both beloved of the gods, and quick to incur their anger. When you tap a reliquary to boost your Divine spells, you can make your roll against their will with +1 die. However, if you fail, you automatically incur two points of disapproval.

Gift of the Sun

Falcon-Headed Kharu is a great and terrible father; he demands much, but he rewards with pride the efforts of his children. You gain the following power:

GIFT OF THE SUN **SPELL**

Cost: 0 FP
AP: Spell Action, 1 AP
Effect: You can lose half your Health; all allies within close range that have line of sight to you immediately recover a quarter of their Health.

Gift of the Earth

The Boar-Mother gives freely of her gift; but those who sup too greedily discover that with debt comes obedience. All effects on you whose duration is measured in rounds last one round longer than usual, whether they be beneficial or harmful to you.

Attributes and Characteristics

Attributes

Attributes describe a creature's core traits in the game. Most creatures have ten attributes: **Strength**, **Endurance**, **Dexterity**, **Agility**, **Attunement**, **Sight**, **Intelligence**, **Perception**, **Will** and **Presence**. Each attribute is rated on a scale from **1 to 6**. Every character begins with a single rank in all ten attributes before modifiers are applied.

Attributes are used together with skills to make die rolls. Every point in an attribute adds one die to the pool. For a description of each skill, see the skills section of the rules.

Attributes also influence a character's combat statistics, which are described below:

Strength

Strength is a measure of a character's capacity to exert physical force. A character with low strength will be not far beyond his race's baseline; a character with very high strength has both very well-developed musculature and significant supernatural or technological assistance.

Strength contributes to a character's capacity for Athletics and Manual Labor. It influences the Martial and Stamina characteristics of a character. It also adds to their Athletics skill.

Endurance

Endurance measures a character's capacity to keep exerting themselves without needing to rest. A low-Endurance character has to be careful not to overburden themselves, lest they fail to keep up; a very high-Endurance character can fight in the heaviest armor for hours without needing to rest.

Endurance helps a character resist harsh environments and the exertions of long travel under muscle power. It influences a character's Grit and Stamina characteristics. It also assists their Athletics skill.

Agility

Agility represents a character's ability to move their body quickly and explosively. A low-Agility character might seem almost sluggish, while a very high Agility score allows a character to run at superhuman speeds and deliver devastatingly fast blows.

Agility assists a character in almost all spheres of physical exertion. It influences a character's Martial, Speed and Dodge characteristics. It also assists their Acrobatics skill.

Dexterity

Where Agility is about speed and explosivity, Dexterity represents a character's capacity for subtlety and finesse. A character with high Dexterity is much more likely to be able to repair an extremely complicated micromechanism or wriggle out of rope bindings than one with low Dexterity.

Dexterity assists characters both in the control of their own body as well as in the manipulation of various mechanisms. Dexterity adds to a character's Marksmanship characteristic, as well as their Access, Shop and Piloting skills.

Attunement

Attunement represents a character's capacity to sense and manipulate the flow of magical energies around them. It is an indispensable attribute for would-be practitioners of Arcane magic, and those who would make effective use of the many wonders they produce. A character with low Attunement will find themselves oblivious to the presence of all but the most obvious magic, and poorly suited to make use of magical items. A high-Attunement character, on the other hand, will find these pursuits easy.

Attunement adds to a character's Arcane and Potential characteristics. It also aids in the Eerie, Magitek and Ritual skills.

Sight

Sight represents a character's proverbial Sixth Sense: an uncanny talent to know things that by rights ought to be unknowable. A character with high Sight is difficult to surprise and uncannily resourceful; with the appropriate training, sufficient Sight allows a character to pierce the veil of reality and perceive what lies beyond, allowing them a modicum of clairvoyance and the ability to make use of psychic powers.

Sight contributes to a character's Psychic and Initiative ratings. It is also useful for the Eerie and Occultism skills.

Intelligence

Intelligence represents a character's capacity to absorb and process new information. High Intelligence marks a character as quick-witted and capable of finding novel solutions to problems.

Intelligence is the foundational attribute for most technical skills. It adds to a character's Initiative and Arcane characteristics as well as their Access, Influence, Alchemy, Electronics and Magitek skills.

Perception

The mundane counterpart to Sight, Perception measures how acute a character's ordinary five senses are. A character with high Perception is more likely to notice fine details that another might have missed.

Perception contributes to many different skills. It adds to a character's Marksmanship and Dodge ratings as well as their Alchemy and Piloting skills.

Will

Will represents a character's capacity for taking decisions and seeing them through, come hell or high water. A character with high Will will be more able to resist pain or attempts at controlling them, as well as be more able to follow through on their decisions.

Will contributes to a character's Grit, Potential, Psychic and Command ratings. It also adds to their Impose, Occultism and Ritual skills.

Presence

Presence is a measure of the character's ability to capture others' attention. A character with high Presence cannot walk into a room unnoticed – they are sure to turn all the heads that can be turned. A low-Presence character is much more forgettable, which has social disadvantages, but also lets one be more stealthy.

The Presence attribute contributes to a character's Command rating. It also adds to the Impose and Influence skills.

Characteristics

Apart from their attributes, each character also has several characteristics that are derived from them. These statistics principally influence the success and failure of a character in combat, but occasionally may also be rolled against in other situations.

Each character has a rating in a characteristic that normally ranges between 3 and 18. The ratings are composed of a character's ranks in that statistic, from 1 to 6, and their attribute bonuses to the statistic. Each statistic gains bonuses from two attributes, listed below.

A character starts with one rank in each characteristic, but may advance their ranks in the course of play. See the sections on character creation and advancement for details.

Martial

Attributes: STR + AGI

This characteristic describes a character's effectiveness in melee combat. It is used to make attack rolls with melee or thrown weapons. You need to make an opposed Martial check to resist being overpowered.

Marksmanship

Attributes: DEX + PER

This characteristic describes a character's skill with ranged weapons of all kinds. It is used to make attack rolls with ranged and thrown weapons.

Initiative

Attributes: SGT + INT

This characteristic represents a character's alertness and quickness to act. It determines how quickly your character gets a chance to act in combat (or in structured time). Initiative checks are also rolled to avoid surprises and sudden dangers, such as trap doors.

Speed

Attributes: AGI + END

This characteristic represents how quick a character is on their feet. It determines a character's movement range. You may also need to make a speed check when attempting to traverse ground within a certain amount of time.

Stamina

Attributes: STR + END

This characteristic represents your character's ability to keep fighting and exerting themselves under strain. Your character's Stamina rating determines their **Bulk capacity** (see *Bulk and Charge* in the Equipment chapter). Your character may need to make a Stamina check to resist the effects of poison, disease or fatigue.

Potential

Attributes: ATT + WIL

This characteristic represents your character's ability to control magical energy. Your character's Potential rating determines their **Charge capacity** (see *Bulk and Charge* in the Equipment chapter). You may also need to make a Potential check to resist the effects of harmful magic.

Arcane

Attributes: ATT + INT

This characteristic determines your character's skill at casting Arcane magic. It is used when making casting rolls for Arcane spells.

Psychic

Attributes: SGT + WIL

This characteristic determines your character's skill at using Psychic powers.

Command

Attributes: PRS + WIL

This characteristic represents your character's ability to persuade both allies and enemies. It is used to make casting rolls for charm abilities. Since it is also necessary to convince Reliquaries, this characteristic additionally determines your character's skill at casting Divine magic.

Dodge

Attributes: AGI + PER

This characteristic influences how easy your character is to hit with weapon attacks, and can allow them to avoid larger attacks as well. Dodge checks are usually made to avoid area attacks and effects.

Grit

Attributes: END + WIL

This characteristic influences your character's ability to resist pain, disturbing mental effects and similar noxious influences.

Derived Statistics

The following statistics are derived from a character's attributes, characteristics and advances. Unlike attributes and characteristics, they do not have ranks — they are calculated from other values.

Hit Points (HP)

Hit Points represent how much damage a character can sustain before falling. Every character begins with **10 HP**. Additional HP is gained from advances: each advance a character purchases grants a certain amount of HP as listed in its description. A character's total HP is the sum of their base 10 plus all HP gained from advances. For rules on how damage is dealt and reduced, including damage types, Armor, Ward, and resistances, see *Damage* in the Combat chapter.

Focus Points (FP)

Focus Points fuel a character's extraordinary abilities, including spells, prayers and psychic powers. Every character begins with **10 FP**. Additional FP is gained from advances in the same way as HP. A character's total FP is the sum of their base 10 plus all FP gained from advances.

Movement Speed

A character's Movement Speed determines how many squares they can move with a single move action. Movement Speed is equal to **2 + the character's Speed rating**. A starting character typically has a Movement Speed of 5 squares, while a character at the peak of their physical ability can reach 20 or more with advances.

Evasion

Evasion represents how difficult a character is to hit with attacks. A character's base Evasion is equal to **half their Dodge rating, rounded down**. This base value is then modified by armor (light armor typically grants a bonus, heavy armor imposes a penalty) and other effects.

Action Points (AP)

Every character has **4 Action Points** per turn. AP is spent to take actions during combat; unspent AP is lost at the end of a character's turn. Some advances and effects can modify the number of AP available.

Essence Points

Each character has a number of **Essence Points (EP)** that control that character's ability to recover from damage and exhaustion. A character starts with 10 EP and gains an additional EP every time he or she gains 1000 experience.

Characters can spend EP to recover from damage and even return from the dead. The costs are as follows:

A Deathless character who dies may spend 5 EP on their next turn to revive on the spot. See *Death and Revival* in the Combat chapter for the full rules, and *Death and Reincorporation* in the Exploration chapter for what happens when spot-revival is not possible.

When taking a rest, a character may spend 1 EP to recover either **half their health** or **their entire focus**. Characters suffering from magical effects that do not require special measures to end may also spend 1 EP to end them.

Whenever you take a **long rest**, you recover 3 EP.

Skills

Skills represent your character's abilities and aptitudes that are not directly related to their performance in combat.

Trained and Untrained Skills

Skills are divided into untrained and trained skills. Untrained skills are available to every character, and start at rank 1. Trained skills, as the name suggests, require special training. Characters without training in a trained skill have 0 ranks in it and cannot make skill checks using that skill.

Gaining and Improving Skills

Characters improve their skills by spending **skill points (SP)**. Every character begins the game with **11 SP** (10 base and 1 from their starting 1000 XP). During play, characters earn 1 additional SP for every 1000 XP they accumulate.

Skill points can be spent during character creation or during intermissions to improve your skills in the following ways:

- **Learn a trained skill** (rank 0 ⟶ 1): 1 SP. This represents acquiring the basic training needed to use the skill, whether through instruction from a mentor, self-study, or hard-won experience. Characters may choose
- **Improve a skill by one rank**: The cost to raise a skill from rank N to rank N+1 is equal to N skill points.

COST PER SKILL RANK

Rank	SP Cost	Cumulative (from rank 1)
2	1	1
3	2	3
4	3	6
5	4	10
6	5	15

The maximum rank in any skill is 6, representing absolute mastery. A skill's total **rating** — the number of dice you roll for skill checks — equals your ranks in the skill plus your ranks in its two linked attributes, for a maximum of 18.

Using skills

Skills are usually called upon in situations where unusual danger must be confronted or special knowledge is required. As such, using a skill requires making a skill check.

To roll a skill check, first determine your total **rating** for that skill. Every skill is associated with two attributes; add up your skill ranks with your ranks in those attributes to obtain your total rating. The end result will be a number between 3 and 18. This is the total number of dice you have to roll. If the number of successes you roll beats the difficulty indicated by your GM, your skill check was successful.

The modalities of your skill check depend on the circumstances and your character's training. Some advances or items can grant you a bonus to your skill check, while some external circumstances may increase the difficulty of your task. As an example, if you are making an athletics check to climb up a cliff face, you may benefit from a bonus to your check if you have taken along proper mountaineering equipment. Conversely, if you are surprised by a sudden storm, your skill check may become more difficult than you expected.

There are also some special ways you can use your skills that are not making the usual skill check.

Taking the Average

If you are not otherwise distracted or endangered, you can choose to take the average of your skill rather than roll. If you do so, you can automatically attempt to succeed at a skill check with a number of successes equal to half your rating in that skill (rounded down). This usually results in an automatic success for many routine tasks.

You cannot take the average if you are in combat or in another situation that makes it impossible for you to devote your full concentration to the skill check. You also cannot take the average on skill checks made as part of skill challenges. At your GM's discretion, you may also not be allowed to take the average on intrinsically dangerous or high-stakes skill checks, even if you have a high rating in the skill.

Taking the average is risk-free but also routine — it does not represent a moment of growth or challenge for your character.

Taking the Maximum

If you have plenty of time, and failing a skill check does not entail any particular consequences (i.e., you can retry it indefinitely) then you can elect to treat the result of your skill check as equal to your rating in it.

Doing so takes 10 times as long as making a single check, as it is assumed that your character fails at, and retries, the task several times before arriving at a satisfactory outcome; that is, if you keep making skill checks, eventually you will roll your rating's worth of successes or higher.

Taking the maximum assumes your character spends the time to get the job done right, failing and retrying as needed until they arrive at a satisfactory outcome.

Helping Another

Some tasks are amenable to being performed in groups. If you decide to join another in making such a skill check, then you can grant them a bonus to their

check. The first helper adds a +2 bonus, every helper after that a +1 bonus. In order to qualify to help another in their skill check, your skill rating must be at least equal to the difficulty of the task. For example, to help somebody in a ritual with difficulty 6, your Ritual rating must be 6 or higher.

You cannot help another with a task requiring a trained skill if you are not yourself trained in that skill.

Difficulty

The skill descriptions below include a set of sample skill checks along with their difficulties. If a particular use of a skill is not listed in these chapters, apply the following guidelines:

The merely hard is difficulty 0

An immortal is by nature far above the powers of ordinary mortals. Any task that would be readily learnable by a mortal of average talent and skill does not require a skill check from a character, unless the circumstances are truly adverse.

One level of difficulty equals two dice

When determining difficulties, consider the skill level of the character the challenge ought to be appropriate for. At the absolute minimum level, three dice, a character will statistically pass a check of difficulty 2 50% of the time. Every two dice above that, the cutoff for passing 50% of the time increases by one.

For determining the chance of success at different dice pools, consider the following chart:

SUCCESS CHANCES

Pool Size	< 10%	25%	50%	75%	>90%
3	5	3	2	1	-1
5	6	5	3	1	0
7	8	6	4	2	0
9	9	7	5	3	1
11	11	8	6	4	1
13	12	9	7	5	2
15	13	10	8	6	3
17	15	12	9	6	3
19	16	13	10	7	4
21	17	14	11	8	5
23	18	15	12	9	6

Skill List

Untrained Skills

Acrobatics (U; AGI + DEX)

Control your body, maintain your balance.

Athletics (U; STR + END)

Perform feats of strength and speed.

Awareness (U; PER + SGT)

Know your surroundings, detect and avoid threats.

Deceive (U; INT + PRS)

They didn't need to know that. Or maybe they did.

Eerie (U; SGT + ATT)

Use your sixth sense.

Impose (U; PRS + WIL)

Leave a lasting impression.

Influence (U; PRS + INT)

Give people really good advice.

Investigate (U; INT + PER)

Perform research.

Subterfuge (U; DEX + INT)

Steal, hide, cheat, and all other such sporting activities.

Trained Skills

Access (T; DEX + INT)

Circumvent locks, access control systems and structurally unsound walls.

Alchemy (T; INT + PER)

Straw to gold, lead to uranium, grapes into illegal booze.

Electronics (T; DEX + INT)

Deal with sentient creatures' worst mistake.

Magitek (T; INT + ATT)

Figure out how that magical gizmo works.

Occultism (T; SGT + ATT)

Commune with your Luigi Board and other things inhabited by a supernatural presence.

Piloting (T; DEX + PER)

Control high-speed vehicles of all kinds.

Ritual (T; WIL + ATT)

Perform pious and/or blasphemous invocations to the spirits and cast really fancy spells.

Shop (T; DEX + STR)

Welding, riveting, lathing... the works!

Skill Descriptions

Skill descriptions adhere to the following guidelines.

Skill Name: The name of the skill.

Training required: Whether a skill is untrained ("U") or trained ("T"). **Key Attributes**: The name line also includes the abbreviations of the attributes that contribute to your skill rating.

Check: What a character ("you" in the skill description) can do with a successful skill check and the usual difficulties (D) of such checks.

Action: The amount of AP or the amount of time required for a check.

Try Again: Any conditions that apply to successive attempts to use the skill successfully. If the skill doesn't allow you to attempt the same task more than once, or if failure carries an inherent penalty, you can't take the maximum. If this paragraph is omitted, the skill can be retried without any inherent penalty

other than the additional time required.

Special: Any extra facts that apply to the skill.

Untrained Skills

Acrobatics (U; AGI + DEX)

Your ability to move securely through space. This skill covers keeping your balance on particularly treacherous ground (such as tightropes), performing feats of jumping or tumbling, and even avoiding or lessening injury when you take a fall.

Checks

Balance: You can make an acrobatics check to balance across narrow surfaces, highly slippery or uneven ground, or a surface in motion.

Some general modifiers apply to checks made to balance. These modifiers stack between categories, but only the most severe penalty per category applies. Thus, trying to run across a narrow (0,75 m) walkway that is iced over and slopes slightly upward carries a total difficulty of 9 (D 1 base + D 3 icy + D 1 slope + D 4 running speed).

BALANCE DIFFICULTIES

Terrain Condition	Difficulty Modifier
Severely Obstructed (cavern, rubble)	+1
Slightly Slippery (wet)	+1
Severely Slippery (icy)	+3
Slightly Sloped (<45°)	+1
Severely Sloped (>45°)	+3
Slightly Unsteady (boat in rough water)	+1
Mildly Unsteady (boat in a storm)	+2
Severely Unsteady (earthquake)	+4
Move at full speed on narrow or uneven surfaces	+2
Run across narrow or uneven surfaces (double speed)	+4

The base difficulties for narrow surfaces are given below.

NARROW SURFACE DIFFICULTIES

Surface Width	Base Acrobatics Difficulty
Greater than 1 m wide	0
0,4-1 meters wide	1
20-40 cm wide	2
5-20 cm wide	3
Less than 5 cm wide	4

Jumping: The acrobatics skill also allows you to make jumps and aerobatic maneuvers.

JUMP DIFFICULTIES

Attempted Jump	Difficulty (Modifier)
High Jump (2 m)	2
High Jump (per additional meter)	+2
Long Jump (Quarter Speed)	2
Long Jump (Half Speed)	4
Long Jump (per quarter speed)	+2
Running start	−2
Wearing Medium or Heavy armor	+Bulk of the armor

Tumbling and Rolling: You can make acrobatics checks to perform various maneuvers while in mid-air. Usually, these checks are made in reaction to another event, either a previous Acrobatics check to jump, or because something knocked you away.

If you make an acrobatics check to bypass an obstacle while moving quickly, you lose some speed: an obstacle counts as difficult terrain. You can make your check with an additional +2 difficulty to keep moving at your original speed.

MANEUVER DIFFICULTIES

Maneuver	Difficulty (Modifier)
Vault an Object	Corresponding High Jump difficulty +2
Slide under an obstacle while moving (0.5-1m of space)	2
Slide under an obstacle while moving (30-50 cm of space)	4
Cartwheels, somersaults or twists while jumping	Jump difficulty + 1 per turn
Kick off a wall to keep moving	4 (+ high jump difficulty if moving upwards)
Land on your feet after being knocked over	2
Roll to absorb fall damage	1 per meter fallen

Action

None. Acrobatics checks are made as reactions or as part of move actions. They do not take additional time.

Try Again

Varies. An Acrobatics check that doesn't put you in physical danger can be retried indefinitely. If you would fall a dangerous distance on failure, you cannot retry before resolving the effects of the fall (you cannot take the maximum on such checks).

Special

Porcelains' *Graceful Form* ability also affects their Acrobatics checks. A porcelain treats every conditional modifier to an Acrobatics check made to balance on narrow or uneven as 1 lower than it actually is, and does not take a

penalty to Acrobatics checks to perform a movement at full speed. If the check difficulty is reduced to 0 in this way, they do not need to make a check. For example, Porcelains can move across a wet floor or a 30 centimeter wide plank at full speed without requiring an acrobatics check, and only need to succeed at a D 6 Acrobatics check to cross a frozen tightrope without falling.

Any other effects that allow a character to ignore penalties from difficult terrain have the same influence on their Acrobatics checks.

Athletics (U; STR + END)

Athletics measures your skill at exerting force on the world. Where proficiency in Acrobatics allows you to jump and wheel freely to the world, proficiency in Athletics lets you lift great weights, throw objects very far, climb up sheer cliff faces and swim swiftly through rough waters.

Checks

Climb: You can make an Athletics check to climb up or down surfaces that are too steep to traverse normally. You can also climb horizontally across walls or traverse a chasm or gap hanging off overhead handholds.

CLIMBING DIFFICULTIES

Example Surface or Activity	Check Difficulty
... on very wet or otherwise slippery surfaces	+2
... in strong wind	+2

Lift and Throw: Your athletics checks also allow you to exert strength and move objects, whether by lifting, throwing, or even just pushing.

LIFTING AND THROWING DIFFICULTIES

Example activity	Check Difficulty
Push your body weight	2
... per additional times your weight	+2
Lift half your body weight overhead	2
... per additional half times	+2
Throw (per quarter body weight)	2

Swim: You can use an Athletics check to swim. In calm conditions with no external dangers, characters usually require no check to swim (except if they would otherwise sink due to their composition); to swim in adverse conditions or to move particularly quickly, a check is required.

A character without an innate Swim speed moves half their land speed by default when swimming. They can exert themselves to swim twice as fast, but this always requires a check.

SWIMMING DIFFICULTIES

Water Condition	Check Difficulty
Calm	0
Rough	2
Very Rough*	4
Storm*	6
... moving at full speed	+2
... with flotsam in the water	+2
... with heavy flotsam or underwater obstacles*	+4

* These conditions are hazardous and characters cannot take the average to swim

Special

Constructs do not float. Constructs automatically fail any checks made to swim and sink to the bottom of any body of water unless equipped with flotation devices (or effects) capable of handling their weight.

Awareness (U; SGT + PER)

The awareness skill allows a character to maintain awareness of their surroundings and notice changes or oddities that less trained observers might miss. It's used to navigate unfamiliar environments, spot hidden objects and creatures, and notice inconsistencies in narrative.

In general, Awareness is the skill used for spontaneous perception, whereas Investigation is the skill used for directed search and research.

The GM might call for an Awareness check when:

- ... a character fears an ambush
- ... a character must find their way in a place they've not been to before
- ... a character is attempting to spot a hidden individual or item
- ... a character is attempting to evaluate whether a narrative is plausible

Sample Awareness difficulties:

- Detecting the approach of a large vehicle: 2
- Spotting an acquaintance in a crowded pub: 3
- Finding your way around a maze: 4
- Noticing a well-laid ambush: 5
- Detecting that you are being followed by someone in thermal camo: 8

Deceive (U; INT + PRS)

The Deceive skill measures a character's ability to mislead others. Characters with a high rating in Deceive are adept at strategically omitting information, convincing others of half-truths and untruths, and pretending to be who they are not.

The GM may call for a Deceive check when:

- ... a character attempts to pass themselves off as someone else or mislead another as to their motives
- ... a character wishes to tell a story from which they are omitting crucial details
- ... a character is trying to bluff their hand at a game of cards

A Deceive check is usually opposed by the victim's Eerie or Awareness. Both parties might receive modifiers to their checks based on the outrageousness of the attempted fib and the pre-existing relationship between them.

Opposing a Deceive Check

Two skills can oppose Deceive: Awareness and Eerie. Awareness can help a character notice logical errors or factual inconsistencies, while Eerie acts to allow another to sense the Deceive user's intentions.

If the defender has no reason to mistrust the Deceive user, they might be able to detect the Deceive user's unfriendly motives with their passive Eerie skill. Alternatively, if they are somewhat well-informed about the facts in question, they might be able to notice that something is being misrepresented using their Awareness. In general, if the victim is well-disposed toward the Deceive user, the GM should use the lower of those two numbers. If the victim is already suspicious, the GM should use the higher of the two numbers.

Sample Deceive Difficulties

- Lie to a suspicious mortal: 2
- Successfully pass yourself off as a locally known figure: 4
- Bluff a table of professional card-players: 6
- Successfully pass yourself off as an intimate acquaintance of your interlocutor: 8
- Lie to an extremely adept psychic: 11

Eerie (U; SGT + ATT)

The Eerie skill represents a character's aptitude for sensing things not entirely amenable to mundane senses. This includes the presence of magical or otherworldly energies as well as the motivations of an interlocutor.

Detect Magic

You can make an Eerie check to determine the presence of magical energy. The difficulty of such a check varies with the intensity of the magical energy as well as whether any attempts were made to hide its presence.

Sense Motive

You can make an Eerie check in order to discern the intentions of another by sensing their aura. A successful Eerie check to sense motive allows you to divine whether your interlocutor is lying or speaking the truth, and whether he is well- or ill-disposed towards you. Eerie checks to sense motive are opposed by the target's Deceive.

Detect Danger

A character with a high Eerie rating may feel a sense of impending doom when about to confront a significant danger. Characters may roll Eerie to attempt to sense danger; the difficulty to detect danger is 12 - the threat's level.

For significant threats, the GM may opt to compare the threat's level against characters' passive Eerie, even if the characters do not explicitly make a check.

Sample Eerie difficulties:

- Detect the presence of powerful magic: 2
- Detect a malicious lie: 3
- Detect the presence of subdued magic: 5
- Detect the presence of very well-disguised magic: 8
- Detect a lie from an extremely adept manipulator: 9

Impose (U; PRS + WIL)

The Impose skill measures a character's ability to impress another. It can be used to browbeat, intimidate or otherwise overpower another in a test of wills. It also serves as the skill governing a character's ability to captivate and win over others.

The GM might call for an impose check when:

- ... a character gives an impassioned speech
- ... a character wishes to force another to do their bidding
- ... a character is interrogating another and pressures them to reveal information

Sample Impose difficulties:

- Browbeating a hapless mortal: 2
- Winning over a neutral crowd: 4
- Winning over a hostile crowd: 7
- Blackmailing a powerful immortal: 9

Influence (U; INT + PRS)

The influence skill measures a character's proficiency at the subtler arts of social conduct. Negotiation, diplomacy, manipulation – everything requiring a good sense of decorum, tact, and charisma.

The GM might call for an Influence check when:

- ... a character is attempting to negotiate the price of goods or services
- ... a character is arguing a legal case
- ... a character is attempting to establish friendly relations with an important figure

Sample influence difficulties:

- Haggling down an inexperienced seller: 2
- Securing a favor from an important figure: 4
- Arguing an extremely difficult case in court: 7
- Negotiating a ceasefire between two Immortal Orders: 9

Investigate (U; INT + PER)

The investigate skill allows a character to research, collate and correlate information. It is the skill used for searching through dusty tomes for clues as to the whereabouts of a long-lost temple, making sense of an archaic electronic records system, or poring over ledgers in search of a specific transaction. It is also the skill used for cultivating informants within a city, tracking the movements of a target, and distilling actionable intelligence from diverse sources.

A specialized use of the skill is to attempt to recall information that a character might have accidentally come by in their previous information-gathering efforts. The more widely read and traveled a character is, after all, the more likely it is they might have seen something before.

Checks

Research Documents: A character can use the Investigate skill to attempt to find information in documents of some kind, be they books in a library or entries in an electronic database. The difficulty of doing so is generally related to how concretely the information the character is looking for is available within the documents, if at all.

Sample Research difficulties:

- Information is somewhat obscure: 2
- Information is very obscure and requires specialist knowledge to understand and extract: 4
- Information is highly arcane and requires intricate knowledge to extract: 6
- Information has been deliberately suppressed and must be reconstructed from traces: 8
- Character does not entirely know what they are looking for: +3
- Information must be gathered from several different information stores: +2

Develop and Use Contacts: A character can use the Investigate skill to research and identify useful people to know. Once they have built a relationship with such people (a matter for the Influence skill) they can use Investigate to attempt to use their network to obtain information. Such information can include dirt on a person of interest, information on the markets in a city or area, as well as, of course, introductions to people in other areas.

Sample Contacts difficulties:

- Obtain insight into the goings-on within a city: 2
- Gain information on the schedule and whereabouts of a public figure: 4
- Gain information on the schedule and whereabouts of a highly secretive person: 6
- Obtain insight into the secret agendas of Immortal factions: 8

The GM may, at their discretion, call for an Influence check alongside the Investigate check when the character attempts to call in favors. The results of that Influence check decide how the character's actions affect their ability to use Investigate in this fashion in the future.

Search for Tracks: A character can use the Investigate skill to analyze a scene, looking for any traces and tracks left behind by others. They can also use this skill to track down a creature and attempt to follow it or surmise its whereabouts.

Sample Tracks difficulties:

- Tracking an animal in unfavorable conditions: 2
- Tracking a Mist Creature in unfavorable conditions: 4
- Tracking a human in a city: 6
- Discovering the route taken by someone through a town a week before: 8
- Tracking down a professional deploying countermeasures in a city: 11

Subterfuge (U; DEX + INT)

The Subterfuge skill allows a character to move quietly and avoid detection, as well as perform feats of sleight of hand, such as pickpocketing or unseen manipulation of objects. The difficulty of a Subterfuge check generally depends on the scrutiny placed upon a character. Forging a document that nobody will pay too close attention to while nobody is watching is a much easier feat than sneaking through a fortress equipped with CCTV in order to lift an artifact from a heavily guarded vault.

Subterfuge is generally opposed by Awareness, but can be opposed by Investigate (where the objective of the Subterfuge check is to conceal, destroy, or alter evidence or records). If a Subterfuge check is being made to evade automated or magical countermeasures, the GM sets the difficulty of that check as a function of the sophistication of these devices.

Checks

Hide and Sneak: A character may use Subterfuge to move around undetected. As a special case of this use of the Subterfuge skill, a character may also attempt to lose pursuers. Making such a check requires that the character have concealment from any hostile creatures or countermeasures. If a character is being pursued and wishes to evade their pursuers, they must find a hiding place.

The sensory spectrum of the threat determines whether a character counts as having concealment; see **Senses** for more.

Sample Sneak difficulties:

- Evade a simple CCTV system: 2
- Evade the attention of professional guards equipped with night vision or IR goggles: 4
- Slip through the cracks of a magical intrusion detection system: 6
- Infiltrate a facility protected by multiple redundant high-power surveillance systems: 8
- Lose a highly skilled pursuer equipped with multi-spectrum sensorics: 10

Sleight of Hand: A character may use the Subterfuge skill to perform a sleight of hand. This includes pickpocketing, planting an item on another, concealing the presence of an item (such as a weapon) on themselves under search, or cheating at card games.

Sample Sleight of Hand difficulties:

- Perform a simple magic trick: 2
- Steal a small item from an observant victim: 4
- Conceal an item on someone conversing with you without them noticing: 6
- Smuggle a weapon past a high-security checkpoint: 8

Forgery: A character may use the Subterfuge skill to alter, replace or falsify physical documents or evidence. Making such a check is a protracted affair, and requires the character to manufacture the forgery ahead of time or, if it is possible to perform the manipulation on site, bring the appropriate tooling with them. If the item to be forged is particularly difficult to manufacture, the character might need to make an appropriate crafting check or, if they do not have the requisite training in the skill required, find someone who can help them.

Sample Forgery difficulties:

- Manipulate an invoice or other unsecured document: 2
- Forge a watermarked or holo-secured document: 4
- Duplicate a well-known piece of art: 6
- Forge a cryptographic access token: 8

Trained Skills

Access (T; DEX + INT)

The Access skill allows a character to circumvent security systems of various kinds, using more or less violent means. With sufficient training, a character trained in Access can pick locks, hack into computers, place breaching charges, disable traps, and generally go where they are not supposed to go.

The Access skill is by nature somewhat interdisciplinary, and proficiency in skills such as Subterfuge, Electronics or Shop is helpful when using it.

Checks

Lockpicking: The Access skill can be used to bypass locks of all kinds. Effectively using the skill in this way requires a set of appropriate tools for the job at hand (for which see the Equipment chapter). While better tools usually lead to better results, even improvised tools have to do sometimes. In this case, raise the difficulty of the job by 2.

A character who has no tools whatsoever on them may be unable to bypass a lock regardless of how well they roll on their check, at the GM's discretion.

Sample Lockpicking difficulties:

- Picking a well-made lock with improvised tools: 4
- Picking a high-security lock: 6
- Bypassing a multi-modal access control system: 8
- Bypassing a magically reinforced, mastercrafted multi-lock: 10

Hotwiring and Hacking: The Access skill can be used to manipulate electric and electronic systems of all kinds, whether by crude bypasses or more subtle methods. When attempting more sophisticated attacks, especially against computer systems, the GM may rule that a successful Electronics check is also required to subdue the recalcitrant machine.

Sample Hacking difficulties:

- Hotwiring a simple motor or electronic lock: 2
- Gaining unauthorized access to a simply secured computer system: 4
- Performing a privilege escalation attack on a well-secured computer system: 6
- Mechanically suborning an AI core: 10

Traps: A character trained in the Access skill can detect and disable traps. The difficulties for doing so are similar to lockpicking.

Alchemy (T; INT + PER)

The alchemy skill allows a character to study, analyze and perform chemical reactions in or outside of the presence of magical energies. Successfully using the Alchemy skill requires having access to the appropriate equipment for the job at hand; even the most experienced alchemist cannot work without a laboratory.

Proficiency in Occultism and Eerie is helpful when working with magically charged substances, while Shop assists in crafting and modifying alchemical equipment and containers.

Checks

Analyzing Substances: A character trained in Alchemy can use their skills to analyze substances and detect certain components or alchemical-magical properties within them. The difficulty of doing so depends on the number of distinct components making up the substance as well as the number and concentration of components to be detected.

Sample Analyzing difficulties:

- Identify whether a common substance has been tampered with: 2
- Identify the active components of an unfamiliar compound: 4
- Detect trace quantities of a rare reagent within a complex mixture: 6
- Fully analyze an unknown substance of extraplanar or magical origin: 8

Synthesizing Substances: A character can use their Alchemy skill to perform alchemical procedures — combining, refining, and transforming materials to produce compounds with specific properties. This subsumes everything from distilling poisons to crafting alchemical reagents for use in rituals.

When synthesizing a known recipe, the difficulty is set by the recipe itself. When working without a recipe — improvising or experimenting — the GM sets a difficulty appropriate to the desired effect and the character's available materials.

Consumable reagents and equipment are spent whether or not the synthesis succeeds.

Sample Synthesizing difficulties:

- Brew a simple stimulant or sedative from common materials: 3
- Prepare a ritual reagent of moderate power: 5
- Synthesize a compound with precisely calibrated alchemical-magical properties: 7
- Produce a substance of legendary potency or unprecedented effect: 10

Alchemical Rituals: When performing an alchemical recipe, Alchemy is the only applicable skill — Ritual and Occultism do not apply (see *Rituals and Recipes*).

Electronics (T; DEX + INT)

The Electronics skill covers the hands-on diagnosis, repair, modification, and construction of electronic devices and systems — from simple motors and locks to computing hardware and AI subsystems. It is the skill of the engineer and the scrapper alike.

Access is the natural complement when the goal is bypassing or subverting a system rather than understanding it; Magitek applies where magical and electronic systems are intertwined; Investigate can assist when researching technical documentation or an unfamiliar device's design.

Checks

Repair & Maintenance: A character trained in Electronics can diagnose malfunctions and restore damaged or broken devices to working order. The difficulty depends on the complexity of the device and the severity of the damage.

Sample Repair difficulties:

- Fix a common appliance or simple motor: 2
- Restore a damaged circuit board or control system: 4
- Bring a sophisticated computing system back online after catastrophic failure: 6
- Reconstruct a destroyed AI subsystem from salvaged components: 8

Modification & Construction: A character can use Electronics to alter existing devices or build new ones from salvaged or raw parts. When building something with no reference design, the GM may require a prior Investigate or Magitek check to establish the specifications.

Sample Modification & Construction difficulties:

- Jury-rig a simple bypass or adapter: 2
- Build a functional device from salvaged parts: 4
- Modify military-grade hardware for unauthorized use: 6
- Construct a novel electronic component with no reference design: 8

Assisted Hacking: When using the Access skill to attack sophisticated computer systems, the GM may additionally call for an Electronics check to manipulate the underlying hardware — particularly when physical access to the machine is available.

Magitek (T; INT + ATT)

The Magitek skill covers understanding, operating, and working with technology that incorporates magical components or principles — the ancient relics, enchanted machinery, and hybrid devices that populate a world where magic and technology were once unified.

Electronics handles the non-magical circuitry within a magitek device; Eerie can supplement Magitek when sensing a device's magical state or charge; Alchemy and Ritual are relevant when a magitek device's function overlaps with alchemical or ritual processes.

Checks

Identifying Magitek: A character trained in Magitek can examine an unknown device to determine its function, origin, and magical properties. The difficulty depends on the complexity of the device and how much information is being sought.

Sample Identifying difficulties:

- Identify the function of a simple magitek tool: 2
- Determine the magical properties of an unfamiliar device: 4
- Analyze a magitek device of ancient or unknown design: 6
- Reverse-engineer a unique magitek artifact: 8

Operating Magitek: Using a familiar magitek device does not require a check. Checks arise when the device is unfamiliar, damaged, unstable, or actively resisting the user — or when the character is attempting to use it in a way it was not designed for.

Sample Operating difficulties:

- Operate an unfamiliar but standard magitek device: 2
- Safely activate an unstable or partially damaged device: 4
- Override a device's magical safeguards: 6
- Operate a device fundamentally hostile or incompatible with the user: 8

Repair & Modification: A character can use Magitek to restore damaged devices or alter their function, including re-seating magical cores and recalibrating enchantments. Electronics may be required alongside Magitek when the damage extends to non-magical components.

Sample Repair & Modification difficulties:

- Repair a lightly damaged magitek device: 3
- Restore a device with a damaged magical core: 5
- Modify a device to function outside its intended parameters: 7
- Integrate two incompatible magical systems within a single device: 9

Crafting Magitek: A character with sufficient expertise can attempt to create new magitek devices. Magitek provides the overall design and integration of magical and technical systems, but is rarely sufficient on its own: crafting the physical components typically requires Shop, the electronic elements require Electronics, and the magical workings require Ritual or Occultism. Substantial facilities are also required — improvised or field-expedient construction raises difficulties significantly, and some projects may be impossible without a proper workshop.

Occultism (T; SGT + ATT)

Where Ritual treats magic as a natural force to be studied and reproduced, Occultism is the practice of engaging with forces that resist systematic understanding: spirits, divine powers, and the deeper currents of Fate and the Void. The effects it produces can be profound, but the forces involved are capricious — failure is not merely a lack of result, and a catastrophic failure may invite consequences far beyond what the caster intended.

Occultism is primarily the skill of Divine magic, and applies to Psychic magic of an esoteric or entropic nature, such as the Fate and Void domains. Eerie is a natural complement, helping a character sense and interpret the presences they are dealing with. Ritual, by contrast, is not interchangeable with Occultism — the two approaches are fundamentally different in method.

Checks

Identifying Supernatural Entities: A character trained in Occultism can attempt to recognize the nature, origin, and intent of a spirit or divine presence. This typically precedes any attempt to commune with or bind it.

Sample Identifying difficulties:

- Identify the broad category of a supernatural presence (spirit, divine fragment, etc.): 2
- Determine the domain or allegiance of a known type of entity: 4
- Assess the disposition and intent of an unfamiliar entity: 5
- Identify a rare, concealed, or actively deceptive supernatural presence: 8

Communing: A character can use Occultism to contact or negotiate with a spirit or divine force. Unlike ritual casting, the outcome of a communion is not guaranteed even on a success — the entity retains its own will. On a failure, the entity may ignore the character, respond with hostility, or extract a price of its own choosing.

Divination: A character trained in Occultism can petition the forces of Fate or Void for glimpses of the past, present, or future. The specificity and reliability of the vision depends on the difficulty; Fate can be consulted but not commanded.

Sample Divination difficulties:

- Seek a broad impression of a past event: 3
- Seek a clear image of a specific past event: 5
- Request a vision of a probable future: 6
- Seek precise knowledge of a hidden or deliberately obscured truth: 9

Warding & Binding: A character can use Occultism to ward a location against supernatural intrusion or to bind a spirit, constraining its actions. The difficulty depends on the power of the entity and the scope of the constraint.

Sample Warding & Binding difficulties:

- Ward a small space against minor spirits: 3
- Bind a willing or weakened entity: 4
- Ward against a powerful or persistent supernatural presence: 6
- Bind an unwilling and powerful entity: 9

Casting Rituals: Occultism may be used in place of Ritual for the casting of rituals that draw on Divine or esoteric Psychic magic, such as those of the Fate and Void domains. All other rules for ritual casting apply (see *Rituals and Recipes*). Unlike ritual casting with the Ritual skill, a failed check using Occultism may produce unintended consequences beyond the loss of reagents.

Piloting (T; DEX + PER)

The Piloting skill covers the operation of vehicles of all kinds — ground vehicles, aircraft, and watercraft alike. A trained pilot can push a vehicle to its limits, navigate hostile conditions, and fight from behind the wheel or controls.

Routine travel under safe conditions does not require a check; rolls arise when speed, hazards, or hostile action demand precise control.

Electronics and Magitek are useful when diagnosing or improvising repairs to a vehicle's systems while in motion.

Checks

Hazardous Navigation: A character can use Piloting to traverse difficult terrain, severe weather, or complex environments at speed. The difficulty depends on the combination of speed, conditions, and the demands of the route.

Sample Navigation difficulties:

- Navigate a damaged road or choppy water at speed: 2
- Pilot through dense terrain, storm conditions, or heavy traffic: 4
- Thread through a collapsing structure or tight urban canyon at speed: 6
- Pilot a badly damaged vehicle through extreme or rapidly changing conditions: 8

Pursuit & Evasion: When one vehicle is chasing or fleeing another, both pilots make opposed Piloting checks. The victor gains or maintains positional advantage. The GM may call for multiple checks over the course of a prolonged chase, with environmental hazards adding to the difficulty.

Combat Maneuvers: A character can use Piloting to perform aggressive or evasive maneuvers in a fight — ramming a target, breaking away from a pursuer, or positioning to give allies a firing advantage. These are typically opposed checks or checks against a fixed difficulty set by the GM based on the target's speed and maneuverability.

Sample Combat Maneuver difficulties:

- Ram a stationary or slow-moving target: 2
- Execute a precise intercept or blocking maneuver: 4
- Perform a high-speed attack run through hostile fire: 6
- Execute a maneuver against a vastly more agile vehicle: 8

Ritual (T; WIL + ATT)

The Ritual skill represents a character's command of magic as a natural, learnable force. Ritual magic is systematic and reproducible — its effects are well-scoped and knowable, and a sufficiently skilled practitioner can analyze an unfamiliar working and reverse-engineer it almost like a piece of technology. Ritual is primarily the skill of Arcane magic, and applies to Psychic magic of a structural or physical nature, such as the Space and Time domains.

Where Ritual treats magic as a force to be understood and controlled, Occultism deals with the ineffable: spirits, divine powers, and forces that do not follow predictable rules. Characters trained in Eerie may find it easier to sense the presence and nature of active ritual effects.

Note that alchemical recipes, while mechanically similar to rituals, use the Alchemy skill exclusively — Ritual does not apply to them (see *Rituals and Recipes*).

Checks

Casting Rituals: The primary use of the Ritual skill is the casting of rituals, for which see the full rules in *Rituals and Recipes*. Ritual applies to any non-alchemical ritual that draws on Arcane or structurally-oriented Psychic magic.

Because ritual magic is well-understood and bounded, a failed Ritual check typically results in nothing happening and the consumption of reagents — not in uncontrolled or catastrophic effects.

Identifying & Reading Magic: A character trained in Ritual can examine an active magical effect, a ritual circle, or an arcane inscription and attempt to understand what it does. The difficulty depends on the complexity of the working and how well it has been obscured.

Sample Identifying difficulties:

- Identify the school or broad domain of an active magical effect: 2
- Determine the function and approximate power of a ritual circle: 4
- Fully analyze a complex or layered arcane working: 6
- Decode a deliberately obfuscated or alien magical inscription: 8

Shop (T; DEX + STR)

The Shop skill covers the creation, repair, and modification of physical objects — from welding and machining to woodworking, leatherworking, and general fabrication. DEX provides the precision for fine work; STR handles the heavy labour of raw construction. A character trained in Shop is equally at home in a forge or a field workshop, and can turn salvaged materials into functional equipment given enough time and tools.

Electronics and Magitek are natural complements when working on devices with technical or magical components; Access benefits from Shop when physical bypass work — cutting, breaking, or fabricating parts — is required.

Checks

Repair: A character can use Shop to restore damaged or broken physical items to working order. The difficulty depends on the severity of the damage and the complexity of the object.

Sample Repair difficulties:

- Repair a simple tool or piece of equipment: 2
- Restore a damaged weapon or piece of armour: 4
- Rebuild a complex mechanical device from partial components: 6
- Reconstruct a badly damaged or intricate item with missing parts: 8

Fabrication: A character can use Shop to create new items from raw or salvaged materials. Working from known plans or patterns reduces the difficulty; improvising a design or working without proper tools increases it.

Sample Fabrication difficulties:

- Fabricate a simple tool or fitting: 2
- Craft a functional weapon or piece of armour: 4
- Construct a complex mechanical assembly: 6
- Produce a masterwork item requiring exceptional skill and materials: 9

Appraisal: A character trained in Shop can assess the quality, provenance, and condition of physical objects. This covers identifying fine craftsmanship, detecting structural flaws, and recognizing forgeries or unusual construction techniques.

Sample Appraisal difficulties:

- Assess the general quality of a common item: 2
- Identify a notable flaw or point of weakness in a well-made object: 4
- Determine the origin or maker of an unusual or deliberately disguised item: 6
- Detect a masterfully executed forgery: 8

Rituals and Recipes

In the mystical realms of Ashen, the casting of rituals is an intricate and powerful art. To bring forth the desired magical effects, players must navigate the complexities of difficulty, magnitude, and available power. Alchemical recipes function as rituals do, so for the purposes of the following rules, "rituals" includes them.

The rules for rituals are as follows:

1. Difficulty and Magnitude

A ritual is defined by two essential factors: difficulty and magnitude.

Difficulty: This represents the base challenge level of the ritual, reflecting the innate complexity of the magical task at hand.

Magnitude: The magnitude sets the minimum total power value required to successfully cast the ritual. Players can harness power from various sources, including reagents, implements, locations, or unique circumstances like magical terrain or alchemical laboratories.

2. Power Management

Every point of available power beyond the ritual's magnitude is a boon to the caster. Surplus power can be derived from a variety of sources and contributes to making the ritual easier.

Power Sources: Reagents, implements, locations, and circumstantial factors all contribute to the available power pool.

Difficulty Reduction: For each point of available power exceeding the ritual's magnitude, the difficulty of the ritual is reduced by 1, down to the tier of the ritual.

3. Skill Checks

Executing a ritual requires a careful balance of knowledge, skill, and finesse. Players can employ one of the following skills for the ritual's casting: Ritual, Occultism, or Alchemy. The appropriate skill depends on the nature of the ritual.

4. Casting and Success Conditions

Success hinges on the outcome of a skill check against the adjusted difficulty.

Success: If the result of the check equals or exceeds the adjusted difficulty, the ritual is successful. The desired magical effects manifest as intended.

Failure: Should the skill check fall short, the ritual fails. Despite the failure, consumable power sources like reagents are still expended. Depending on the ritual, there may be additional consequences.

5. Consequences of Failure

Failing a ritual doesn't come without repercussions. In addition to the consumption of consumables, other consequences may unfold, varying based on the specific nature of the ritual. Players should be prepared for the unexpected in the arcane arts.

Ritual List

Rite of Opening

Tier 1 Ritual

With the final twist of your implement, you open a path to your destination.

Skill: Ritual

Difficulty: 3, *Magnitude:* 3

Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 100)

Casting Time: 5 minutes

Effect: The Rite of Opening creates a physical path between you and a location of your choosing whose approximate whereabouts are known to you. The Rite is potentially destructive but never creative: it can tear down barriers, but it cannot construct bridges. When opening artificial obstacles like locked doors, the rite may open simple obstacles non-destructively, but may simply unhinge a door equipped with a complex magical lock. It can burrow or blast through natural barriers that are sufficiently thin.

Difficulty Modifiers: Target guarded by magical barriers: +(tier of barrier) per barrier. Target behind rock or earth: +2 per meter. Target behind steel: +2 per 10 cm. Target known to within <10 m accuracy: +2. Target known to within <50 m: +5. Target >30 m away: +1 per 10 m.

Ward of Alarm

Tier 1 Ritual

Skill: Ritual

Difficulty: 3, *Magnitude:* 2

Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 50)

Casting Time: 10 minutes

Effect: You inscribe a ward on a doorway, window, or area up to Burst 3. For the next 8 hours, if any creature of size 1 or larger crosses the ward, the caster is immediately alerted, even if asleep. The alert is mental and silent — only the caster perceives it. The ward is invisible but can be detected with Eerie (difficulty 4).

Failure: The ward is created but is unstable — it triggers once randomly during the duration, then fails.

Arcane Lock

Tier 2 Ritual

Skill: Ritual

Difficulty: 5, *Magnitude:* 4

Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 300)

Casting Time: 10 minutes

Effect: You seal a door, chest, window, or other closeable object with arcane energy. The lock can only be opened by the caster, by a creature they designate during casting, or by a successful Rite of Opening or Magitek check against a difficulty equal to the caster's casting check result. The lock persists until dispelled or broken.

Failure: The lock is created but is brittle — its effective difficulty is halved.

Circle of Binding

Tier 3 Ritual

Skill: Ritual

Difficulty: 7, *Magnitude:* 6

Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 1000)

Casting Time: 30 minutes

Effect: You inscribe a circle of binding on a surface up to 3 squares in diameter. Any summoned, extraplanar, or undead creature that enters or is summoned into the circle cannot leave it by any means (including teleportation) unless the circle is physically broken or the creature succeeds on a D8 Potential check at the start of each of its turns. The circle persists for 24 hours or until broken.

Failure: The circle appears complete but has a hidden flaw. The first creature bound in it may attempt to escape with a D4 Potential check instead.

Planar Gate

Tier 5 Ritual

Skill: Ritual

Difficulty: 12, *Magnitude:* 11

Aspects: Key, Mist

Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 8000) + Essence (5 Strain)

Casting Time: 8 hours

Effect: You tear open a portal to another plane of existence. The portal is a circle up to 3 squares in diameter and remains open for 1 minute per success on the casting check. Creatures can pass through in both directions. The caster may close the portal early as a free action. The destination must be a plane the caster has visited or possesses a fragment of (a physical object originating from that plane).

Failure: The portal opens to an unintended location on the target plane, or to the wrong plane entirely. The caster takes an additional 5 Strain.

Resurrection Rite

Tier 5 Ritual

Skill: Ritual

Difficulty: 11, *Magnitude:* 10

Aspects: Scarab

Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 10000) + Essence (8 Strain)

Casting Time: 12 hours

Effect: You perform a lengthy rite that revives all dead creatures within the ritual circle at no EP cost to them. Each revived creature returns with full HP and full Focus, with all status conditions removed. This ritual can revive creatures whose remains have been destroyed, as long as a personal belonging or fragment of the creature is available as a focus. Uniquely, this ritual can also restore mortal creatures to life — an effect not otherwise available through any power or prayer. The ritual cannot revive creatures affected by effects that prevent revival (such as Noble Eightfold Blade's death effect).

Failure: The ritual fails. Components are consumed. Creatures remain dead. If the check fails by 5 or more, a hostile entity may be drawn to the ritual site.

Enchantment Rituals

The following rituals apply enchantments to items (see *Enchantments* in the Equipment chapter). In each case, the listed difficulty is the base; half the tier of the target item (rounded up) is added to the difficulty. For example, applying Moontouched (base difficulty 3) to a tier 5 weapon requires a difficulty 6 check. If the item already has an enchantment in the slot being used, replacing it increases the difficulty by 2.

Enchant Weapon — Moontouched

Tier 2 Ritual

Skill: Ritual

Difficulty: 3 + half item tier, *Magnitude:* 4

Sacrifice: 4 Magnitude (moonstone dust or similar lunar reagent)

Casting Time: 4 hours

Effect: You imbue a weapon with captured moonlight. On a successful hit, the target is surrounded by a halo of moonlight: attacks against it gain a +2 bonus and it cannot benefit from invisibility until the end of the wielder's next turn.

Failure: The enchantment is unstable — it functions normally but fades after 1d6 encounters.

Enchant Weapon — Spacerender

Tier 3 Ritual

Skill: Ritual

Difficulty: 5 + half item tier, *Magnitude:* 6

Sacrifice: 6 Magnitude (void essence or spatial reagent)

Casting Time: 8 hours

Effect: You fold the space around a melee weapon, extending its effective reach. The weapon gains Reach 2.

Failure: The spatial fold is unstable. The weapon gains Reach 2, but on any attack roll where no successes are scored, the enchantment collapses and must be reapplied.

Enchant Armor — Lightbender

Tier 2 Ritual

Skill: Ritual

Difficulty: 3 + half item tier, *Magnitude:* 4

Sacrifice: 4 Magnitude (prismatic glass or light-aspected reagent)

Casting Time: 4 hours

Effect: You treat a piece of armor to bend light around its wearer. When the wearer is fighting in bright light, the armor's Evasion bonus increases by 1.

Failure: The treatment is imprecise — the Evasion bonus applies, but the armor glows faintly, imposing a -2d penalty on Subterfuge checks in darkness.

Enchant Armor — Deflecting

Tier 3 Ritual

Skill: Ritual

Difficulty: 5 + half item tier, *Magnitude:* 6

Sacrifice: 6 Magnitude (warding sigils or abjuration reagent)

Casting Time: 6 hours

Effect: You inscribe magical deflection patterns onto a piece of armor. When the wearer is targeted by an area-effect spell or magical ability, the armor grants light cover against that effect.

Failure: The sigils are flawed — the deflection works, but each time it activates there is a 1-in-6 chance the sigils burn out permanently.

Enchant Implement — Resonating

Tier 4 Ritual

Skill: Ritual
Difficulty: 7 + half item tier, *Magnitude:* 8
Sacrifice: 8 Magnitude (harmonic crystal or resonance reagent)
Casting Time: 12 hours
Effect: You attune a catalyst or weapon to resonate with the caster's magical frequency. For every spell channeled through the implement on a given turn, its casting bonuses increase by 1, up to a maximum of its base bonus + 3.
Failure: The resonance is erratic — the bonus increases as normal but resets to 0 at the start of each round instead of persisting.

Enchant Implement — Manabind

Tier 5 Ritual

Skill: Ritual
Difficulty: 9 + half item tier, *Magnitude:* 10
Sacrifice: 10 Magnitude (essence of a counterspell or antimagic reagent)
Casting Time: 1 day
Effect: You bind an implement with counter-magical properties. The implement grants a +6 bonus to counterspelling. If used to perform a successful counterspell, the wielder recovers Focus equal to the cost of the countered spell.
Failure: The binding is incomplete — the counterspell bonus is only +3, and Focus recovery is halved (round down).

Occultism Ritual List

Augury

Tier 1 Ritual

Skill: Occultism
Difficulty: 4, *Magnitude:* 2
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 50)
Casting Time: 10 minutes
Effect: You perform a divination to glimpse the near future. Ask the GM one question about a specific course of action you plan to take within the next hour. The GM answers with one of: Weal (good outcome), Woe (bad outcome), Weal and Woe (mixed), or Nothing (no significant consequence). The GM is not required to reveal details — only the general tenor of the outcome.
Failure: The augury gives a misleading answer (GM's choice).

Scrying

Tier 3 Ritual

Skill: Occultism
Difficulty: 7, *Magnitude:* 6
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 800)
Casting Time: 30 minutes
Effect: You observe a creature or location remotely. You must have either met the target creature, visited the target location, or possess an object closely associated with either. On success, you perceive the target's immediate surroundings (sight and sound) for up to 10 minutes. The target may sense the scrying with a D6 Potential check — on success, they know they are being observed and by whom.
Difficulty Modifiers: Target possesses anti-scrying wards: +(tier of ward). Target is on another plane: +4. You possess a piece of the target (hair, belonging): -2.
Failure: The scrying fails and the target is automatically alerted to the attempt.

Commune

Tier 4 Ritual

Skill: Occultism
Difficulty: 10, *Magnitude:* 9
Aspects: Moon
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 2000) + Essence (3 Strain)
Casting Time: 2 hours
Effect: You open a channel of communication with an otherworldly entity — a god, a powerful spirit, or an echo of a dead deity. You may ask up to three questions, which the entity answers truthfully but not necessarily completely. The entity may demand a price for its knowledge (additional Essence, a future favor, or information in return). The nature of the entity contacted depends on the circumstances and location of the ritual.
Failure: The channel opens but connects to an unintended entity. The entity may lie, demand payment, or be hostile.

Fate Unraveling

Tier 6 Ritual

Skill: Occultism
Difficulty: 14, *Magnitude:* 14
Aspects: Moon, Skull
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 20000) + Essence (10 Strain) + Influence (Skull 8, Moon 6)
Casting Time: 1 day
Effect: You unravel the threads of fate surrounding one subject — a person, an object, an event, or a place. The GM reveals the complete truth about the subject: its history, its current state, its connections, and its most likely future. This information is absolute and cannot be obscured by any magic short of divine intervention. The caster experiences the revelation as a trance-vision lasting several hours.
Failure: The revelation is partial and fragmented. The caster takes the full Strain and Influence cost. The caster is Dazed for 24 hours from the psychic backlash.

Occultism Enchantment Rituals

As with the Ritual enchantments above, half the tier of the target item (rounded up) is added to the base difficulty. Replacing an existing enchantment increases the difficulty by 2.

Enchant Weapon — Bloodthirst

Tier 2 Ritual

Skill: Occultism
Difficulty: 3 + half item tier, *Magnitude:* 4
Sacrifice: 4 Magnitude (fresh blood of a predatory creature)
Casting Time: 4 hours
Effect: You awaken a hunger for blood in a weapon. If the weapon successfully deals damage to a living target, the wielder gains a +2 bonus to the next attack with the weapon.
Failure: The hunger is indiscriminate — the bonus applies, but the wielder must also make a D4 Grit check after each combat or attack the nearest living creature (friend or foe) once.

Enchant Weapon — Cursebringer

Tier 4 Ritual

Skill: Occultism
Difficulty: 7 + half item tier, *Magnitude:* 8
Aspects: Skull
Sacrifice: 8 Magnitude (cursed relic or hexed remains) + Essence (2 Strain)
Casting Time: 12 hours
Effect: You bind a malevolent curse into a weapon. On a successful hit that deals damage, the target must make a Potential save at difficulty equal to the weapon's tier + 2. On failure, the target takes a -2 curse penalty to all of its rolls (save ends).
Failure: The curse is bound but unstable — it functions normally, but each time it activates, the wielder takes 1 Strain.

Enchant Weapon — Souldrinker

Tier 4 Ritual

Skill: Occultism
Difficulty: 7 + half item tier, *Magnitude:* 8
Aspects: Skull
Sacrifice: 8 Magnitude (soul gem or essence of the dying) + Essence (3 Strain)
Casting Time: 12 hours
Effect: You bind the weapon with soul-draining properties. On a successful hit that deals damage, the target must make a Potential save at difficulty equal to the weapon's tier + 2. On failure, the target loses 1 EP and Focus equal to 3 × the weapon's tier.
Failure: The drain is reversed — on a failed save, the target loses the EP and Focus as normal, but the wielder also loses Focus equal to the weapon's tier.

Alchemical Recipe List

Healing Potion

Tier 1 Ritual

Skill: Alchemy
Difficulty: 3, *Magnitude:* 2
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 150)
Casting Time: 10 minutes
Effect: You brew a potion that restores HP equal to 100% of the catalyst used in its creation. The potion can be consumed as a 1 AP action. Potions expire after one week.
Failure: The potion is inert — it has no effect but is otherwise harmless.

Antidote

Tier 1 Ritual

Skill: Alchemy
Difficulty: 3, *Magnitude:* 2
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 100)
Casting Time: 10 minutes
Effect: You brew a potion that removes the Poisoned condition from the drinker. If the poison is of a tier higher than this recipe's tier, the difficulty increases by 2 per tier difference. The antidote can be consumed as a 1 AP action.
Failure: The antidote is ineffective.

Stimulant Draft

Tier 2 Ritual

Skill: Alchemy
Difficulty: 5, *Magnitude:* 4
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 300)
Casting Time: 20 minutes
Effect: You brew a stimulant that sharpens the drinker's abilities. When consumed (1 AP action), the drinker chooses one skill. They gain +2d on checks with that skill for 1 hour. A creature cannot benefit from more than one stimulant at a time; consuming a second replaces the first.
Failure: The stimulant works but inflicts a -1d penalty on all other skills for its duration.

Weapon Oil

Tier 2 Ritual

Skill: Alchemy
Difficulty: 5, *Magnitude:* 4
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 400)
Casting Time: 15 minutes
Effect: You create an oil that can be applied to a weapon (1 AP action). The weapon gains a damage type of your choice (Thermal, Cold, Electric, or Acid) for 1 encounter. While active, the weapon's damage is treated as that type for the purposes of resistances and vulnerabilities. Only one oil can be active on a weapon at a time.
Failure: The oil is unstable — it lasts only 3 rounds instead of 1 encounter.

Paralytic Poison

Tier 3 Ritual

Skill: Alchemy

Difficulty: 7, *Magnitude:* 6
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 800)
Casting Time: 30 minutes
Effect: You create a dose of paralytic poison (3 applications). The poison can be applied to a weapon (1 AP action) or slipped into food/drink. On the next hit (or when ingested), the target must pass a D6 Stamina check or be Stilled (save ends). Whether the save succeeds or fails, the application is consumed.
Failure: The poison is weak — the resist DC is reduced to D4.

Elixir of Fortitude

Tier 4 Ritual

Skill: Alchemy
Difficulty: 9, *Magnitude:* 8
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 2500)
Casting Time: 1 hour
Effect: You brew a powerful protective elixir. When consumed (1 AP action), the drinker gains +3 Armor and +3 Ward for 1 encounter. Additionally, the drinker gains +2d on Stamina resistance checks for the duration. A creature cannot benefit from more than one elixir at a time.
Failure: The elixir provides only +1 Armor and +1 Ward, and its duration is halved.

Philosopher's Reagent

Tier 5 Ritual

Skill: Alchemy
Difficulty: 12, *Magnitude:* 10
Aspects: Mist, Forge
Sacrifice: Components (#feathers 6000) + Essence (5 EP)
Casting Time: 8 hours
Effect: You create a single universal reagent of extraordinary purity, worth 8 Magnitude for the purpose of any ritual. This exceeds the magnitude of any readily obtainable reagent (capped at 6 for standard materials). The Philosopher's Reagent does not expire and can provide any single aspect at up to magnitude 4 when used as Influence.
Failure: The reagent is created but is flawed — it is worth only 5 Magnitude and cannot provide aspect Influence.

Alchemical Enchantment Recipes

Silver a Weapon

Tier 1 Ritual

Skill: Alchemy
Difficulty: 2 + half item tier, *Magnitude:* 2
Sacrifice: 2 Magnitude (alchemical silver)
Casting Time: 2 hours
Effect: You coat a weapon in alchemical silver through a chemical bonding process. The weapon gains the Silvered keyword: it bypasses immunity or resistance to non-silvered weapons, and deals bonus damage to undead creatures equal to 50% of its base damage. Silvering is permanent but can be stripped by re-treating the weapon with a different material. This recipe can alternatively be performed as a Shop check at the same difficulty.
Failure: The silver coating is thin and uneven — it functions but wears off after 1d6 encounters.

Advances

What is an advance?

Advances represent unique skills and talents your character gains or remembers as they gain experience. They usually affect primarily a character's abilities in combat, although they may also have uses during exploration.

How to unlock advances

Advances are unlocked by spending experience points (XP) during downtime. To unlock an advance, you must meet its prerequisites (if any) and pay the XP cost listed in its entry. Once unlocked, an advance is permanent — you benefit from it for the rest of the campaign.

Characters gain XP from completing missions, overcoming challenges, and achieving story milestones, as determined by the GM.

Advance Lists

Arcane

SPELL MEMORY I — **TIER 1 (150 XP)**

ARCANE POWER

Prerequisites: None — 0 HP, 2 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 1 spells. You can prepare up to one Tier 1 spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 1 spell slot each time.

SPELL MEMORY II — **TIER 2 (250 XP)**

Prerequisites: Spell Memory I — 0 HP, 2 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 2 spells. You gain a Tier 2 spell slot with which you can prepare one Tier 2 or lower spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 2 slot each time.

SPELL MEMORY III — **TIER 3 (375 XP)**

Prerequisites: Spell Memory II, Arcane 8 — 1 HP, 2 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 3 spells. You gain a Tier 3 spell slot with which you can prepare one Tier 3 or lower spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 3 slot each time.

SPELL MEMORY IV — TIER 4 (500 XP)

Prerequisites: Spell Memory III — 1 HP, 4 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 4 spells. You gain a Tier 4 spell slot with which you can prepare one Tier 4 or lower spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 4 slot each time.

SPELL MEMORY V — TIER 5 (750 XP)

Prerequisites: Spell Memory IV, Arcane 10 — 2 HP, 5 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 5 spells. You gain a Tier 5 spell slot with which you can prepare one Tier 5 or lower spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 5 slot each time.

SPELL MEMORY VI — TIER 6 (1100 XP)

Prerequisites: Spell Memory V, Arcane 12 — 3 HP, 8 FP

You gain the ability to cast Tier 6 spells. You gain a Tier 6 spell slot with which you can prepare one Tier 6 or lower spell each time you memorize spells for the day. You may take this advance multiple times, adding a new Tier 6 slot each time.

AMBIENT POWER — TIER 3 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Arcane 8 — 1 HP, 4 FP

You gain a +3 bonus to your Arcane rolls to cast every spell beyond the first one on your turn.

ARCANE WELLSPRING — TIER 4 (750 XP)

Prerequisites: Arcane 10, Ambient Power — 2 HP, 5 FP

The focus cost of every spell you cast on your turn beyond the first one is reduced by one quarter.

MANA FLOW — TIER 5 (1100 XP)

Prerequisites: Arcane 12, Ambient Power — 3 HP, 8 FP

The AP cost of every spell you cast on your turn beyond the first one is reduced by 1, to a minimum of 1.

Command

WARLOCK ACOLYTE — TIER 1 (200 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 1 HP, 1 FP

While you are controlling a summoned creature, you gain one extra AP per round. This AP can only be spent to perform a move action.

RALLYING PRESENCE — TIER 1 (200 XP)

Prerequisites: Command 3 — 2 HP, 0 FP

Allies within 5 squares of you gain +1d on saving throws against fear and morale effects. This bonus is lost if you are unconscious or Stunned.

TACTICAL COORDINATION — TIER 2 (350 XP)

Prerequisites: Command 5, Rallying Presence — 2 HP, 2 FP

Once per round, when an ally within 10 squares hits with an attack, you may spend a reaction to grant a different ally within 10 squares a free shift of 2 squares.

IRON AUTHORITY — TIER 3 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Command 7 — 3 HP, 3 FP

When you use a Command power that targets enemies, you may add +2d to the casting check. Additionally, enemies that fail a resistance check against your Command powers take a −1d penalty on their next saving throw against the effect.

WARMASTER — TIER 4 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Command 9, Tactical Coordination, Iron Authority — 5 HP, 4 FP

At the start of each round, choose one ally within 10 squares. That ally gains +1 AP this round. You may not choose the same ally in consecutive rounds.

Dodge

ACTION ROLL — TIER 3 (500 XP)

Prerequisites: Dodge 7 — 3 HP, 2 FP

Your dive range is increased from 3 to 5 squares.

PARTING STRIKE — TIER 2 (350 XP)

Prerequisites: Dodge 5, Martial 5 — 3 HP, 0 FP

When you disengage, you may make a melee attack against an adjacent target. This attack cannot hit more than once.

VAULT — TIER 1 (150 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 2 HP, 0 FP

You can pass through squares occupied by enemy creatures as if they were difficult terrain.

OUTMANEUVER — TIER 1 (200 XP)

Prerequisites: Press the Advantage, Vault — 1 HP, 1 FP

When an enemy misses you with a melee attack, you can immediately move through its space as a free action, ending on the other side of it. While neither you nor that enemy perform any further actions, you have combat advantage against it.

BULLET TIME — TIER 4 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 6 HP, 4 FP

When targeted by a single-target ranged attack, you can spend a reaction to make a Dodge resist. Add half the successes to your Evasion for the purposes of calculating hits for this attack only.

Grit

DAUNTLESS — TIER 2 (500 XP)

Prerequisites: Grit 5 — 3 HP, 2 FP

You are immune to fear effects. If you are within the area of an enduring fear-inducing effect (such as an *Aura of Fear*), you gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls.

LORD OF MYSELF — TIER 3 (600 XP)

Prerequisites: Grit 7 — 3 HP, 3 FP

You are immune to being dominated or charmed.

TENACITY — TIER 3 (700 XP)

Prerequisites: Grit 8 — 4 HP, 3 FP

You can always revive on your next turn after dying, even if you died in the same round. Effects that prevent revival have no effect on you.

WILL OF STEEL — TIER 5 (1100 XP)

Prerequisites: Grit 10, x — 7 HP, 4 FP

When an attack would reduce you to 0 Health: you may make a D6 Grit resist; on success, you survive with 1 Health. Every time you invoke this power per scene, the Grit difficulty increases by 2.

WILL TRIUMPHANT — TIER 6 (1800 XP)

Prerequisites: Grit total 12, Grit base 5, Will of Steel — 12 HP, 6 FP

Reviving costs you 4 instead of 5 EP.

Initiative

SWIFT AS LIGHTNING — TIER 2 (350 XP)

Prerequisites: Initiative 6 — 1 HP, 2 FP

During your first turn, you may treat all combatants that have not yet acted as *dazed*.

SEIZE THE MOMENT — TIER 3 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Initiative 8 — 2 HP, 3 FP

When you act before all other combatants do, you gain 2 extra AP on your first turn.

RIPOSTE — TIER 1 (150 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 1 HP, 0 FP

If an enemy within your reach misses you with a melee attack: as a reaction, you can immediately make an attack against that enemy with your equipped melee weapon.

PRESS THE ADVANTAGE — TIER 1 (200 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 2 HP, 0 FP

You become adept at exploiting moments of inattentiveness. When you have combat advantage against a creature, your attacks and powers against that target have a +2 bonus to hit; additionally, your attacks against that target gain extra AP equal to your tier. You gain combat advantage against a creature when you are totally obscured from it, or when you are in a flanking position.

LIGHTNING REFLEXES — TIER 3 (600 XP)

Prerequisites: Initiative 7, at least two Reaction advances — 3 HP, 3 FP

You may take up to two reactions per round.

Marksmanship

HEAVY GUNNER — TIER 3 (500 XP)

Prerequisites: Marksmanship 6, Stamina 5 — 5 HP, 0 FP

Wielding heavy weapons is second nature to you. You can brace your weapon as a free action.

Martial

EXPLOIT (TIER 1) — TIER 1 (250 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 0 HP, 2 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 1 Exploit. You learn one Tier 1 Exploit of your choice.

PURSUIT — TIER 1 (250 XP)

Prerequisites: Opportunity Attack — 2 HP, 1 FP

When you use your opportunity attack reaction, after the attack resolves, you can immediately move up to your speed in the direction of the triggering enemy. You must end your move adjacent to the triggering enemy if possible.

EXPLOIT (TIER 2) — TIER 2 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 1 Exploit — 2 HP, 4 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 2 Exploit. You learn one Tier 2 Exploit of your choice.

WEAPON FOCUS — TIER 2 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 2 HP, 1 FP

Pick a class of melee weapon (such as sword, hammer, or axe). All attack rolls with a weapon of that type gain a +2 bonus. You may take this advance multiple times, but each one must apply to a different weapon type.

MONKEY GRIP — TIER 2 (375 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 4 HP, 0 FP

You can wield a two-handed weapon in one hand. When you do so, you gain a −2 penalty to attack rolls with that weapon.

LOTUS LEAF KATA — TIER 2 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: Lotus Art: Sage's Stance, Martial 5, Dodge 5 — 2 HP, 1 FP

While in *Sage's Stance*, you gain a +3 bonus to Parry checks.

EXPLOIT (TIER 3) — TIER 3 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 2 Exploit — 4 HP, 6 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 3 Exploit. You learn one Tier 3 Exploit of your choice.

EXPLOIT (TIER 4) — TIER 4 (1850 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 3 Exploit — 9 HP, 9 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 4 Exploit. You learn one Tier 4 Exploit of your choice.

EXPLOIT (TIER 5) — TIER 5 (2500 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 4 Exploit — 12 HP, 13 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 5 Exploit. You learn one Tier 5 Exploit of your choice.

EXPLOIT (TIER 6) — TIER 6 (3500 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 5 Exploit — 15 HP, 20 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 6 Exploit. You learn one Tier 6 Exploit of your choice.

Potential

LEYLINE ATTUNEMENT — TIER 1 (200 XP)

Prerequisites: Potential 3 — 0 HP, 2 FP

You can sense the presence and school of magical effects within 10 squares. Additionally, your catalyst's focus increment is reduced by 1 (minimum 1).

ARCANE SMOOTHING — TIER 2 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: Potential 5, any casting Characteristic 5 — 0 HP, 3 FP

You are an adept wielder of Catalysts. You may reduce the focus increment of any Catalyst you wield by one-half its tier, rounding up.

PARMA ARCANA — TIER 3 (600 XP)

Prerequisites: Potential 6 — 3 HP, 3 FP

You gain a resistance to enemy magic. When targeted by a spell or magical ability, you may roll a Potential resist with difficulty equal to the casting check. On success: you are unaffected by the spell.

WELLSPRING — TIER 4 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Potential 9, Arcane Smoothing — 2 HP, 6 FP

Your connection to ambient magical energy deepens. Allies within 5 squares of you reduce the increment cost of their spells and powers by 1 (minimum 1). This does not stack with other sources of increment reduction.

Psychic

QUICKEN MAGIC — TIER 1 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 0 HP, 3 FP

When you manifest a psychic power that costs 2 or more AP, you can expend one additional increment of focus to reduce the AP cost of that power by 1.

MAXIMIZE MAGIC — TIER 1 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 0 HP, 3 FP

When you manifest a psychic power, you can expend one additional increment of focus to use the maximum value for each die roll to determine the effects or duration of the power instead of rolling.

TELEPATHY — TIER 1 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 1 HP, 2 FP

You can communicate telepathically with creatures within 30 squares that you can see. Neither party requires a common spoken language.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 1) — TIER 1 (250 XP)

Prerequisites: None — 1 HP, 2 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 1 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 1 Psychic power of your choice.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 2) — TIER 2 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 1 Psychic power — 1 HP, 5 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 2 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 2 Psychic power of your choice.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 3) — TIER 3 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 2 Psychic power — 3 HP, 7 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 3 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 3 Psychic power of your choice.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 4) — TIER 4 (1850 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 3 Psychic power — 5 HP, 13 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 4 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 4 Psychic power of your choice.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 5) — TIER 5 (2500 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 4 Psychic power — 7 HP, 18 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 5 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 5 Psychic power of your choice.

DISCIPLINE (TIER 6) — TIER 6 (3500 XP)

Prerequisites: Any Tier 5 Psychic power — 10 HP, 25 FP

This advance stands in for learning any Tier 6 Psychic power. You learn one Tier 6 Psychic power of your choice.

Speed

FLEET OF FOOT — TIER 1 (150 XP)

Prerequisites: Speed 3 — 1 HP, 1 FP

Your base Movement Speed increases by 2.

EVASIVE SPRINT — TIER 2 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: Speed 5, Fleet of Foot — 2 HP, 1 FP

When you use the Dash action, you do not provoke opportunity attacks for the rest of your turn.

LIGHTNING DASH — TIER 3 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Speed 7, Evasive Sprint — 3 HP, 2 FP

Once per encounter, you may take a move action as a free action at the start of your turn.

IMPOSSIBLE SWIFTNESS — TIER 4 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Speed 9, Lightning Dash — 4 HP, 3 FP

Your base Movement Speed increases by an additional 3 (stacks with Fleet of Foot). You may move through difficult terrain at normal speed.

Stamina

CONDITIONING — TIER 1 (150 XP)

Prerequisites: Strength 2, Endurance 2 — 2 HP, 0 FP

Treat the bulk of all armor as 1 lower than it actually is (subject to category minimums).

IRON CONSTITUTION — TIER 2 (300 XP)

Prerequisites: Stamina 4, Conditioning — 4 HP, 0 FP

You gain +1d on all Endurance checks and saving throws against Poisoned, Diseased, and Exhausted conditions.

POWERED PROFICIENCY — TIER 3 (550 XP)

Prerequisites: Conditioning, Stamina 6 — 4 HP, 1 FP

You gain the ability to use powered armor in powered mode. While wearing powered armor, you benefit from all your advances that improve your wearing of armor.

UNSTOPPABLE — TIER 4 (1000 XP)

Prerequisites: Stamina 9, Iron Constitution — 8 HP, 0 FP

Once per encounter, when you would be reduced to 0 HP, you are instead reduced to 1 HP. Additionally, you are immune to the Stunned condition from non-magical sources.

Magic and Powers

Apart from their wits, their skill and their weapons, Ashen characters also have at their disposal mystical abilities to defend against a hostile world. Whether they are magical spells, esoteric martial disciplines or psychic manipulations, collectively these abilities are referred to as Powers.

Reading Powers

Powers come in many different types, and the effects they can manifest are accordingly diverse. To keep the complexity manageable, Power entries are formatted in a structured way.

Header

Every power starts with a header that lists the power's name, type and rank, as well as any keywords the power has.

Flavor Text

The next line in the power describes what the power does from the perspective of the game world.

Prerequisites

The first entry in the power block proper describes what conditions a character must fulfill to be able to invoke the power. For example, a power might require a specific type of weapon

Range

This entry describes what the power affects and at what range it does so. Ranges are expressed in the form [target] [within [range][; [special]]], where *target* is either a number of valid targets and their description or an area, *range* expresses the distance from the user that the power can be manifested in (if any) and *special* expresses any special modifiers to the range.

Targets can be creatures, allies, enemies or objects. If all kinds of entities can be targeted, the power will simply refer to *targets*.

Area targets are referred to as *bursts*, *cones* or *lines*. See the section *area targets* for more details.

Special modifiers mostly apply when the target is an area, but the power does not affect everything inside the area indiscriminately. For example, a healing spell may have a range line of "Burst 2 within 12; all allies in burst", indicating that only allies within its area target are affected.

Difficulty

Most powers require that the user pass a particular characteristic check to cause the power to take effect. For example, arcane spells require an Arcane check to cast. Such powers will have the relevant ability and the check difficulty noted on this line. Some powers cannot fail: for such powers, the difficulty line reads *unerring*. Yet other powers inherently require a check as part of resolving their effect; for example, martial powers that cause the user to make a weapon attack. Such powers may lack a difficulty line altogether.

Cost

Most powers also have a focus cost that a character must spend to use the power. Focus costs can be expressed in one of two ways: a power that depends on a weapon or catalyst to use will have its cost expressed in *increments*. Each increment costs an amount of Focus Points equal to the wielded implement's focus increment value. For example, a power costing 2 increments used through a catalyst with a focus increment of 8 would cost 16 FP. Powers that do not require any implement to use, such as command powers, will instead have a fixed cost in focus points. A character who wishes to use a power that has a focus cost must have enough focus to use the power. The focus cost is paid upon resolution of the effect; that is, a power that has a difficulty does not consume focus until after the relevant characteristic check has been passed.

Some powers create permanent effects that last as long as the power is kept alive. These powers will have a *sustain* cost listed after their main cost, denominated in the same unit as the main cost. For example, a power reading *Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1* would cost 2 increments of focus to use and 1 increment of focus per round thereafter to sustain.

Action Points

This line indicates how many AP a power takes to use. If a power has a sustain cost, it may also require AP to sustain. In this case, the AP cost to sustain the power will be listed after the main cost.

Resistance

This line indicates whether the target(s) can make a check to resist the effects of the power, listing the characteristic to check against as well as the check difficulty. This line only appears on powers that damage or hinder their targets.

Effect

These lines describe the actual effect of powers. For interpreting effects, see *damage* and *status conditions*.

On hit

Powers that require an attack roll to take effect or that can be resisted will have their main effect listed in an "on hit" block.

Miss

Some powers have effects even if they missed or were resisted by their target. Such effects will be listed under the "miss" block for the power, if any.

Catalyst

Some magical powers have effects that vary based on the weight category of the catalyst used to cast them. Such powers will include a line indicating the effect variation.

Types of Powers

Arcane Powers

Arcane Powers are also known as *Spells*. In order to use an Arcane power, a character must have a catalyst equipped. A spell's effects and focus cost depend on the catalyst equipped. Spells that have non-damaging effects usually become more or less powerful depending on the weight class of the catalyst equipped, with heavier catalysts being able to cast more powerful spells.

Spellcasting is an intricately formulaic affair, and due to the required accuracy in the motions and incantations it is necessary to refresh one's knowledge periodically. However, unlike most other kinds of power, the very formulaic nature of spells means that for a trained practitioner, learning (or relearning) to use a spell can be done in comparatively very little time, even starting from only a written description. For this reason, a character may learn an arbitrary

amount of spells, but they can only equip a certain number of them at a time, depending on the Arcane advances they have unlocked.

Psychic Powers

Where arcane powers represent an almost scientific approach to the working of magic, supernatural might distilled into repeatable and distributable formulas accessible to any one with the required training, psychic powers are a much older and more primal way of using magical power. It is said that psychic magic is as close as mortals may get to understanding the power wielded by the gods when they still walked the earth.

Psychic powers may be **augmented**, trading a greater difficulty to manifest the power for greater effects. This comes at a risk, as psychic powers manipulate reality itself; if a practitioner loses control over their magic, the consequences can be dire indeed.

Psychic powers require a great deal of practice and study to master, and thus require XP to be spent for each power learned.

Divine Powers

Divine powers are also known as *Prayers*. In order to use a prayer, a character must have a Reliquary equipped. A prayer's effects and focus cost depend on the reliquary equipped.

Unlike spells, characters normally do not permanently learn new prayers. Instead, the divine power contained within a reliquary temporarily gives them access to a list of prayers specific to that reliquary as long as the reliquary remains equipped.

Prayers are organized by *domain*, which represent an area of the world that a given deity has dominion over. Domains typically encompass one prayer per tier, but this may be more or fewer depending on the domain.

Divine powers may have a *tap* effect, which increases the strength of the power, but consumes favor (see *reliquaries* for an explanation of favor).

Martial Powers

Martial powers, also known as *Exploits*, are special techniques and disciplines practiced by warriors and fighters. Unlike spells, exploits do not require a catalyst; most require only a weapon to use. Exploits are learned permanently and remain available for as long as the character meets their prerequisites.

Command Powers

Command powers represent the use of authority and force of will over other creatures. They include abilities to direct summoned creatures, rally allies, and break the morale of enemies.

Marksmanship Powers

Marksmanship powers, also known as *Marksmanship Exploits*, are ranged combat techniques practiced by sharpshooters, gunslingers, and archers. Like martial exploits, they do not require a catalyst; they require a ranged weapon to use.

Spell Lists

Arcane

Tier 1

FLAMETHROWER — ARCANE SPELL 1

FIRE

Your catalyst suddenly erupts in a burst of white-hot flame to scour your foes.

Range: Cone 10
Difficulty: 2
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Dodge vs Arcane Check)
Effect: All creatures and objects within the cone take 100% Thermal damage. All flammable objects within the area catch fire. All targets struck take ongoing 3/T Thermal damage (save ends).

LIGHTNING BOLT — ARCANE SPELL 1

LIGHTNING

You raise your catalyst, and with a deafening peal of thunder, a bolt of lightning erupts from it to smite your enemies.

Range: Line 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 3)
Effect: On hit: 100% electric damage, and the target is stunned for one round.

FROST BOLT — ARCANE SPELL 1

COLD

Range: one creature within 15
Difficulty: 2
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 3)
Effect: On hit: 100% Cold damage. The target is Slowed (5) for 1 round.

CORROSIVE SPRAY — ARCANE SPELL 1

ACID

Range: Cone 5
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Dodge 3)

Effect: On hit: 100% Acid damage. The target's Armor value is reduced by 1 until the end of the encounter (stacks up to 3 times).

Tier 2

FIREBALL — ARCANE SPELL 2

FIRE

With a wave of your hand, a brilliant sphere of energy erupts from your catalyst, streaking towards your target before detonating with a dull roar.

Range: Burst 3 within 30
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Dodge 4)
Effect: On hit: All creatures and objects within the burst take 200% Thermal damage. Flammable objects within the target area catch fire; all creatures take ongoing 5/T Thermal damage (save ends).

SHATTERBLAST — ARCANE SPELL 2

FORCE

Range: one creature or object within 20
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 5; armor damage only)
Effect: On hit: 200% Force damage. Objects and constructs take double damage. If the target is wearing armor, they must pass a resistance check or their armor's value is permanently reduced by 2 (until repaired).

VENOMCLOUD — ARCANE SPELL 2

ACID ZONE

Range: Burst 2 within 20
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 2; sustain 1
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 4)
Effect: On hit: All creatures in the area take 100% Acid damage and are Poisoned (save ends). The cloud persists as a zone of light obscurement as long as you sustain it; creatures that enter or start their turn in the zone take 100% Acid damage.

Tier 3

FULMINATION — ARCANE SPELL 3

LIGHTNING

For a split second, hair stands on end and the air crackles with anticipation before a terrifying burst of electrical energy discharges from your catalyst, sending bolts of brilliant blue plasma tearing into every foe unfortunate enough to stand close to you.

Range: Close Burst 5; all enemies within burst
Difficulty: 6
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 6)
Effect: On hit: 200% electric damage, and the target is stunned for one round.
Miss: Half damage and the target is dazed instead.

ICE STORM — ARCANE SPELL 3

ICE WIND

Temperatures start to drop precipitously as a whirlwind picks up. The storm lasts only a few seconds, leaving everything covered in a sheet of glistening ice.

Range: Burst 5 within 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 6)
Effect: All targets within the range take 200% cold damage and must make a D6 Stamina resist. On failure, they are stunned for one round; afterwards, they are dazed and slowed (5) (save ends).

Tier 4

SOLAR FLARE — ARCANE SPELL 4

FIRE

You stretch out your hand and cast a wave of blazing plasma, bathing all before you in the fury of a burning star.

Range: Line 15
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes
Effect: All creatures and objects within the line take 300% Thermal damage. Additionally, all targets must make a D9 Stamina resist; on failure, they lose 3/T armor/hardness. Flammable objects and living targets reduced to 0 Health by this power turn to ash.

VITRIOLIC DELUGE — ARCANE SPELL 4

ACID

Range: Burst 3 within 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Dodge 8)
Effect: A torrent of caustic liquid pours over the area. All creatures in the area take 200% Acid damage. Their armor and Hardness are permanently reduced by 3 (until repaired). On each subsequent turn for 3 rounds, affected creatures take ongoing 100% Acid damage (save ends the ongoing damage, but not the armor reduction).
Miss: Half initial damage, ongoing 50% Acid for 1 round, no armor reduction.

Tier 5

CHAIN LIGHTNING — ARCANE SPELL 5

ELECTRIC

Range: one creature within 20; chains to up to 3 additional creatures within 5 of the previous target
Difficulty: 9
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: Stamina 8
Effect: A bolt of electricity arcs from the primary target to up to three additional targets, each of which must be within 5 squares of the previous target. Make a separate attack roll against each target. Each target struck takes 200% electric damage. A target that fails their resistance check is stunned for 1 round.
Miss: Half damage, no stun.

PETRIFICATION — ARCANE SPELL 5

TRANSMUTATION

Range: one creature within 15
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D8 Stamina
Effect: You attempt to turn the target to stone. On a failed resistance check, the target is Stilled and Slowed (5) (save ends both). If the target fails three saving throws against this effect before succeeding one, they are permanently petrified (turned to stone and unconscious) until freed by a Tier 4+ ritual.
Miss: The target is Slowed (5) for 1 round.

WALL OF FORCE — ARCANE SPELL 5

FORCE

Range: Wall 10 within 20
Difficulty: 9
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You create an impassable wall of translucent force up to 10 squares long and 5 squares high. The wall blocks all movement, projectiles, and line of effect for spells. The wall has HP equal to 300% of your catalyst's damage and Hardness 10. It lasts as long as you sustain it or until destroyed.

INFERNO — ARCANE SPELL 5

FIRE ZONE

Range: Burst 3 within 20
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 4 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Resistance: Dodge 8 (halves damage, negates Burning)
Effect: You create a zone of roaring flame. Any creature that enters the zone or starts its turn there takes 200% Thermal damage and is Burning (save ends). The zone provides total concealment and lasts as long as you sustain it.

Tier 6

DISINTEGRATION — ARCANE SPELL 6

FORCE

Range: one creature or object within 20
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Stamina
Effect: A thin green ray strikes the target. On a hit, the target takes 300% Force damage, ignoring all armor and Hardness. If this damage reduces the target to 0 HP, they and all equipment they carry are reduced to fine dust. Objects and structures targeted by this spell take double damage.
Miss: 100% Force damage, ignoring armor.

METEOR SWARM — ARCANE SPELL 6

FIRE

Range: four Burst 3 areas within 30
Difficulty: 11
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: Dodge 10

Effect: Four meteors slam into the battlefield. Each meteor targets a Burst 3 area and deals 200% Thermal damage. You may target the same or different areas; a creature caught in multiple blasts takes damage from each separately. Each impact leaves the area as difficult terrain covered in burning rubble (creatures starting their turn in the rubble take 100% Thermal ongoing damage).
Miss: Half damage from each meteor, no ongoing.

ABSOLUTE ZERO — ARCANE SPELL 6

COLD

Range: Close Burst 5
Difficulty: 11
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Stamina
Effect: You drain all heat from the area, flash-freezing everything in place. All creatures in the area take 300% Cold damage. Creatures that fail their resistance check are Stunned for 1 round, then Stilled and Slowed (5) (save ends both). The area becomes difficult terrain covered in ice for the rest of the encounter. Creatures that start their turn in the ice must pass a D6 Stamina check or fall Prone.
Miss: Half damage, Slowed (5) for 1 round.

Divine

Life Domain

MEND WOUNDS — PRAYER 1

DIVINE LIFE

Range: one creature within 15
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: The target recovers HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: The recovery increases to 200%.

VIGOR OF THE LIVING — PRAYER 2

DIVINE LIFE

Range: Close; one creature
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: The target gains temporary HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage. These temporary HP last until the end of the encounter.
Tap: The target also gains +2d to Endurance checks until the end of the encounter.

CLEANSING LIGHT — PRAYER 3

DIVINE LIFE

Range: Short; one creature
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: Remove one status condition from the target (Poisoned, Diseased, Bleeding, Burning, or Blinded). The target then recovers HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: You may remove up to two status conditions instead of one.

BREATH OF RESURRECTION — PRAYER 4

DIVINE LIFE

Range: Burst 3 centered on you; all allies
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 4 Increments + 2 EP
AP: 3 AP
Effect: All dead allies in the burst are restored to life with 1 HP and their current Focus total; then all allies in the burst heal 200% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: Dead allies revive with 50% HP and 100% Focus instead.

REGENERATION — PRAYER 5

DIVINE LIFE

Range: Close; one creature
Difficulty: 9
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 2 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: At the start of each of the target's turns, they recover HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: The regeneration increases to 200%.

CIRCLE OF VITALITY — PRAYER 6

DIVINE LIFE

Range: Burst 4 centered on you; all allies in burst
Difficulty: 11
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Effect: All allies in the area immediately recover HP equal to 300% of your catalyst's damage. Additionally, all allies gain immunity to one status condition of your choice (chosen when you cast this prayer) for 3 rounds.

Tap: Allies also gain temporary HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage and the immunity duration increases to 5 rounds.

War Domain

BATTLE CRY — PRAYER 1

DIVINE WAR

Range: one ally within 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: One ally within range gains +2d on their next attack roll and +2 to their Movement Speed until the end of their next turn.
Tap: The bonus increases to +3d on the attack roll.

SMITE THE FAITHLESS — PRAYER 2

DIVINE RADIANT WAR

Difficulty: 4
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: Your next weapon attack before the end of your turn deals an additional 100% damage as radiant. If the target is Undead or Fiend, the additional damage increases to 200%.
Tap: The attack also ignores the target's Hardness.

INSPIRING CHARGE — PRAYER 3

DIVINE WAR

Range: Burst 3 centered on you; up to 3 allies
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You and up to three allies within range each gain +1 AP and +3 Movement Speed until the end of your next turn. Each affected creature may immediately shift 1 square.
Tap: Affected allies also gain +2d on attack rolls until the end of their next turn.

DIVINE WRATH — PRAYER 4

DIVINE RADIANT WAR

Range: Burst 3 within 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D8 Stamina
Effect: You call down a pillar of radiant fury on the battlefield. All enemies in the area take 300% radiant damage. Enemies that fail their resistance check are also Dazed (save ends).
Miss: Half damage, no Dazed.

AVATAR OF WAR — PRAYER 5

DIVINE RADIANT WAR

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You or one ally within range becomes an avatar of divine battle for the duration. The avatar gains +1 AP, +3d on all attack rolls, and their weapon attacks deal an additional 100% radiant damage. While the avatar is active, enemies within 3 squares of the avatar take a -2d penalty on attack rolls.
Tap: The avatar also gains Resistance 5 to all damage types for the duration.

DIVINE STORM OF BLADES — PRAYER 6

DIVINE RADIANT WAR

Range: Burst 5 within 20
Difficulty: 11
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Stamina
Effect: Spectral weapons rain from the sky across the battlefield. All enemies in the area take 300% radiant damage. Each enemy hit must pass a resistance check or be Stunned for 1 round, then Exposed (save ends). Allies in the area are unaffected and recover HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage.
Miss: Half damage, Exposed for 1 round.

Nature Domain

ENTANGLING GROWTH — PRAYER 1

DIVINE NATURE

Range: Burst 2 within 15
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D3 Stamina
Effect: Grasping vines and roots erupt in the target area. The area becomes difficult terrain for the rest of the encounter. Each creature in the area when it appears must pass a resistance check or be Slowed (5) for 1 round.
Tap: Creatures that fail are also Immobilized until the end of their next turn.

BARKSKIN — PRAYER 2

DIVINE NATURE

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: The target's skin hardens to the resilience of oak. The target gains +3 Armor and +2 Hardness until the end of the encounter. This bonus does not stack with worn armor.
Tap: The target also gains Resistance 3 to Thermal and Cold damage.

CALL LIGHTNING — PRAYER 3

DIVINE ELECTRIC NATURE

Range: Burst 5 within 20; one creature in area per turn
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 2 AP; sustain 1 AP
Resistance: D6 Stamina
Effect: You summon a storm cloud in the area. When you cast this prayer and at the start of each of your subsequent turns while you sustain it, a bolt of lightning strikes a creature of your choice within the area, dealing 200% electric damage.
Miss: Half damage.
Tap: You may target two creatures per bolt instead of one.

WRATH OF THE WILD — PRAYER 4

DIVINE NATURE

Range: Burst 4 within 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: Dodge 8
Effect: The terrain itself turns hostile. All enemies in the area take 200% damage as thorns, roots, and stone erupt beneath them. The area becomes heavily obscured difficult terrain for 3 rounds. Enemies that start their turn in the area take 100% ongoing damage.
Miss: Half damage, ongoing damage still applies.

VERDANT RESURRECTION — PRAYER 5

DIVINE NATURE

Range: one dead ally within 10
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments + 3 EP
AP: 3 AP
Effect: You encase a dead ally in a cocoon of living wood that rapidly restores their body. The target revives with HP equal to 300% of your catalyst's damage and 100% Focus. Additionally, the cocoon removes all status conditions from the target upon revival. The cocoon takes 1 round to open — the target cannot act until the start of their next turn.
Tap: The target revives with full HP and all status conditions removed from all allies within 3 squares.

PRIMEVAL CATACLYSM — PRAYER 6

DIVINE NATURE

Range: Burst 5 within 20
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Stamina
Effect: You unleash the full fury of the natural world. The terrain in the area is permanently transformed: trees erupt from stone, chasms split open, and rivers divert. All enemies in the area take 300% damage and must pass a resistance check or be Prone and Immobilized (save ends both). The transformed terrain is difficult terrain permanently and provides cover to your allies but not to your enemies.
Miss: Half damage, Prone for 1 round.

Protection Domain

SHIELD OF FAITH — PRAYER 1

DIVINE PROTECTION

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: The target gains +2 Evasion and +2 to all resistance checks until the end of the encounter.
Tap: The bonuses increase to +3.

WARDING BOND — PRAYER 2

DIVINE PROTECTION

Range: one ally within 10
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You create a divine link between yourself and the target. While the bond persists, the target gains Resistance 5 to all damage types, but you take damage

equal to the amount resisted. The bond lasts until the end of the encounter or until you dismiss it (free action).
Tap: You take only half of the redirected damage.

DISPELLING WAVE — PRAYER 3

DIVINE PROTECTION

Range: Burst 3 within 15
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: A wave of divine energy washes over the area, stripping away magical effects. Each ongoing spell, power, or magical effect in the area is immediately ended if its tier is equal to or less than 3. For effects of tier 4 or higher, make a Command check against the effect's original difficulty; on success, the effect is dispelled.
Tap: Automatically dispels effects up to tier 4 instead of 3.

AEGIS OF THE FAITHFUL — PRAYER 4

DIVINE PROTECTION

Range: Close Burst 3 centered on you
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: A dome of golden light surrounds you and your allies. All allies within the area gain Resistance 10 to all damage types. Projectiles and ranged spell attacks that cross the barrier take a -3d penalty to hit. The aegis lasts as long as you sustain it, but you cannot move while sustaining.
Tap: You may move at half speed while sustaining the aegis.

INVIOLABLE SANCTUARY — PRAYER 5

DIVINE PROTECTION

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Effect: You designate one creature within range. For 3 rounds, that creature cannot be targeted by attacks or harmful effects. The creature cannot attack or use offensive powers while the sanctuary is active; if they do, the sanctuary ends immediately. At the end of the duration, the creature recovers HP equal to 200% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: The sanctuary duration increases to 5 rounds and the healing increases to 300%.

DIVINE BULWARK — PRAYER 6

DIVINE PROTECTION

Range: Burst 5 centered on you; all allies in burst
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Effect: You invoke the full protective power of your deity. For 3 rounds, all allies within the area gain immunity to two status conditions of your choice, Resistance 10 to all damage types, and +3 Evasion. The first time each ally would be reduced to 0 HP during this effect, they are instead reduced to 1 HP. When the effect ends, all allies recover HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage.
Tap: The duration increases to 5 rounds and allies recover 200% instead.

Poison Domain

VENOMOUS TOUCH — PRAYER 1

DIVINE POISON POISON

Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D3 Stamina
Effect: You channel a potent toxin through your hand or weapon. Your next melee attack or touch before the end of your turn deals an additional 100% of your catalyst's damage as Poison damage. If the target takes damage, it must pass a resistance check or become Poisoned (save ends).
Tap: The target also takes ongoing 3/T Poison damage (save ends) regardless of whether the Poisoned save succeeds.

MIASMA — PRAYER 2

DIVINE POISON ZONE POISON

Range: Burst 2 within 15
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 2 AP; sustain 1 AP
Resistance: D4 Stamina
Effect: You exhale a cloud of noxious fumes that fills the area. The zone provides light obscurement. Any creature that enters or starts its turn in the zone takes 100% Poison damage and must pass a resistance check or be Poisoned and Weakened (-2d on attack rolls) for 1 round. The zone lasts as long as you sustain it.
Tap: The zone also imposes a -2 penalty to saving throws against Poisoned while creatures remain within it.

WITHER — PRAYER 3

DIVINE POISON DISEASE POISON

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D6 Stamina
Effect: You curse the target with a wasting toxin that saps their vitality. The target takes 200% Poison damage. On a failed resistance check, the target is Diseased (save ends): while Diseased, all healing received by the target is halved, and the target takes ongoing 5/T Poison damage at the start of each of its turns.
Miss: Half damage, Poisoned for 1 round.
Tap: The Disease also reduces the target's Stamina by 2 for the duration.

PLAGUE BEARER — PRAYER 4

DIVINE POISON DISEASE POISON

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D7 Stamina (spread only; primary target auto-fails)
Effect: You infect a target with a virulent plague that spreads to nearby enemies. The primary target takes 200% Poison damage and is automatically Diseased (save ends). At the end of each of the primary target's turns, all enemies within 2 squares of it must pass a resistance check or also become Diseased. The disease spreads in this manner up to 3 times. Diseased creatures have their healing halved and take ongoing 5/T Poison damage.
Miss: Half damage, Poisoned (save ends) instead of Diseased.
Tap: The spreading radius increases to 3 squares and the maximum number of spreads increases to 5.

NECROTIC VENOM — PRAYER 5

DIVINE POISON NECROTIC POISON

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D9 Stamina
Effect: You inject a target with a toxin that attacks the boundary between life and death. The target takes 300% Poison damage, ignoring Ward. On a failed resistance check, the target cannot be healed by any means (save ends). While this effect persists, any damage the target takes also reduces its maximum HP by the same amount. Maximum HP lost this way is restored when the effect ends.
Miss: Half damage, healing halved for 1 round.
Tap: The target's maximum HP reduction persists for 24 hours after the anti-healing effect ends.

WORLD SERPENT'S EMBRACE — PRAYER 6

DIVINE POISON DISEASE NECROTIC POISON

Range: Burst 4 within 20; all enemies in burst
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Stamina
Effect: You call upon the World Serpent to devour your enemies' vitality. All enemies in the area take 300% Poison damage and are Diseased and Poisoned (save ends both). Diseased creatures have their healing halved and take ongoing 100% Poison damage per turn. For each enemy affected, one ally of your choice within the area recovers HP equal to 100% of your catalyst's damage. Enemies reduced to 0 HP by this prayer cannot be resurrected for 1 week.
Miss: Half damage, Poisoned for 1 round.
Tap: Allies in the area also gain immunity to Poison and Disease for 3 rounds.

Psychic

Tier 1

TWIST OF FATE — PSYCHIC POWER 1

FATE REACTION

Range: 1 within 12
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Effect: On the target's next roll, you may modify the result by +1 or -1. Augment 2: You may use this power as a reaction.

SLOW — PSYCHIC POWER 1

TIME

Range: 1 creature within 12
Difficulty: 4
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Effect: The target must make a D4 Potential save. On failure: the target loses 1 AP while the spell lasts. They also gain a -2 penalty to their Movement Speed and a -10 penalty to their Initiative value. This effect cannot decrease Movement Speed below 2 or Initiative below 0. Augment 1: The duration changes to save ends. Augment 2: The resist difficulty is increased to D7.

PIERCING SILENCE — PSYCHIC POWER 1

VOID

Range: Burst 3 within 10
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Effect: The target area becomes a zone of magical silence. While the spell is active, no-one within the zone may cast a spell or manifest a power. It is possible to brute-force the silence; a casting check over a difficulty of 8 will break this spell.

Tier 2

REVERSAL OF FORTUNE — PSYCHIC POWER 2

FATE

Range: 1 within 12
Difficulty: 6
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Potential 5)
Effect: On the target's next roll, all 6s count as 1 success. Augment 2: You may use this power as a reaction.

HASTE — PSYCHIC POWER 2

TIME

Range: 1 creature within 10
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Effect: The target gains 1 additional AP while the spell lasts. They also gain a +2 bonus to their Movement Speed and a +10 bonus to their Initiative value. Duration: 2 rounds. Augment 2: The duration increases to 2+1d3 rounds. Augment 2: The bonuses to speed and initiative increase to +3 and +15, respectively.

BANISH — PSYCHIC POWER 2

VOID DEATH

Range: 1 within 12
Difficulty: 6
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 4)
Effect: The target must make a D4 Stamina save. On failure, it is banished to the Void and dies instantly. Augment 2: The resist difficulty increases to 6.

Tier 3

CURSED FATE — PSYCHIC POWER 3

FATE CURSE

Range: 1 within 12
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Potential 6)
Effect: For the duration of the effect, all 1s count as -2 successes, rather than -1. Duration: save ends. Augment 2: Saving against this effect requires 3 successes.

MASS SLOW — PSYCHIC POWER 3

TIME

Range: Burst 3 within 16
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Effect: The target(s) must make a D6 Potential save. On failure: the target loses 1 AP while the spell lasts. They also gain a -2 penalty to their Movement Speed and a -10 penalty to their Initiative value. This effect cannot decrease Movement Speed below 2 or Initiative below 0. Duration: 2 rounds. Augment 1: The duration changes to save ends. Augment 2: The resist difficulty is increased to D9.

Tier 4

MASS HASTE — PSYCHIC POWER 4

TIME

Range: Burst 3 within 16
Duration: 2 Rounds
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Effect: The target(s) gain 1 additional AP while the spell lasts. They also gain a +2 bonus to their Movement Speed and a +10 bonus to their Initiative value.
Augment 2: The duration increases to 2+1d3 rounds.
Augment 2: The bonuses to speed and initiative increase to +3 and +15, respectively.

IMPLOSION — PSYCHIC POWER 4

VOID

A tiny portal to the void opens where the caster directs it to, sucking in the surrounding air as it expands briefly before it collapses in on itself, blinking out of existence.

Range: Burst 10 within 30
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 8)
Effect: All targets within the burst must make a D8 Stamina resist; on failure, they are moved up to 5 m toward the center of the burst.
Secondary: All targets within 3 m of the center take 200% Untyped damage. Any target in the center square of the burst takes 300% Untyped damage.
Tertiary: Any target in the center of the burst must make a D6 Stamina resist or be banished to the Void (death effect).

Augment 3: The range increases to Burst 12 within 36.
Augment 2: The resist difficulty for the banishment effect increases to D8.

GRAVITY WELL — PSYCHIC POWER 4

SPACE

Range: Burst 4 within 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 8)
Effect: You create an intense gravitational singularity. All creatures in the area are pulled 3 squares toward the center. Creatures in the center square take 300% Force damage; creatures elsewhere in the area take 200% Force damage. Creatures that fail their resistance check are Prone and Slowed (5) (save ends). Augment 2: The pull increases to 5 squares and the area increases to Burst 6.
Miss: Half damage, Slowed (5) for 1 round.

Tier 5

CURSED FATE, MASS — PSYCHIC POWER 5

FATE CURSE

Range: Burst 5 within 20; all enemies in burst
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Potential 8)
Effect: For the duration of the effect, all 1s count as -2 successes, rather than -1. Duration: save ends. Augment 2: Saving against this effect requires 3 successes.

Tier 6

TIME STOP — PSYCHIC POWER 6

TIME

Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Effect: You freeze the flow of time for all creatures except yourself. You immediately take 2 additional turns. During these turns, you may move and take actions as normal, but you cannot deal damage to or directly target any other creature. Any area effect you create during the stopped time takes effect when time resumes. If you directly attack or target a creature, the spell ends immediately.

MASS BANISHMENT — PSYCHIC POWER 6

VOID

Range: Burst 5 within 20
Difficulty: 11
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Potential
Effect: You rip open the boundary between planes, pulling all enemies in the area toward oblivion. Each target that fails their resistance check is banished to a void between worlds for 1 round, then returns to an unoccupied space of your choice within the area. Banished creatures are removed from play during this time. Creatures that fail by 5 or more successes are permanently banished.
Miss: The target is Dazed for 1 round.

REWRITE FATE — PSYCHIC POWER 6

FATE

Range: Burst 5 within 20
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Potential (option 1 only)
Effect: You seize the threads of destiny and rewrite them. Choose one: (1) force all enemies in the area to reroll every die roll and take the worse result for 3 rounds (save ends); or (2) grant all allies in the area the ability to reroll every die roll and take the better result for 2 rounds. This effect cannot be dispelled by non-Psychic means.

Martial Exploits

Tier 1

LOTUS ART: IMPENETRABLE — EXPLOIT 1

LOTUS ART STANCE

"The true sage does not seek to counter strength with strength, but redirects it. The blade runs off him like water off a lotus leaf."

Cost: --
AP: 1; sustain 1
Effect: While in Impenetrable stance, you gain a +2 bonus to your Evasion.

MEASURED STRIKE — EXPLOIT 1

WEAPON

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +1
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You make a careful, controlled attack. The attack deals 100% damage and you gain +2 Evasion until the start of your next turn.

GUARDIAN STANCE — EXPLOIT 1

STANCE

Cost: --
AP: 1; sustain 1
Effect: While in Guardian stance, enemies that move out of a square adjacent to you provoke an opportunity attack from you, even if they use Disengage. You may make one such attack per round.

Tier 2

LOTUS ART: PURE LAND BURIAL — EXPLOIT 2

LOTUS ART

Every soul yearns to return to the soil of the Pure Land from which it was born. This blade will show it the way.

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +2
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2
Effect: On hit: the target takes 200% damage. Secondary: The target must make a D6 Potential resist. On failure: the target loses 5 EP, if applicable. A target killed by this power must make a D8 Potential resist each round it is dead; on failure, it cannot revive or be revived that turn. This power does not prevent discorporation.

KEEP YOUR DISTANCE — EXPLOIT 2

REACTION IMMEDIATE INTERRUPT

Prerequisites:
- You are wielding a reach weapon

Difficulty: +2
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: Reaction
Effect: When a creature moves into your weapon reach, as a reaction: you may make an attack against it. On hit: it takes 100% damage and you push it up to one square away from you. This interrupts its movement.

PIERCING THRUST — EXPLOIT 2

PIERCING

Prerequisites:
- You are wielding a weapon that deals piercing damage

Range: Weapon + 1
Difficulty: +3
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Effect: You lunge forward, thrusting your weapon at a weak point in the enemy's armor. On hit: the target suffers 200% damage. The attack's Pen value is equal to the damage roll.

Tier 3

LOTUS ART: PEARL SCISSOR — EXPLOIT 3

LOTUS ART DUAL WIELD

The honed blade cuts the line of the soul.

Prerequisites:
- You must be wielding two bladed weapons

Range: Line, Movement Range
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: Yes (Dodge 6)
Effect: All targets on the line are hit once by each wielded weapon, halving armor. Secondary: The target must make a D8 Potential save; on failure: it is stilled (save ends).

CRASHING WAVE — EXPLOIT 3

SPEAR

Prerequisites:
- You are wielding a polearm

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +3
Cost: 2 Increments

AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 6)
Effect: On hit: the target takes 200% damage and must make a D6 Stamina resist; on failure: the target is vaulted into the air, pushing it up to 3 squares. Secondary: You may make a secondary attack against the target at the same difficulty; on hit: the target takes 100% damage ignoring armor, is knocked prone, and must make a D6 Stamina resist; on failure: the target is stunned for one round.

Tier 4

LOTUS ART: THOUSAND PETAL — EXPLOIT 4

LOTUS ART | DUAL WIELD

When the creator made the universe, it is said that he first made a lotus flower of a thousand petals, and when he scattered the petals, from each one there blossomed a world.

Prerequisites:
- You must be wielding two bladed weapons

Range: Close Burst 5
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Dive; Dodge 8)
Effect: On hit: the target takes 100% damage, halving armor. The target must also make a D7 Potential save; on failure: it loses 2 EP.

SUNDERING BLOW — EXPLOIT 4

WEAPON

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D7 Stamina (equipment damage only; HP damage always applies on hit)
Effect: You strike with such force that you damage the target's equipment. The target takes 300% damage. If the target fails their resistance check, one piece of their worn armor or wielded shield permanently loses 3 Armor value (until repaired). This reduction stacks with multiple uses.

WHIRLWIND STRIKE — EXPLOIT 4

WEAPON

Range: Close Burst 2; all enemies
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D7 Stamina (push only; damage always applies on hit)
Effect: You spin in a devastating arc, striking all nearby enemies. Each enemy in range takes 200% damage. Enemies that fail their resistance check are also pushed 2 squares away from you.

Tier 5

LOTUS ART: NOBLE EIGHTFOLD BLADE — EXPLOIT 5

LOTUS ART | DUAL WIELD

"The master said: there are eight worlds in creation. To truly kill your enemy, you must cut him down in each of them."

Prerequisites:
- You must be wielding two bladed weapons

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: Special
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Potential 9)
Effect: When you perform this exploit, you may make four attacks against the same or different targets. The difficulty of the first attack is equal to the target's evasion, increasing by 2 on each subsequent attack, up to +6 on the fourth. Each attack deals 100% damage at half armor. Secondary: After performing all attacks, targets hit must make a D9 Potential check. On failure, they suffer the following effects depending on how many times they were hit (these effects stack): 1 hit: the target is stilled. 2 hits: the target loses 5 EP. 3 hits: the target is exposed. 4 hits: the target dies instantly and loses 5 more EP.

DEATHBLOW — EXPLOIT 5

WEAPON

Range: Weapon
Difficulty: +4
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D9 Stamina (instant-kill effect only)
Effect: You deliver a single, devastating strike aimed to kill. The target takes 300% damage. If this reduces the target to half HP or below, they must pass a resistance check or be reduced to 0 HP. This exploit can only be used once per encounter.

Tier 6

FOREST OF CORPSES — UNIQUE POWER 6

WEAPON

You thrust Kazykly deep into the earth. For a second, everything is still before sharpened stakes of solid shadow erupt beneath your enemies.

Prerequisites:
- You must be wielding Kazykly

Range: Close Burst 10
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3
Resistance: Yes (Stamina 8)
Effect: Every creature targeted by this power must take a Dive reaction to avoid the stake (Dodge DC equal to this power's attack roll). On failure, it takes 300% piercing damage and is immobilized; in addition, it must make a D8 Stamina check or be stunned for one round. On each of the target's turns, it must make a D6 Athletics check to vault off the stake or take 100% damage and remain immobilized. Special: If you fail the attack roll to invoke this power, Kazykly becomes stuck in the ground. Pulling it back out is a 1 AP action and requires a successful D7 Martial check.

Command Powers

Tier 1

RALLY — COMMAND 1

COMMAND MORALE

Range: one ally within 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: One ally within range immediately gains +2d on their next attack roll or saving throw (their choice). If the ally is suffering from a fear effect, they may immediately make a saving throw against it with +2d.

COMPEL OBEDIENCE — COMMAND 1

COMMAND

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D3 Potential (only if not already under your control)
Effect: You issue a forceful command to a summoned or dominated creature. The target must immediately use its next turn to perform one specific action of your choice (move, attack a target, or use a specific power). If the creature is not under your control, it may resist.

Tier 2

COORDINATED STRIKE — COMMAND 2

COMMAND TACTICAL

Range: two allies within 10
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You direct two allies to strike in unison. Each ally within range may immediately make a basic attack as a free action against a target of your choice. If both allies hit the same target, that target is Dazed until the end of its next turn.

TERRIFYING SHOUT — COMMAND 2

COMMAND MORALE FEAR

Range: Close Burst 3
Difficulty: 5
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D5 Potential
Effect: You unleash a shout that breaks the morale of your enemies. All enemies in the area that fail their resistance check are Frightened of you (save ends). Frightened creatures take a -2d penalty on attack rolls and cannot willingly move closer to you.

Tier 3

HOLD THE LINE — COMMAND 3

COMMAND TACTICAL

Range: Burst 3 centered on you; up to 4 allies
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You command your allies to form a defensive formation. Up to four allies within range gain +3 Evasion and +2d on resistance checks until the end of your next turn. While this effect is active, enemies that move through or out of a square adjacent to an affected ally provoke an opportunity attack.

BREAK WILL — COMMAND 3

COMMAND DOMINATION

Range: one creature within 10
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D7 Potential

Effect: You shatter an enemy's resolve with sheer authority. The target that fails their resistance check is Dominated (save ends). While Dominated, the target acts on your turn under your control, but can only take basic actions (move, basic attack). At the end of each of its turns, the target may attempt a saving throw.
Miss: The target is Dazed for 1 round.

Tier 4

OVERWHELMING PRESENCE — COMMAND 4

COMMAND | MORALE | FEAR

Range: Close Burst 5
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D8 Potential
Effect: Your authority is absolute. All enemies in the area must pass a resistance check or be Stunned for 1 round, then Frightened of you (save ends). Allies in the area are immune to fear effects and gain +2d on all checks for 2 rounds.
Miss: Frightened for 1 round (no Stun).

Tier 5

GRAND TACTICIAN — COMMAND 5

COMMAND | TACTICAL

Range: Burst 5 centered on you; up to 5 allies
Difficulty: 10
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Effect: You orchestrate a devastating coordinated assault. Up to five allies within range each immediately take a standard action of their choice as a free action. Each ally that attacks gains +3d on their attack roll. An ally may not be targeted by this power more than once per encounter.

Tier 6

ABSOLUTE AUTHORITY — COMMAND 6

COMMAND | MORALE | DOMINATION

Range: Burst 5 centered on you
Difficulty: 12
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D10 Potential (option 1 only)
Effect: Your word becomes law on the battlefield. Choose one: (1) All enemies in the area are Dominated for 1 round (no save). During this round, dominated enemies cannot use powers above Tier 2 and must use their movement to move to a location you designate. (2) All allies in the area gain +1 AP, +3d on all attack rolls, and immunity to all status conditions for 2 rounds.
Miss: Dazed for 1 round (option 1 only).

Marksmanship Exploits

Tier 1

STEADY SHOT — EXPLOIT 1

WEAPON | RANGED

Range: Weapon range
Difficulty: +2
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You take careful aim and fire. Make a ranged attack with +2d. If you have not moved this turn, the attack deals an additional 50% damage.

Tier 2

PINNING SHOT — EXPLOIT 2

WEAPON | RANGED

Range: Weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Resistance: D5 Stamina (negates Immobilized/Restrained, damage still applies)
Effect: Your shot pins the target in place. On a hit, the target takes 100% damage and is Immobilized (save ends). If the target is adjacent to a wall or solid surface, they are also Restrained (save ends) instead.

TRICK SHOT — EXPLOIT 2

WEAPON | RANGED

Range: Weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +3
Cost: 1 Increment
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You ricochet a shot off a surface to strike a target behind cover. This attack ignores cover and concealment. The target takes 200% damage.

Tier 3

SUPPRESSING FIRE — EXPLOIT 3

WEAPON | RANGED | ZONE

Range: Burst 3 within weapon range
Difficulty: 6
Cost: 2 Increments; sustain 1

AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Resistance: Dodge 6
Effect: You lay down a hail of fire across an area. The zone becomes hazardous: any enemy that enters the zone or starts its turn there must pass a resistance check or take 100% damage and be Prone. Enemies in the zone take a -3d penalty on attack rolls. The zone lasts as long as you sustain it; you cannot move while sustaining.

CALLED SHOT: VITALS — EXPLOIT 3

WEAPON RANGED

Range: Weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +3
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2 AP
Effect: You aim for a critical point. On a hit, the target takes 200% damage and is Bleeding (save ends). If this attack scores 3 or more hits above the target's Evasion, the target is also Stunned for 1 round.

Tier 4

KILLZONE — EXPLOIT 4

WEAPON RANGED ZONE

Range: Burst 3 within weapon range
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 3 Increments; sustain 1
AP: 3 AP; sustain 1 AP
Effect: You designate a Burst 3 area within weapon range as a killzone. Enemies that enter the zone or start their turn there provoke a free ranged attack from you that deals 200% damage. You may make one such attack per enemy per turn. You cannot move while sustaining the killzone.

HEADSHOT — EXPLOIT 4

WEAPON RANGED

Prerequisites:
- Must not have moved this turn

Range: Weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +4
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D8 Stamina (Dazed only; damage always applies on hit)
Effect: You take a single, devastatingly precise shot. The target takes 300% damage. If the target fails their resistance check, they are also Dazed (save ends) as the impact rattles them.

Tier 5

DEATH FROM AFAR — EXPLOIT 5

WEAPON RANGED

Prerequisites:
- Must not have moved this turn

Range: Double weapon range; one creature
Difficulty: +4
Cost: 3 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D9 Stamina (instant-kill effect only)
Effect: You fire a single shot with lethal precision. The attack's range is doubled. The target takes 300% damage, ignoring Hardness. If this reduces the target to half HP or below, they must pass a resistance check or be reduced to 0 HP instead.

Tier 6

BULLET HELL — EXPLOIT 6

WEAPON RANGED

Prerequisites:
- You are wielding an automatic weapon.

Range: Cone 15 or Line 20
Difficulty: 8
Cost: 4 Increments
AP: 3 AP
Resistance: D9 Stamina
Effect: You unleash a storm of projectiles across the battlefield. Make a ranged attack against every enemy in the area. Each target hit takes 200% damage. Targets that fail their resistance check are also Prone and Dazed (save ends both). The area becomes difficult terrain littered with spent ammunition.
Miss: Half damage, Prone for 1 round.

Equipment

The Deathless carry the remnants of a lost age: weapons forged in factories that no longer run, armor plated with alloys whose formulas are half-remembered, catalysts housing fragments of power that predate the cataclysm. Equipment in Ashen is not simply purchased off a shelf — it is scavenged, repaired, inherited, and occasionally crafted anew by artisans working from incomplete knowledge.

A character's equipment defines their role in combat as much as their powers do. The weapon they wield determines their damage output and range; their armor shapes whether they stand in the open or fight from cover; their catalyst or reliquary channels the powers they have learned. Choosing equipment is choosing a style of play.

This chapter covers the rules for acquiring, carrying, and using equipment, as well as the systems for masterwork craftsmanship and magical enchantments that allow items to grow alongside the characters who bear them.

General Rules

This section covers the rules that apply to all equipment regardless of type: how items are carried and readied, how encumbrance works, how powers interact with implements, and how items can be improved through masterwork craftsmanship and enchantment.

Equipment States

Items a character possesses can be in one of three states:

- **Carried:** The item is stowed in a pack, bag, or otherwise on the character's person, but is not ready for immediate use. Retrieving a carried item to equip or wield it takes significant effort (typically a full action). Carried items contribute to a character's encumbrance but do not count against their Bulk or Charge capacity (see *Bulk and Charge* below).
- **Equipped:** The item is worn on the body or stored in a readily accessible location (a belt, holster, or sheath). Armor must be equipped to provide its benefits. Equipped items can be drawn to be wielded as a minor action (see *Draw/Stash* in the Combat chapter). Equipped items count against a character's Bulk and Charge capacity.
- **Wielded:** The item is actively held in hand and ready to use. A character can wield items in as many hands as they have free (typically two). Weapons must be wielded to attack with them; catalysts and reliquaries must be wielded to channel powers through them. Some items — notably light catalysts such as pendants, circlets, and tiaras — can be wielded without occupying a hand, as they are worn on the body in a way that allows the user to channel through them. Wielded items count against a character's Bulk and Charge capacity.

Bulk and Charge

Every piece of equipment has a **Bulk** value representing its physical weight and size, and a **Charge** value representing its magical resonance and encumbrance.

A character's **Bulk capacity** is equal to their **Stamina rating**. A character's **Charge capacity** is equal to their **Potential rating**. The total Bulk and Charge of all *equipped and wielded* items must not exceed these capacities. Carried items (stowed in a pack) do not count against Bulk or Charge capacity, but are subject to the character's carrying capacity instead (see below).

Non-magical items (mundane weapons, basic armor) have Charge 0. Lightly magical items have Charge roughly half their Bulk. Heavily magical items (catalysts, reliquaries, enchanted robes) may have high Charge and low Bulk. This creates a meaningful equipment tradeoff: physical warriors invest in Bulk capacity, casters invest in Charge capacity, and hybrid characters must balance both.

Carrying Capacity

A character's **carrying capacity** represents the total Bulk of items they can carry on their person, including both equipped and carried items. A character's base carrying capacity is equal to **twice their Bulk capacity** (i.e., twice their Stamina rating). Some races have a different carrying capacity multiplier:

- **Ironhands:** ×3 (their construct frames are built for heavy loads)
- **Warboars:** ×3 (bred for endurance on long campaigns)
- All other races: ×2

A character whose total carried and equipped Bulk exceeds their carrying capacity is **encumbered**: their Movement Speed is halved and they suffer a −2d penalty on all physical checks.

Focus Increments

Weapons, catalysts, and reliquaries each have a **focus increment** value. This value determines how much Focus a character spends when using powers through that implement. When a power's cost is expressed in *increments* (e.g., "Cost: 2 Increments"), the actual Focus Point cost is equal to the number of increments multiplied by the wielded implement's focus increment value. For example, a character using a power that costs 2 increments through a weapon with a focus increment of 5 would spend 10 FP.

Higher-tier and heavier implements tend to have larger focus increments, reflecting their greater power output. This creates a tradeoff: more powerful implements deal more damage but are more expensive to fuel with Focus. A character choosing between two weapons of the same tier might opt for one with a lower increment if they rely heavily on exploits, or a higher increment if they prefer raw damage and use powers sparingly.

Masterwork Items

Most equipment available to characters is **generic**: mass-produced or commonly available gear whose quality is determined by its materials and the technology used to manufacture it. Generic items exist at tiers 0 through 4.

A **masterwork** item is one crafted with exceptional skill, superior materials, or both. Masterwork quality allows an item to exceed the tier 4 generic ceiling, and for weapons, grants an intrinsic bonus to attack rolls. Masterwork items come in two grades:

- **Masterwork +1:** The item is one tier above its generic equivalent. Masterwork weapons grant +1d to attack rolls. Available at tier 3 and above; **required** at tier 5 and above.
- **Masterwork +2:** The item is two tiers above its generic equivalent. Masterwork weapons grant +2d to attack rolls. Available at tier 5 and above only; **required** at tier 6.

For armor and catalysts, masterwork quality is reflected in the item's stat line (higher Armor, Ward, Evasion, or casting bonuses) rather than granting a separate numerical bonus. Reliquaries, being remnants of the dead gods rather than crafted objects, are not subject to masterwork rules.

Crafting a masterwork item requires a Shop check at difficulty 9 or higher, along with appropriate materials. Not every skilled artisan can produce masterwork items — the combination of talent, tools, and materials needed is rare.

Enchantments

An **enchantment** is a magical effect layered onto an item. Enchantments grant special abilities — they do not change the item's base stats or tier. A standard item can hold up to **two** enchantments.

Enchantments are described by named traits such as Moontouched, Bloodthirst, or Rimebound. Each enchantment occupies one of the item's enchantment slots. Enchantments can be added, removed, or replaced through the appropriate ritual, skill check, or downtime activity. The specific process depends on the nature of the enchantment: magical effects typically require a ritual (using the Ritual or Occultism skill), while physical treatments like silvering a weapon are achieved through alchemy or craftsmanship (using Alchemy or Shop).

Each enchantment has its own ritual or recipe describing the process, difficulty, cost, and skill required to apply it. The rituals and recipes for known enchantments are found in the Skills chapter under the relevant skill.

Enchantment List

The following enchantments are known to exist. Others may be discovered during play.

Weapon Enchantments:

- **Bloodthirst:** The weapon hungers for blood. If the weapon successfully deals damage to a living target, the wielder gains a +2 bonus to the next attack with the weapon. *(Occultism recipe.)*
- **Cursebringer:** The weapon brings doom to anything it strikes. On a successful hit that deals damage, the target must make a Potential save (difficulty equals the weapon's tier + 2). On failure, the target takes a −2 curse penalty to all of its rolls (save ends). *(Occultism recipe.)*
- **Manabind:** The implement grants a +6 bonus to counterspelling. If the implement is used to perform a successful counterspell, the wielder recovers Focus equal to the cost of the countered spell. *(Ritual.)*
- **Moontouched:** A target hit by this weapon is surrounded by a halo of moonlight. Any attacks against the afflicted target gain a +2 bonus until the end of the wielder's next turn; additionally, the halo cancels the effects of invisibility for this duration. *(Ritual.)*
- **Resonating:** The implement becomes more efficient at channeling magical energy with every spell cast in quick succession. For every spell channeled through the implement on a given turn, its casting bonuses increase by 1, up to a maximum of its base bonus + 3. *(Ritual.)*
- **Souldrinker:** On a successful hit that deals damage, the target must make a Potential save (difficulty equals the weapon's tier + 2). On failure, the target loses 1 EP and Focus equal to 3 × the weapon's tier. *(Occultism recipe.)*
- **Spacerender:** The weapon cuts through the fabric of space, extending its effective reach. The weapon gains Reach 2. *(Ritual.)*

Armor Enchantments:

- **Deflecting:** The armor's surface is magically treated to scatter incoming magical energy. When the wearer is targeted by an area-effect spell or magical ability, the armor grants the wearer light cover against that effect. *(Ritual.)*
- **Lightbender:** The armor bends light around itself. When the wearer is fighting in bright light, the armor's Evasion bonus increases by 1. *(Ritual.)*

Material Treatments:

- **Silvered:** The weapon has been treated with alchemical silver. See the Silvered keyword under Weapon Keywords. *(Alchemy or Shop recipe.)*

Legendary Items

Legendary items (see *Legendary* in the Basic Rules chapter) are unique artifacts with an intrinsic trait that cannot be replicated or transferred. This legendary trait is part of the item's identity and **does not count against its enchantment slots**. A legendary item can therefore have up to three total effects: its intrinsic legendary trait plus up to two enchantments. Most tier 6 weapons and some tier 5 weapons are legendary.

Types of Equipment

Weapons

Weapons are divided into **melee weapons** and **ranged weapons**. Each weapon has a **weight class** (Light, Medium, or Heavy) that affects its damage, bulk, and handling characteristics.

Light weapons are small and quick. They have low bulk and can often be drawn as a free action. Light melee weapons include daggers, short swords, and gauntlets. Light ranged weapons include pistols and holdout guns.

Medium weapons represent the standard arms of a professional soldier. They balance damage and handling well. Medium melee weapons include longswords, maces, and spears. Medium ranged weapons include rifles and carbines.

Heavy weapons are large, powerful, and unwieldy. They deal the most damage but have the highest bulk and often require two hands. Heavy melee weapons include greatswords, mauls, and halberds. Heavy ranged weapons include machine guns, cannons, and sniper rifles. Heavy ranged weapons must be **braced** before they can be fired accurately; firing without bracing is called **hip-firing** and incurs a −2d penalty to the attack roll.

Weapon Stats

- **Damage:** The base damage dealt on a successful hit, expressed as a flat value plus a die roll (e.g., 9+D8).
- **Penetration (Pen):** How much of the target's Armor value this weapon ignores.
- **Bulk:** The physical weight and size of the weapon.
- **Hands:** The number of hands required to wield the weapon (1 or 2).
- **Range:** For ranged weapons, the effective range in squares. For melee weapons, this is typically "Melee" (adjacent squares) unless the weapon has reach.
- **Fire Mode (FM):** For ranged weapons only. Determines the weapon's hit rate (see *Ranged Attacks* in the Combat chapter). S = single shot (one hit maximum), SA = semi-automatic (hit rate 3, or 4 for heavy weapons), FA = full automatic (hit rate 2 for light/medium, 3 for heavy). Melee weapons use "—".
- **Special:** Any keywords or unique properties the weapon has.

Weapon Keywords

- **Assault:** Hip-fire penalty is halved (-1d instead of −2d).
- **Burning:** Target catches fire on hit (ongoing Thermal damage, save ends).
- **Chain:** The weapon uses mechanically driven teeth or a motorized cutting edge to tear through targets. Chain weapons require a power source (see Powered) and are heavier than conventional equivalents, but deal exceptionally high raw damage.

- **Disrupting:** On hit, the target must make a Potential check at difficulty 2 + the weapon's tier. On failure, the target is Disrupted, losing Ward equal to the weapon's tier. This effect stacks with other sources of Disrupt.
- **Explosive:** The weapon has a blast radius affecting adjacent squares.
- **Force:** The weapon projects an energy edge or sheath that cuts through physical protection. Force weapons have inherent Penetration and deal Rending damage regardless of the weapon's form factor (even if it would otherwise deal Impact damage).
- **Heavy:** The weapon must be **braced** before it can be fired accurately. Firing a heavy weapon without bracing is called **hip-firing** and incurs a −2d penalty to the attack roll (see also Assault).
- **Irradiated:** The weapon fires radioactive or chemically toxic ammunition. On hit, the target must make a Stamina check at difficulty 2 + the weapon's tier. On failure, it is Weakened (3 + tier) and takes ongoing Chemical damage equal to 3 × the weapon's tier per round (save ends both).
- **Overload:** The weapon risks overheating or malfunction on certain rolls.
- **Parry +Nd:** Grants +N bonus dice on parry checks while wielded.
- **Poisonous (N):** Target must pass a D(N) Stamina check or become Poisoned.
- **Powered:** Requires a power source or charge to function.
- **Rapid Fire:** When the target is within half the weapon's range, attack rolls gain +2 automatic successes.
- **Reach N:** The weapon can strike targets up to N squares away, but cannot strike directly adjacent targets.
- **Reliable:** Reduced chance of malfunction.
- **Sidearm:** Can be drawn or stowed as a free action once per turn, even while wielding a two-handed weapon.
- **Silvered:** The weapon has been treated with silver. Some creatures are immune or resistant to damage from non-silvered weapons; a silvered weapon bypasses this protection. Additionally, silvered weapons deal bonus damage to undead creatures equal to 50% of their base damage.
- **Split damage:** The weapon's damage is split between two types, each reduced by its respective defense separately. The weapon's item description specifies the split.

Armor

Armor protects the wearer from physical and magical damage. Like weapons, armor comes in weight classes: Light, Medium, and Heavy.

Light armor offers modest physical protection but does not hinder the wearer's mobility. Light armor typically grants a positive Evasion bonus. Robes, combat suits, and cloaks fall into this category.

Medium armor balances protection and mobility. Medium armor typically has no Evasion penalty. Combat plates, reinforced suits, and construct frames fall into this category.

Heavy armor offers the greatest protection but significantly reduces mobility. Heavy armor imposes an Evasion penalty. Power armor, battle plates, and siege frames fall into this category.

Armor Stats

- **Armor:** Physical damage reduction. Incoming physical damage is reduced by this value.
- **Ward:** Magical damage reduction. Incoming magical damage is reduced by this value.
- **Evasion:** Bonus or penalty to the wearer's Evasion score.
- **Bulk:** Physical weight and encumbrance.
- **Charge:** Magical encumbrance (see *Bulk and Charge* above).
- **Profile:** The armor's physical form factor, which determines how it layers with other armor (see *Armor Layering* below).

Armor Layering

A character may wear up to one piece of armor in each of three **profile** slots. From innermost to outermost, these are:

- **Close-fit (C):** Form-fitting garments worn directly against the body. Combat suits, bodysuits, and similar items.
- **Plating (P):** Rigid or semi-rigid protective layers worn over close-fit garments. Flak vests, armor plates, and combat frames.
- **Overgarment (O):** Large, flowing, or draped garments worn as the outermost layer. Robes and mantles.

A character may wear one piece of armor in each slot. Full-body armor such as power armor and construct frames occupies both the Close-fit and Plating slots (marked **C+P** in the armor table), meaning nothing can be worn underneath them.

When multiple pieces of armor are worn, their **Armor**, **Ward**, **Evasion**, **Bulk**, and **Charge** values are all added together. Special properties such as camouflage or stealth bonuses only apply if the piece with that property is the character's outermost worn layer.

Catalysts

Catalysts are implements used to channel magical energy. They are required to cast arcane spells and psychic powers. Each catalyst has a **damage** value (used as the base for spell damage calculations — when a spell deals "100% catalyst damage," it deals damage equal to the catalyst's damage value) and a **focus increment** value that determines the Focus cost of spells channeled through it (see *Focus Increments* above).

Catalysts come in two types: **Arcane catalysts** (rods, staves, orbs) are used for arcane spells. **Psychic catalysts** (crystals, masks, circlets) are used for psychic powers. A character must wield a catalyst of the appropriate type to cast spells or powers of that school.

Reliquaries

Reliquaries are remnants of the dead gods, retaining some of their power even long after they passed. Reliquaries can be used by characters with the appropriate training to cast divine prayers.

Reliquaries are catalysts with two unique stats: **will** and **favor**. These represent the strength of the divine will contained within the reliquary. All reliquaries begin in a state unfriendly to their users; in this state, casting any prayer with the reliquary adds the reliquary's will to the base difficulty of the prayer. To use a new reliquary without these penalties, a character must make a favor check; the difficulty of that favor check is equal to the tier of the reliquary plus its will.

If the favor check is passed, the character loses the casting penalties to prayers with that reliquary and gains the amount of **favor** indicated on the

reliquary's stat block (usually 1). A character may expend favor in two ways: to **tap** a prayer, increasing its power (see the section on prayers for an explanation) as well as to pass a failed command check made to cast a prayer. If a character's favor with a reliquary drops to 0, casting prayers with that reliquary is again subject to the will penalty of the reliquary.

If a character fails a favor check, they have displeased the deity and suffer the consequences.

Reliquaries also control the prayers that a wielder can make use of. Each reliquary typically gives access to prayers from between one to three domains. The maximum tier of prayer that a wielder receives from the reliquary is equal to the tier of the reliquary. For example, a tier three reliquary that grants access to the Life and Fire domains would grant access to prayers in those domains up to tier three, as long as it remained wielded.

Some reliquaries may grant access to unique prayers not part of any domain, or specific prayers outside of the domains they ordinarily grant access to. In these cases, those prayers are specially noted in the reliquary's stat block.

Equipment Tables

Melee Weapons by Type

All melee weapons deal **Rending** damage unless otherwise noted. Blunt weapons (hammers, maces) deal **Impact** damage instead.

Several technologies appear across melee weapon forms:

- **Force weapons** use an energy edge or sheath to enhance a conventional blade. They are lighter than their mundane equivalents and have inherent Penetration, as the energy field cuts through armor that would stop a physical edge. Force weapons deal Rending damage regardless of form factor.
- **Chain weapons** use mechanically driven teeth to tear through targets. They deal exceptionally high raw damage but require a power source (Powered keyword) and are heavier than conventional equivalents.
- **Power Field weapons** project a localized energy field that destabilizes matter on contact. They represent the pinnacle of melee Penetration, but are rare and expensive. Power Field weapons have the Powered keyword.

Daggers and Knives

Daggers and knives are Light weapons, easily concealed and quick to draw. Most have the Sidearm keyword, allowing them to be drawn or stowed as a free action. They deal less damage than larger weapons but excel as backup weapons, off-hand options, and tools for parrying.

DAGGERS AND KNIVES

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Inc	Special
Old War Dagger	0	*ƒ 0*	2+D6	0	½ (L)	1	2	Sidearm
Heat Knife	1	*ƒ 150*	6+D3	0	½ (L)	1	3	Sidearm, Burning
Parry Dagger, Power Field	4	*ƒ 5000*	7+D6	15	1 (L)	1	11	Parry +4d, Powered
Venom Fang, Unstable Edge	4	*ƒ 5000*	8+2D8	10	1 (L)	1	11	Poisonous (8)

One-handed Swords

The standard melee weapon for most combatants. One-handed swords leave a hand free for a catalyst, shield, pistol, or second weapon. They range from Light (force swords, shortswords) to Medium (longswords, sabres), balancing damage and versatility.

ONE-HANDED SWORDS

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Inc	Special
Old War Longsword	0	*ƒ 0*	4+D4	0	1 (M)	1	3	
Lantern Force Sword	1	*ƒ 300*	5+D8	0	½ (L)	1	3	Force
Dragon Guard Longsword	1	*ƒ 350*	6+D6	0	1 (M)	1	4	
Silvered Force Sword	2	*ƒ 600*	6+D6	4	½ (L)	1	4	Force, Silvered
Lacerator Shortsword	2	*ƒ 700*	9+D8	0	1 (M)	1	5	
Argent Keyblade	2	*ƒ 1000*	9+2D8	0	½ (L)	1	5	Force
Gathering Cloud Blade	3	*ƒ 2500*	11+2D8	0	2 (M)	1	9	
Hoarfrost	5	*Unique*	7+D12	0	2 (M)	1	14	Split damage
Void Blade	5	*Unique*	15+D10	0	1 (L)	1	15	
Moonlight Shortsword	6	*Unique*	18+2D8	0	2 (M)	1	16	

Two-handed Blades

Two-handed swords and similar large bladed weapons sacrifice versatility for raw damage. They are Heavy, requiring significant Bulk capacity, but their damage output exceeds anything a one-handed weapon can match at the same tier. Chain weapons fall into this category, trading precision for devastating cutting power.

TWO-HANDED BLADES

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Inc	Special
Old War Greatsword	0	*ƒ 0*	4+D6	0	2 (H)	2	4	
Construct Chainsword	1	*ƒ 500*	6+D12	0	2 (H)	1	5	Chain, Powered
Construct Power Sword	2	*ƒ 1200*	15+D4	0	2 (H)	1	8	Chain, Powered

Blunt Weapons

Hammers, maces, and similar bludgeoning weapons deal **Impact** damage rather than Rending. Impact damage is less affected by certain resistances and is particularly effective against constructs and heavily armored targets whose plating can absorb cuts but not concussive force.

BLUNT WEAPONS

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Inc	Special
Old War Greathammer	0	*ƒ 0*	6+D3	0	2 (H)	2	4	
Argent Disruptor	2	*ƒ 800*	9+D8	0	1½ (M)	1	5	Disrupting

Polearms

Polearms are long-hafted weapons — spears, lances, halberds — that grant the wielder **Reach**, allowing them to strike targets beyond adjacent squares. This makes them uniquely valuable for controlling space in combat. The tradeoff is that most polearms cannot strike directly adjacent targets, leaving the wielder vulnerable if an enemy closes the distance.

POLEARMS

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Inc	Special
Old War Spear	0	*ƒ 0*	5+D3	0	2 (M)	2	3	Reach 2
Kazykly	6	*Unique*	29+2D12	0	3 (H)	1	18	

Gauntlets

Gauntlets are fist-mounted weapons — powered gloves, cestus, and similar devices. They are the lightest melee weapons available, leaving the wielder's hands effectively free for other tasks. Their damage is modest, but their negligible Bulk makes them ideal for characters who need a melee option without dedicating significant carrying capacity to it.

GAUNTLETS

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Inc	Special
Lantern Impulse Gauntlet	1	*ƒ 200*	4+D6	0	¼ (L)	1	3	

Ranged Weapons by Type

Conventional Firearms

Conventional firearms propel solid projectiles using chemical propellants or compressed gas. They are the most common ranged weapons in the world, ranging from crude Old War relics to precision-engineered Perfector-pattern rifles. Conventional firearms deal **Rending** damage by default.

CONVENTIONAL FIREARMS

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Range	FM	Inc	Special
Old War Pistol	0	*ƒ 0*	1+D4	0	½ (L)	1	Short	S	2	Sidearm
Old War Rifle	0	*ƒ 0*	3+D3	0	1 (M)	2	Medium	S	3	
Silent Killer	1	*ƒ 200*	8+D3	0	1 (M)	1	Medium	S	4	
Lantern Autopulse Rifle	1	*ƒ 350*	5+D8	0	1 (M)	2	Long	SA 3	4	Rapid Fire

Nightpiercer	1	*ƒ 450*	11+D3	0	2 (H)	2	Very Long	S	5	Heavy
Alchymic Double Barrel	2	*ƒ 800*	15+D6	0	2 (M)	1	Short	S	5	
Perfector Mk IV Suppressed Rifle	2	*ƒ 1000*	15+D6	0	1 (M)	2	Very Long	S	5	Reliable
Dragon Gun	2	*ƒ 1500*	20+D6	0	2½ (H)	2	Very Long	S	5	Heavy
Jet Black Pistol	3	*ƒ 1800*	11+D4	0	1 (L)	1	Long	S	6	Sidearm
Irradiated Battle Rifle	3	*ƒ 2800*	12+D10	0	2 (M)	2	Long	SA 3	7	Irradiated
Poynting Rad-Fleche	5	*ƒ 10000*	5+2D10	12	2 (L)	1	Short	SA 3	13	Sidearm, Irradiated

Plasma Weapons

Plasma weapons fire superheated bolts of ionized gas that burn through both flesh and armor. All plasma weapons deal **Thermal** damage and have the **Burning** keyword. Their high Penetration values represent the plasma's ability to melt through physical protection. The tradeoff is range: plasma disperses rapidly, limiting most plasma weapons to short engagements. Higher-tier plasma weapons from the Sunfury and Nova lines push the technology to its limits, risking catastrophic **Overload**.

Plasma weapons come in several forms: **pistols** and **rifles** for direct fire, **casters** that project plasma in a wide cone, and **lances** that focus it into a penetrating beam.

PLASMA WEAPONS

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Range	FM	Inc	Special
Plasma Pistol	2	*ƒ 800*	5+D8	8	1 (L)	1	Short	S	5	
Plasma Rifle	2	*ƒ 1200*	5+D8	8	1 (M)	2	Medium	SA 3	5	
Plasma Caster	3	*ƒ 3000*	6+D10	12	2 (M)	2	Cone 6	S	7	
Plasma Lance	3	*ƒ 3500*	8+D12	16	3 (H)	2	Line 20	S	8	Heavy
Plasma Pistol, Sunfury	4	*ƒ 6000*	7+D12	14	1 (L)	1	Short	S	9	
Plasma Rifle, Sunfury	4	*ƒ 7000*	8+2D12	15	2 (M)	2	Short	S	10	Overload
Plasma Cannon, Sunfury	4	*ƒ 8000*	9+3D10	18	4 (H)	2	Short	S	11	Overload, Heavy
Plasma Caster, Nova	5	*ƒ 10000*	7+2D12	16	3 (M)	2	Cone 8	S	13	
Plasma Lance, Nova	5	*ƒ 12000*	9+3D10	18	4 (H)	2	Line 25	S	14	Heavy
Cœur d'Étoile	6	*Unique*	17+3D10	34	5 (H)	2	Long	S	18	Heavy

Jet Weapons

Jet weapons — sometimes called gyrojets — fire miniature self-propelled rockets. At lower tiers they are simple kinetic projectiles; at higher tiers the rockets carry explosive warheads. All jet weapons are fully automatic, laying down a devastating volume of fire. Jet weapons deal **Rending** damage. Higher-tier jet weapons with the Explosive keyword deal their damage in a small blast around the point of impact.

JET WEAPONS

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Range	FM	Inc	Special
Construct Chaingun	1	*ƒ 500*	8+D8	0	3 (H)	1	Medium	FA 3	5	Heavy
Lantern Jetgun	3	*ƒ 2200*	7+D12	0	1 (L)	1	Long	FA 3	8	
Dragon Guard Combo Jet	3	*ƒ 3500*	12+2D10	0	2½ (H)	1	Medium	FA 3	6	Explosive
Jet Pistol, Annihilator	4	*ƒ 5400*	8+2D8	0	½ (L)	1	Short	FA 4	9	Explosive
Jetgun, Annihilator	4	*ƒ 6000*	12+2D10	0	2 (M)	2	Medium	FA 3	10	Explosive

Magnetic Weapons

Magnetic weapons use electromagnetic coils to accelerate solid projectiles to extreme velocities. The resulting impact is devastating — a raw transfer of kinetic energy that hits like a sledgehammer. All magnetic weapons deal **Impact** damage and have the **Reliable** keyword, as the firing mechanism has no chemical propellant to misfire. Their inherent Penetration comes from sheer velocity rather than heat.

MAGNETIC WEAPONS

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Range	FM	Inc	Special
Sudassi Pattern Light Railgun	2	*ƒ 1200*	9+2D8	0	3 (H)	2	Long	S	8	Heavy
Magnetic Rifle, Gauss	4	*ƒ 5400*	15+D8	5	1 (M)	2	Long	FA 3	10	
Magnetic Sniper Rifle, Gauss	4	*ƒ 6000*	25+D10	5	3 (H)	2	Very Long	S	11	Heavy
Moonlight Railgun	6	*Unique*	14+2D12	0	2 (M)	2	Medium	S	18	
Silence	6	*Unique*	35+2D6	0	2 (M)	2	Medium	S	18	

Flame Weapons

Flame weapons project streams or bursts of burning material — promethium gel, magmatic compound, or alchemical accelerant. Unlike plasma weapons, which fire discrete bolts, flame weapons produce continuous streams of fire that saturate an area. All flame weapons deal **Thermal** damage and have the **Burning** keyword. They lack the armor-piercing properties of plasma, but their area coverage makes them devastating against groups of lightly armored targets.

FLAME WEAPONS

Name	Tier	Price	Damage	Pen	Bulk	Hands	Range	FM	Inc	Special
Magmatic Pistol	3	*ƒ 2000*	11+D4	0	1 (L)	1	Short	S	6	
Dragon Guard Flamethrower	3	*ƒ 2500*	9+2D8	0	1 (M)	1	Cone 8	S	7	

ARMOR

Name	Tier	Price	Armor	Ward	Evasion	Bulk	Charge	Profile
Midnight Combat Suit	1	*ƒ 200*	3	3	+1	1	1	C
Hunter-Killer Combat Suit	1	*ƒ 250*	4	3	+1	½	0	C
Mistwalker Robes	1	*ƒ 300*	3	6	+1	1	2	0
Sudassi-Pattern Construct Frame	1	*ƒ 500*	7	5	−2	5	2	C+P
Black Leather Combat Suit	2	*ƒ 600*	4	4	+2	2	0	C
Synweave Nightcamo Cloak	2	*ƒ 800*	0	1	+2	½	2	0
Warmage Robes	2	*ƒ 1000*	5	8	+1	1	3	0
Flak Vest	2	*ƒ 500*	6	1	−2	2	0	P
Zahak-Pattern Serpent Frame	2	*ƒ 1200*	8	5	0	3	3	C+P
Sudassi-Pattern Artillery Frame	2	*ƒ 1500*	8	11	−2	5	3	C+P
Infiltrator Bodysuit	3	*ƒ 2000*	8	5	+1	1	1	C
Battlemage Vestments	3	*ƒ 2500*	8	10	0	2	3	0
Dragon Guard Power Armor	3	*ƒ 3000*	15	10	−4	5	1	C+P
Venerant Robes	4	*ƒ 5000*	9	20	0	1	4	0
Midnight Suit, Thermal Camo	4	*ƒ 5500*	13	9	+2	1	1	C
Carapace Suit, Perfector Mk V	4	*ƒ 5000*	19	12	−1	3	1	P
Faerie Battleplate, Crystalline	4	*ƒ 6500*	25	19	−4	5	3	C+P
Shadowweave Mantle	5	*ƒ 10000*	11	8	+2	2	3	0
Perfector Mk VI Exosuit	5	*ƒ 12000*	15	10	−1	4	2	C+P
Titan Frame, Mk III	5	*ƒ 15000*	24	16	−3	6	1	C+P
Coldlight Robes	6	*Unique*	10	25	+2	1	4	0
Moonlight Combat Suit	6	*Unique*	18	10	+3	2	3	C
Vanth's Sypharion	6	*Unique*	15	15	+3	1	3	C

CATALYSTS

Name	Tier	Price	Type	Class	Bulk	Charge	Damage	Increment
Soul Crystal	1	*ƒ 200*	Arcane	Light	0	2	4+D6	5
Amber Rod	1	*ƒ 350*	Arcane	Medium	1	2	8+D3	8
Angel Mask	1	*ƒ 300*	Psychic	Medium	0	3	5+D8	8
Prana Crystal	1	*ƒ 250*	Psychic	Light	0	2	2+D6	5
Blackbone Staff	2	*ƒ 800*	Arcane	Medium	½	1½	9+D8	9
Polybind Staff	3	*ƒ 2500*	Arcane	Medium	1	2½	12+D10	11
Memento Mori	4	*ƒ 5000*	Psychic	Light	0	2	8+2D8	11
Caesium Rod	5	*Unique*	Psychic	Medium	2	3	23+D10	16
Moonray	6	*Unique*	Arcane	Medium	1	4	27+2D8	18
Serpent Staff	6	*Unique*	Psychic/Divine	Medium	2	5	18+3D10	17

RELIQUARIES

Name	Tier	Price	Class	Bulk	Charge	Damage	Increment	Will
The Princess' Locket	1	*ƒ 300*	Light	0	2	4+D6	5	3
Battlefield Dust	1	*ƒ 300*	Light	0	2	3+D8	5	3
Kharu's Ember	1	*ƒ 250*	Light	0	1	4+D3	5	2

CONSUMABLES — GRENADES

Name	Tier	Type	Bulk	Range	Effect	Cost
Acid Grenade	0	Grenade	¼	Burst 1/10	4+D10 Acid damage	*ƒ 100*
Frag Grenade	1	Grenade	¼	Burst 1/10	6+D3 damage, DC 2	*ƒ 150*
AP Grenade	1	Grenade	½	5	8+D3 damage, Pen 3	*ƒ 300*
Flashbang Grenade	2	Grenade	¼	Burst 2/10	Dazed + Blinded 1 round (D4 Stamina negates)	*ƒ 300*

CONSUMABLES — POTIONS & DRAUGHTS

Name	Tier	Type	Bulk	Range	Effect	Cost
Red Healing Potion	1	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 1D6+6 HP	*ƒ 250*
Ether Flask	1	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 2D4+10 Focus	*ƒ 250*
Regeneration Draught	2	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 2D4+4 HP per round for 3 rounds	*ƒ 500*
Potent Regeneration Draught	2	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 2D6+8 HP per round for 3 rounds	*ƒ 650*
Potent Ether Flask	2	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 2D6+18 Focus	*ƒ 500*
Scarlet Healing Potion	5	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 4D8+36 HP	*ƒ 1200*
Ether Concentrate	6	Potion	¼	Self/Touch	Recover 5D10+40 Focus	*ƒ 1800*

CONSUMABLES — SPECIAL

Name	Tier	Type	Bulk	Range	Effect	Cost
Revitalization Charge	0	Special	¼	5 squares	Revive a dead Immortal at full HP and Focus	*ƒ 5000*
Pure Land Water	5	Special	¼	Self/Touch	Regain 5 EP	*ƒ 12000*

REAGENTS & MATERIALS

Name	Tier	Bulk	Effect	Cost
Alchemical Reagents (Common)	2	¼	1 Magnitude for Ritual or Alchemy checks	*ƒ 600*
Alchemical Reagents (Rare)	2	¼	3 Magnitude for Ritual or Alchemy checks	*ƒ 2000*
Alchemical Reagents (Precious)	4	¼	6 Magnitude for Ritual or Alchemy checks	*ƒ 4500*
Prima Materia, Vial	6	¼	Legendary crafting ingredient; glows with inner power	—*
Materia Nigra, Vial	6	¼	Corrupted Prima Materia; ingredient for some Legendary Rituals. Corrupts lesser rituals	—*
Materia Rubrior, Vial	6	¼	Realized Prima Materia; ingredient for some Legendary Rituals. Worth 20 Magnitude	—*

**Prima Materia and its derivatives are extraordinarily rare and cannot ordinarily be purchased. They must be found, won, or created through Legendary Rituals.*

GENERAL EQUIPMENT

Name	Bulk	Cost	Effect
Rope (50 ft)	1	*ƒ 10*	+2d to Athletics checks for climbing when secured
Grappling Hook	½	*ƒ 25*	Allows rope to be thrown and anchored at range
Climbing Kit	2	*ƒ 50*	+2d to Athletics checks for climbing; prevents falls on 1 failed check
Camping Kit	3	*ƒ 30*	Tent, bedroll, fire starter. Required for comfortable rest in the field
Healer's Kit (10 uses)	1	*ƒ 100*	Required to perform Alchemy checks for healing. Each use expended per patient
Alchemy Kit	3	*ƒ 200*	Required to perform Alchemy checks and brew potions
Electronics Kit	2	*ƒ 150*	Required to perform Electronics checks
Magitek Kit	2	*ƒ 200*	Required to perform Magitek checks. Charge: 2
Lantern	½	*ƒ 5*	Bright light in 10 squares, dim light in 20
Rations (1 week)	1	*ƒ 10*	Sufficient food for one person for seven days
Binoculars	½	*ƒ 50*	+2d to Scrutiny checks at long range
Comm Unit	¼	*ƒ 100*	Encrypted short-range communication (range: 5 km)
Lockpick Set	¼	*ƒ 75*	Required to pick mechanical locks. +2d to Infiltration checks for locks
Manacles	½	*ƒ 30*	D6 Athletics to break free

Item Descriptions

Power Field Parry Dagger

Tier 4 Dagger; Powered

This dagger grants a +4 equipment bonus to parry checks.

Memento Mori

Tier 4 Psychic Catalyst; Time, Fate

An amulet carved in the form of a miniature human skull. The Dark-Elven inscription reads 'Remember thou, o mage, that one day thou, too, shalt face oblivion'.

The Memento Mori grants its wielder a +2 equipment bonus to manifesting Psychic powers. The bonus increases to +5 for Time and Fate powers.

Hoarfrost

Tier 5 Medium Sword; Cold

A longsword of pale blue steel, rimed with frost that never melts.

Hoarfrost is a +2 Masterwork Rimebound Longsword. It has the following traits:

Rimebound Blade: Hoarfrost deals an additional 7+D12 Cold damage on hit, reduced by Ward (but not Armor). The listed damage in the weapon table is the physical component only; the total effective damage is 14+2D12 split between physical and magical defenses.

Unmelting Edge: Attacks with this weapon gain a +2 equipment bonus to their accuracy.

Void Blade

Tier 5 Legendary Katana; Void

The Void Blade is a +1 Masterwork Spacerender Souldrinker Katana. It has the following traits:

Spacerender: The Void Blade has a reach of 2.

Soul Drain: A target hit by the Void Blade must make a D6 Potential save. On failure, the target loses 1 EP and 15+D10 Focus.

Nowhere Edge: *(Legendary.)* The wielder of this katana gains access to the Wounds from Nowhere legendary power.

WOUNDS FROM NOWHERE — INNATE 5

VOID

Prerequisites:

- You must be wielding the Void Blade.

Range: 1 within 15
Difficulty: 7
Cost: 2 Increments
AP: 2
Resistance: No (Ward applies)
Effect: The target must make a D8 Potential save; on failure, it takes 300% damage, ignoring armor. On success: it takes 100% damage. Whether the check fails or succeeds, the Void Blade cannot be used until the end of your next turn after you attempt to manifest this power, when it returns to your hand.

Poynting Rad-Fleche

Tier 5 Masterwork Pistol; Radiation, Poison, Sidearm

A heavy pistol chambered for depleted uranium flechettes. The weapon is warm to the touch and faintly hums when loaded.

The Poynting Rad-Fleche is a +1 Masterwork conventional pistol. It has the following traits:

DU Fleche-Rounds: The heavy metal flechettes fired by this weapon have a tendency to burst into flame. When this weapon strikes a target whose Armor value exceeds the weapon's Penetration, the weapon deals an additional 5+2D10 Thermal damage.

Toxic Rounds: The flechettes fired by this gun are both radioactive and highly toxic. A target hit by this weapon must make a D7 Stamina save; on failure, it is Weakened (8) and takes 15 Chemical damage per round (save ends both).

Caesium Rod

Tier 5 Psychic Catalyst; Time

A rod of radioactive caesium, encased in a protective sheet of rune-etched lead glass. The resonance of the metal core enhances this catalyst's power in manifesting Time powers.

Resonant Frequency: This rod grants the wielder a +3 equipment bonus to manifesting Psychic powers, increasing to +6 for Time powers.

Kazykly

Tier 6 Legendary Spear; Blood, Shadow, Two-handed, Reach

Kazykly is a Legendary +2 Masterwork Cursebringer Bloodthirst Lance. It has the following traits:

Bloodthirst: The weapon hungers for the blood of its foes. If Kazykly successfully deals damage to a living target, the wielder gains a +2 bonus to the next attack with the weapon.

Cursebringer: The weapon brings doom to anything it strikes. If Kazykly successfully deals damage to a target, the target must make a D7 Potential save. On failure, it takes a −2 curse penalty to all of its rolls (save ends).

Reach: This weapon has a range of 3, but it cannot strike directly adjacent targets.

The Lord Impaler: *(Legendary.)* Kazykly grants its wielder the Forest of Corpses unique power.

Moonlight Shortsword

Tier 6 Masterwork Shortsword; Moonlight

The Moonlight Shortsword is a +2 Masterwork Moontouched Bloodthirst Shortsword. It has the following traits:

Moontouched: A target hit by this sword is surrounded by a halo of moonlight that makes it easier to hit. Any attacks against the afflicted target gain a +2 bonus until the end of the wielder's next turn; additionally, the halo cancels the effects of invisibility for this duration.

Bloodthirst: The weapon hungers for the blood of its foes. If this sword successfully deals damage to a living target, the wielder gains a +2 bonus to the next attack with the weapon.

Silence

Tier 6 Legendary Sniper Rifle; Blood, Moonlight

On the field where bloody battle had raged, there reigned a great silence.

Silence is a Legendary +2 Masterwork Moontouched Bloodthirst Sniper Rifle. It has the following traits:

Moontouched: A target hit by a shot from Silence is surrounded by a halo of moonlight that makes it easier to hit. Any attacks against the afflicted target gain a +2 bonus until the end of the wielder's next turn; additionally, the halo cancels the effects of invisibility for this duration.

Bloodthirst: If Silence successfully deals damage to a living target, the wielder gains a +2 bonus to the next attack with the weapon.

Piercing Silence: *(Legendary.)* Shots from this weapon are magically silenced and cannot be detected by auditory means outside of a radius of 5 meters from the weapon itself. Additionally, a target struck by Silence must make a D6 Potential check or be silenced (save ends). A target killed by a shot from Silence fails this check automatically.

Moonlight Railgun

Tier 6 Masterwork Sniper Rifle; Blood, Moonlight

The Moonlight Railgun is a +2 Masterwork Moontouched Bloodthirst Sniper Rifle. It shares the Moontouched and Bloodthirst traits with its legendary counterpart Silence.

Coldlight Robes

Tier 6 Masterwork Light Armor; Robe, Ice, Light

The priests of Iyalan specialized in spinning the silver light of the moon into magical threads, cold to the touch as silver, yet sheer as silk.

Moonsilver: These robes grant the wearer a +3 bonus to casting Ice and Moonlight spells.

Aura of Cold: In battle, these robes generate a vortex of cold air. The vortex is an Aura 1; any creature that enters or starts its turn in the aura takes 20 Cold damage. Suppressing or reactivating this aura is a free action, but can only be done once per round.

Sheer Reflection: In moonlight, the robes become suffused with magical power. Their Ward and Evasion bonuses increase to 30 and +5 respectively; additionally, the casting bonuses increase to +5 each.

Moonlight Combat Suit

Tier 6 Masterwork Light Armor; Moonlight

Branded with the sigil of the Heirs, this masterwork combat suit was made for one of the Blood Moon's Oathpledged.

This suit is a +2 Lightbender Deflecting Synscale combat suit.

Masterwork Synscale: The overlapping plates of ultra-thin material provide excellent protection and hide the wearer's physical and magical emissions. The wearer gains a +4d bonus to subterfuge checks to avoid detection by any senses, including lifesense and magicsense, other than smell.

Light Bender: This suit bends the light around it. When fighting in bright light, its Evasion bonus increases by 1.

Deflecting: The synscales are magically treated. When the wearer is targeted by an area-effect spell or magical ability, the suit grants the wearer light cover against that effect.

Moonlight Blessing: In moonlight, as a 1 AP action, the wearer can spend 2 EP to become invisible to all senses for the scene or while they remain in the moonlight.

Vanth's Sypharion

Tier 6 Legendary Light Armor

This set of armor was once owned by Vanth, shadow of the midnight gates. Seemingly composed of the actual black scales of some monstrous serpent, it does not provide the protection of heavier materias, but its magical powers more than make up for it.

Shadowscale: The scales attenuate the presence of the wearer. The wearer gains a +5d bonus to subterfuge checks made to avoid detection by any senses, including supernatural ones. Its Evasion bonus increases to +5 in low light or darkness.

Keratin Point: The scales are artfully arranged to present very few flat surfaces, deflecting a great proportion of incoming thrusts. The wearer gains cover against attacks dealing piercing damage.

Slough Off: *(Legendary.)* When damaged, the armor can expel a thin layer of skin, like the moult of a snake. Once per round, when hit by an attack, a wearer possessing the Fey Jaunt ability can use it to escape the attack, leaving behind a husk of sloughed-off skin. The attack affects the husk instead.

Moonray

Tier 6 Legendary Staff; Arcane, Cold, Moonlight

Legendary staff of Iyalan, cast from millions of strands of solid moonlight. The staff is cold to the touch and smooth like glass, emanating a faint silver glow.

Moonray is a Legendary +2 Masterwork Resonating Manabind Staff.

Resonating: Moonray becomes more efficient at channeling magical energy with every spell it casts in quick succession. For every spell channeled through Moonray on a given turn, its casting bonuses increase by 1, up to a maximum of +6/+9.

Manabind: Moonray grants a +6 bonus to counterspelling. If Moonray is used to perform a successful counterspell, the wielder recovers Focus equal to the cost of the countered spell.

Solid Moonlight: *(Legendary.)* Moonray grants a +4 bonus to casting Arcane spells. This bonus increases to +7 for Ice and Moonlight spells.

Serpent Staff

Tier 6 Catalyst; Psychic, Divine

A staff shaped like a winding snake, carved from green-lacquered wood and topped with a glowing green gemstone held between the serpent's teeth. An eerie power emanates from it.

The Serpent Staff is a Legendary Masterwork Psychic catalyst.

Psychic: Grants a +4 equipment bonus to manifesting Psychic powers, and a +7 bonus to manifesting Fate powers.

Mana Toxin: Powers manifested using this staff apply a −3 penalty to attempts to counterspell them. When a power is successfully manifested through this catalyst, the wielder gains an Aura 10 until the beginning of their next turn; attempts to cast Arcane spells in this aura suffer a −4 penalty.

Vessel of the World Serpent: *(Legendary.)* The Serpent Staff is also a Reliquary of the World Serpent (Domains: Life, Poison, Serpent; Will 8; Favor 3).

Combat

Azal jalē vahttan
Iryane niboltvānhē
Nidaumave avorhōyō
Narvim iluiyamgo vatauhanyō
Aivašti arvahvamdō
Avahmāš nyašbittī!

As hero of the Azalmen
Truly thou art now remade
In thy hands, our hope we ken
Our silver-gleaming blade
With godly fire burn them then
Who sought to be our foes!

— The Lay of Ingin

Sometimes, characters' conflicts cannot be resolved in a way other than coming to blows. These situations are handled by the combat rules.

How combat works

When characters find themselves in combat, they enter into **structured time** - because the action being described usually happens over the course of just a few seconds, it is important to track the time in detail. To do so, each combat scene is modeled as a cyclical sequence of rounds.

The order of combat

Combat is structured time (see *Structured Time* in the Core Rules chapter). Each combat scene is divided into rounds, and the order of turns within each round is determined by initiative. For the core rules on rounds, initiative ticks, and action points, refer to that section.

Surprise

A combat begins when the first hostile action is taken or declared.

If a combat begins and some participants are not aware of their opponents, they are surprised. A surprised combatant is **exposed** until they take their first turn.

If this happens, the aware combatants may act in a special surprise round before the combat proper begins. During the surprise round, only aware combatants may act; surprised combatants skip their turns.

Extreme Initiative and Surprise

A combatant that achieves Extreme Initiative takes their first turn during the surprise round. If this happens, they may treat all other combatants as surprised during their first turn, even if they would not otherwise be surprised.

A combatant that already has surprise and rolls an initiative higher than 99 also receives this benefit, in effect obtaining two surprise turns.

The Grid

Combat in Ashen takes place on a square grid. Each square represents a 1-meter by 1-meter area. Miniatures, tokens, or other markers are used to track the positions of creatures and objects on the grid.

Creature Size

A creature's size determines how many squares it occupies. A creature of Size X occupies a space of X by X squares. Most player characters are Size 1. Larger creatures — such as a warhorse (Size 2) or a dragon (Size 3) — occupy correspondingly larger spaces.

Facing

Creatures do not have a facing. A creature can see and act in all directions equally unless an effect specifically limits its field of vision.

Movement

During combat, creatures move across the grid by spending movement from their Movement Speed. A creature's Movement Speed determines how many squares it can traverse with a single move action.

Orthogonal and Diagonal Movement

Moving one square in a cardinal direction (north, south, east, or west) costs 1 square of movement. Moving one square diagonally costs 1.5 squares of movement, rounded down. In practice, this means that every second diagonal step in a single move costs 2 squares of movement instead of 1. The count of diagonal steps resets at the start of each move action.

> *Example:* A character with Movement Speed 5 takes a move action. They step diagonally (1 square spent), then diagonally again (2 squares spent — the second diagonal costs 2), then move north (1 square spent), then diagonally (1 square spent). They have spent 5 squares total and their move ends.

Difficult and Treacherous Terrain

Some squares contain terrain that impedes movement.

- **Difficult terrain** costs 2 squares of movement per square entered. A creature cannot charge through difficult terrain.
- **Treacherous terrain** costs 2 squares of movement per square entered, as difficult terrain. Additionally, a creature moving through treacherous terrain must make an Acrobatics or Athletics check (difficulty 3) each round of movement or fall prone.

These costs stack with diagonal movement costs. A diagonal step into difficult terrain costs 3 squares of movement on an odd step and 4 on an even step.

Moving Through Other Creatures

You can move through a square occupied by an allied creature, but you cannot end your turn in that square. Moving through an ally's space does not cost extra movement.

You cannot move through a square occupied by a hostile creature unless you have an ability that specifically allows it (such as the Vault advance). Creatures may always move through the space of a creature at least 2 sizes larger or smaller than them.

Occupied Squares

A creature cannot voluntarily end its movement in a square occupied by another creature. If an effect forces a creature into an occupied square, the displaced creature is shunted to the nearest unoccupied square of its choice.

Prone Movement

A prone creature can only crawl. Crawling uses the creature's land movement speed at half its normal rate (rounded down). Standing up from prone costs 1 AP.

Movement Types

A creature may have several different movement types, each with its own speed. When you take a move action, you choose one of your available movement types and move up to that speed. You cannot mix movement types within a single move action — to switch from one type to another, you must take a separate move action (at the usual escalating AP cost).

The following movement types exist:

- **Land** is the default movement type. All creatures have a land speed unless otherwise noted. A creature's Movement Speed refers to its land speed unless a different type is specified.
- **Climb** allows a creature to scale vertical surfaces without making skill checks. A creature with a climb speed can move along walls and ceilings at that speed.
- **Swim** allows a creature to move through water without making skill checks. A creature with a swim speed can move freely in any direction while submerged.
- **Fly** allows a creature to move through the air. A flying creature can gain and lose altitude freely during its movement.
- **Burrow** allows a creature to tunnel through earth and loose rock. A burrowing creature cannot normally pass through solid stone unless its description says otherwise.
- **Teleport** allows a creature to instantaneously relocate. Teleport movement does not provoke opportunity attacks, ignores difficult and treacherous terrain, and is not blocked by obstacles or creatures — but requires line of sight to the destination unless otherwise specified.

A creature without a climb or swim speed can still attempt to climb or swim by making skill checks (see *Acrobatics* and *Athletics*), using its land speed at half rate. A creature without a fly speed cannot fly.

Elevation and Vertical Distance

When moving vertically — whether climbing, flying, swimming, or otherwise — each meter of elevation costs 1 square of movement, just as horizontal distance does. Diagonal movement in three dimensions follows the same rounding rules as on a flat grid.

> *Example:* A swimming creature with Swim Speed 8 wants to dive diagonally: 4 meters forward and 4 meters down. The diagonal distance is approximately 6 meters, so the movement costs 6 squares of its swim speed.

Forced Movement

Some powers and effects push, pull, or slide creatures involuntarily. Forced movement follows these rules:

- **Push** moves the target in a straight line directly away from the source of the effect.
- **Pull** moves the target in a straight line directly toward the source of the effect.
- **Slide** moves the target in any direction.

Forced movement is measured in squares. It does not consume the moved creature's movement speed, and it does not require the moved creature to spend AP. Forced movement **does** provoke opportunity attacks.

Forced movement cannot move a creature through solid obstacles. If a creature is pushed or pulled into an obstacle, it stops in the last unoccupied square before the obstacle.

Actions and Action Points

In combat (or other structured game time), everytime you wish to do something, you must take an action to do it. Actions consume action points; every creature has a set number of **Action Points (AP)**, usually 4 of them. On every creature's turn, that creature can take actions by spending action points; when a creature is out of action points, it can no longer take additional actions and must end its turn. On the start of its turn, a creature recovers all its spent action points. Unspent ones are lost - they do not carry over between turns.

Reactions

Reactions are special actions that can be taken when it is not your turn. Reactions do not cost AP. Each character can take one reaction per round; this reaction resets at the start of the character's turn. Some powers or advances may grant additional reactions.

Triggering Reactions

Each reaction specifies a **trigger** — the event that allows you to use it. Reactions may trigger during different phases of an attack or action:

- **Target selection** — triggers when you are chosen as a target (e.g., Fire Overwatch triggers when you are targeted by a charge).
- **Resolution** — triggers when the attack hits or misses (e.g., certain defensive abilities trigger on being hit).
- **Damage** — triggers when you would take damage or be affected (e.g., Dive triggers when you would be damaged by an area effect).

You may only use a reaction whose trigger matches the current phase.

Reaction Chains

A reaction can trigger further reactions from other creatures, forming a chain. However, a creature whose action started the chain cannot also react to something within it. In other words, each creature may only appear once in a reaction chain — either as the original actor or as a reactor, never both.

For example: you move away from an enemy, provoking an opportunity attack. You cannot parry the opportunity attack, because your action started the chain. But if an ally uses an attack and an enemy uses a reaction to interfere, you *can* yourself use another reaction in response to that reaction — your action did not start the chain.

Example: Kael and his ally Ârwân are fighting a dangerous Psychic. Kael attacks the psychic with him sword. In response, the psychic invokes *Twist of Fate* as a reaction to make him miss. Ârwân, who is himself a psychic, counterspells the *Twist of Fate*, and Kael's attack lands normally.

Interrupts and Responses

Reactions come in two types:

- **Interrupt** — the reaction resolves *before* the triggering action completes. If the interrupt removes the conditions that made the triggering action possible (for example, moving out of range), the triggering action is wasted without effect.
- **Response** — the reaction resolves immediately, but does not inherently stop the triggering action. The triggering action continues after the response resolves, unless the response's outcome makes it impossible (for example, a creature killed by an opportunity attack does not continue moving).

A reaction's type is noted in its description. If a reaction does not specify, it is a response.

Universal Reactions

Every character automatically has access to the following reactions.

Counterspell

When another creature within 20 squares uses a magic power of a type that you can currently cast (for example, an Arcane spell while you are wielding an Arcane catalyst), you can counterspell as an interrupt. To counterspell, roll the same check as the one used to cast the spell; if you score an equal number or more successes than the original caster, their spell fizzles without effect.

Dive

When you would be damaged by an area attack or magical effect, you can attempt to dive out of the affected area (response). Count the minimum number of squares you would need to move to exit the area. If that distance is more than 3 squares, you cannot Dive. Otherwise, roll your Dodge characteristic against a difficulty of 3 per square you must cross. If you succeed, you move to the nearest unoccupied square outside the area and are unaffected by the attack. This movement does not provoke opportunity attacks.

Fire Overwatch

If you are wielding a ranged weapon and are targeted for a charge, you can make a strike against the charging enemy (interrupt). If the strike kills or stuns the charger, the charge ends immediately.

Opportunity Attack

When you are wielding a melee weapon, and another creature takes a move action that passes through your weapon reach and does not end next to you, you can immediately make a strike against it (response).

Strikes and Attack Powers

When a character attacks in combat, the basic unit is the **strike**. A strike is a single attack roll against a target: roll your attack characteristic (Martial for melee or thrown weapons, Marksmanship for ranged weapons) and count successes. If your successes equal or exceed the target's Evasion, the strike hits and you roll damage.

An **attack power** is any power that includes one or more strikes as part of its effect. Whether an attack power scores multiple hits depends on the power itself.

Some effects allow a creature to "make a strike" rather than use an attack power. A strike always produces at most one hit, regardless of excess successes.

Every character has access to the following attack power:

BASIC ATTACK — INNATE 0

ATTACK | MARTIAL | WEAPON

AP: 2
Effect: Make a strike against a target within your weapon's range. For every [hit rate] successes scored above the target's Evasion, this attack scores one additional hit. Each hit deals the weapon's damage separately.

Example: Kael attacks a Warboar (Evasion 5) with a dagger (hit rate 2). He rolls his Martial characteristic and scores 8 successes. The first hit lands because he met the Evasion of 5. He has 3 excess successes; at a hit rate of 2, that's 1 additional hit (3 ÷ 2 = 1, rounded down). Kael hits twice and rolls damage for each hit separately.

Resolving an Attack

When you use an attack power or make a strike, follow these steps:

1. **Choose a target.** Select a target within your weapon's range. You must have line of sight to the target unless the power states otherwise.
2. **Roll the attack.** Roll your attack characteristic — Martial for melee and thrown weapons, Marksmanship for ranged weapons. Apply any bonuses and penalties from powers, conditions, concealment, and other effects to determine your final dice pool.
3. **Determine if you hit.** Compare your total successes to the target's Evasion. If your successes equal or exceed the target's Evasion, the attack hits. If not, it misses. If the target has cover, a hit triggers a cover save before proceeding — if the save succeeds, the attack misses.
4. **Determine the number of hits.** If the attack power scores multiple hits (such as Basic Attack), divide the excess successes by the weapon's hit rate, rounding down. Add 1 for the initial hit. A strike or an attack power that does not specify multiple hits always scores exactly one hit.
5. **Roll damage.** Roll the weapon's damage once for each hit. Each hit deals damage independently.
6. **Apply defenses.** For each hit, reduce the damage by the target's defenses (see *Damage* below). The attacker's weapon Penetration reduces the target's effective Armor for that attack. Damage cannot be reduced below zero.

7. **Apply damage.** Subtract the remaining damage from the target's Hit Points.

Example: Kael charges a Warboar (Evasion 5, Armor 4) with a longsword (damage 9+D8, Penetration 2, hit rate 3). Charging grants him +4d to his Martial characteristic of 7, so he rolls 11 dice and scores 9 successes. The attack hits (9 ≥ 5). He has 4 excess successes at hit rate 3: that's 1 additional hit, for 2 hits total. He rolls 9+D8 twice, getting 14 and 12. The Warboar's effective Armor is 4 − 2 Pen = 2, so the hits deal 12 and 10 damage respectively.

Damage

When a character or creature takes damage, that damage has a **type** and a **source**. The type determines what kind of energy or force is involved; the source determines whether the damage is mundane or magical in origin. Together, these determine which defenses apply.

Damage Types

- **Ablative:** Damage inflicted by weapons or effects that strip material from the target in layers, from sand-blasters to disintegration rays.
- **Chemical:** Damage inflicted by strong acids, poisons, and other corrosive or toxic substances.
- **Cold:** Damage caused by freezing effects, whether from Ice magic, cold-gas cannons, or environmental exposure.
- **Impact:** Blunt force damage. Clubs, falling rocks, concussive blasts, and magical force effects all deal Impact damage.
- **Lightning:** Damage dealt by electricity, whether natural, technological, or magical. *Lightning damage bypasses Armor.*
- **Psychic:** Damage dealt by effects that attack the mind or soul. Almost all sources of Psychic damage are magical. *Psychic damage bypasses Armor.*
- **Radiant:** Damage dealt by ionizing radiation. X-rays, radioactive materials, and similar sources cause Radiant damage. *Radiant damage bypasses Armor.*
- **Rending:** Cutting, tearing, and piercing damage. Blades, bullets, claws, and shrapnel all deal Rending damage. This is the most common damage type for conventional weapons.
- **Thermal:** Damage inflicted by extreme heat. Fire, plasma weapons, and heat lasers all cause Thermal damage.
- **Untyped:** Damage that has no elemental or physical classification. Flesh-warping magic, organ damage, and severe bleeding are typical sources. *Untyped damage bypasses Armor. It is not possible to have resistance to Untyped damage.*

Defenses Against Damage

Two statistics protect against incoming damage: **Armor** and **Ward**.

Armor reduces damage from all sources unless the damage type specifically bypasses it (Lightning, Psychic, Radiant, and Untyped bypass Armor). Armor represents physical toughness — worn protection, natural hide, or structural reinforcement. A weapon's **Penetration** value reduces the target's effective Armor against that weapon's attacks.

Ward reduces damage from **magical sources only**. If a spell, magical ability, or enchanted effect deals damage, Ward applies in addition to any other applicable defenses. A technological weapon that deals Thermal damage is reduced only by Armor; a fire spell that deals Thermal damage is reduced by both Armor and Ward. Some spells deal damage types that bypass Armor (such as Lightning or Psychic) — in these cases, Ward is the only defense.

Spells and magical powers generally specify in their description whether Armor applies, to avoid ambiguity.

Resistances

A creature may have **resistance** to one or more specific damage types. Resistance provides a flat reduction to damage of that type, applied after Armor and Ward. For example, a creature with Cold Resistance 5 reduces all Cold damage it takes by 5, after any reduction from Armor or Ward.

Resistances can come from racial traits, magical effects, enchanted equipment, or other sources. A creature cannot have resistance to Untyped damage.

Death and Revival

When a creature is reduced to 0 HP, they die. For a Deathless character, death is a severe setback but not the end — provided their body remains intact.

Dying as a Deathless

At the start of your next turn after dying, you may choose to spend 5 EP to revive. If you do, on the first turn in the round after you died, you return to life at full HP, standing in the square where you fell (or prone, if standing is not possible), and you immediately take a full turn with your normal AP. The regenerative surge is swift: a mangled corpse knits itself back together in moments, rising ready for vengeance. Mortals who witness this are often unnerved by the display.

You pay the 5 EP only if revival actually manifests. If an ally's revival power or a *Revitalization Charge* brings you back before your turn comes around, you revive without spending any EP of your own.

If you choose not to spend EP, cannot spend EP, or your body has been destroyed (see *The Fallen Body* below), your essence departs for your soul anchor and you begin reincorporating there. See *Death and Reincorporation* in the Exploration chapter.

Whether or not you choose to revive, both revival and discorporation occur on your turn in the round after you died. If your next turn after death is in the same round you died in, you skip that turn.

The Fallen Body

A dead Deathless leaves a body behind, which is a targetable object in the square where they fell. Allies and enemies alike may interact with it.

- **Healing has no effect.** HP-restoring effects do nothing to a corpse. Only revival effects — such as *Breath of Resurrection* or a *Revitalization Charge* — can return a dead Deathless to life without them spending EP.
- **Ongoing effects on the character end on death.** Conditions, sustained spells, concentration effects, and auras originating from the dead character

all cease. Effects emanating from worn or carried items, however, remain active.

- **The body can be dismembered.** A creature adjacent to the fallen body may take the **Dismember** action (2 AP) to mutilate it. Each use of this action delays the Deathless's next opportunity to spot-revive by 1 round. After the body has been dismembered three times, or if it is reduced to ash (for example by *Solar Flare*) or banished from the world (for example by *Banish*), the body is destroyed: the Deathless cannot spend EP to revive and must reincorporate at their soul anchor.

Dismembering a fallen Deathless is a valid tactic against hostile immortals — and an equally valid threat against your own party.

Melee Attacks

A melee attack uses the **Martial** characteristic (STR + AGI). Melee weapons can target creatures within their reach — typically adjacent squares (reach 1), though some weapons have greater reach.

Melee Hit Rates

A melee weapon's hit rate is determined by its weight class:

- **Light** melee weapons (daggers, gauntlets): hit rate **2**
- **Medium** melee weapons (longswords, maces, spears): hit rate **3**
- **Heavy** melee weapons (greatswords, mauls, halberds): hit rate **4**

Thrown Weapons

Some melee weapons can be thrown, using the **Martial** characteristic at range. A thrown weapon follows the ranged attack rules for range and penalties, but uses Martial rather than Marksmanship. A thrown weapon always scores at most one hit, regardless of its melee hit rate.

Ranged Attacks

A ranged attack uses the **Marksmanship** characteristic (DEX + PER). Ranged weapons have a listed range band that determines their effective range and the penalty for firing beyond it.

Range Bands

Each range band defines a **range increment** in squares:

Range Band	Increment
Short	10 squares
Medium	20 squares
Long	40 squares
Very Long	80 squares

A weapon can fire at targets within its first increment with no penalty. For each additional increment of distance beyond the first, the attacker takes a **−2d penalty** to the attack roll. If the penalty reduces the attacker's dice pool to zero, the shot automatically fails.

Example: Lira fires a rifle (Medium range, increment 20) at a target 55 squares away. The first 20 squares are free. The target is 35 squares beyond that — two additional increments (21–40 and 41–60). Lira takes a −4d penalty to her Marksmanship roll.

Fire Modes and Ranged Hit Rates

Ranged weapons have a **fire mode** that determines their hit rate:

- **Single shot (S):** The weapon fires one powerful shot. It scores at most **one hit** per attack, regardless of excess successes.
- **Semi-automatic (SA):** The weapon fires in controlled bursts. Hit rate is **3** (or **4** for heavy semi-automatic weapons).
- **Full automatic (FA):** The weapon fires a sustained stream. Hit rate is **2** for light and medium weapons, **3** for heavy weapons.

Heavy Ranged Weapons

Heavy ranged weapons (machine guns, cannons, sniper rifles) must be **braced** before they can be fired accurately. Firing a heavy weapon without bracing is called **hip-firing** and incurs a **−2d penalty** to the attack roll. A heavy weapon can be braced using the Brace action (1 AP).

Ammunition

Characters are assumed to carry sufficient standard ammunition for their weapons; tracking individual rounds is not required. The exception is weapons that fire specialized ammunition — such as rocket launchers or grenade launchers — where the ammunition itself determines the weapon's damage and effects. For these weapons, each shot consumes one unit of ammunition, and reloading costs **1 AP**.

Area Targets

Many powers and some weapons affect an area rather than a single target. An area is defined by its shape and size. All creatures and objects within the area are affected unless the power specifies otherwise (e.g., "all enemies in burst" excludes allies).

Shapes

Burst

A burst is a circular area centered on a point. A **Burst N** affects every square that is within N squares of movement from the origin square, using the standard movement rules (including the diagonal movement rounding rule). For example, a Burst 1 affects the 4 orthogonally adjacent squares; a Burst 2 also reaches the diagonal neighbors and the squares two steps away orthogonally.

A burst's range line reads **Burst N within R**, meaning the center point can be placed on any square within R squares of the caster. A **Close Burst N** is centered on the caster's own square and has no separate range.

Cone

A cone originates from the caster and expands outward. A **Cone N** extends N squares from the caster and widens by 1 square for every 2 squares of length

(rounded down). The caster chooses the direction of the cone when using the power. The cone's width at its origin is 1 square.

Line

A line originates from the caster and extends in a straight path. A **Line N** is N squares long and 1 square wide. The caster chooses the direction.

Wall

A wall is a contiguous line of squares placed within range. A **Wall N** consists of up to N squares arranged in any connected shape (each square must share a side with at least one other square in the wall). Walls are typically 1 square wide and block movement and line of sight unless the power states otherwise.

Resolving Area Attacks

Area attacks do not roll against individual targets' Evasion. Instead, the caster rolls their characteristic check against the power's difficulty. If the check succeeds, the power takes effect on every valid target in the area. Targets may then resist individually if the power grants a resistance check (typically Dodge against a set difficulty, or Dodge opposed by the caster's check result).

A creature that succeeds on its resistance check against an area attack either negates the effect entirely or reduces it, as specified by the power. The Dive reaction can also be used to escape an area attack entirely.

Area attacks never score multiple hits. Each affected target takes the power's listed damage once.

Cover

Terrain, structures, and even other creatures can provide cover when they stand between an attacker and its target.

To determine whether a target has cover, draw a straight line from any corner of the attacker's square to any corner of the target's square (or squares, for a large creature). If at least one such line passes through an obstacle that could grant cover, the target has cover. Whether that cover is light or heavy depends on the nature of the obstacle.

If all lines pass through the cover, and it is an obstacle that would grant heavy cover, such as a wall, then the cover is total.

- **Light cover** — roughly half of the target is obscured (e.g., a low wall, a tree trunk, or an ally standing in the way). When a hit is scored against a target in light cover, the target makes a cover save before the hit is applied. A cover save is a saving throw (roll 3 dice; 2 or more successes passes). If the save succeeds, the attack misses.
- **Heavy cover** — roughly two-thirds of the target is obscured (e.g., firing through an arrow slit, or a creature peeking around a corner). Heavy cover works like light cover, but the cover save requires only 1 success instead of 2.
- **Total cover** — the target is entirely obscured; there is no line of effect. A creature behind total cover cannot be targeted or affected by attacks at all.

Cover applies the same way regardless of whether the attack is single-target or an area effect.

Line of Effect

An area power must have **line of effect** from its origin point to each target — an unobstructed path that is not blocked by total cover. A creature behind total cover within an area is unaffected. Creatures behind light or heavy cover are affected but may benefit from their cover save as normal.

Actions during Combat

Every character has a large and varying set of actions available to take during combat.

Standard Actions (1 AP)

Brace
Disengage
Draw/Stash
Drop Prone
Stand Up
Take Aim

Standard Actions (2 AP)

Attack
Dash
Dismember
Use Item

Standard Actions (3 AP)

Charge

Standard Actions (Special)

Move
Use Skill
Use Power
Cast Spell

Reactions

Counterspell
Dive
Fire Overwatch
Opportunity Attack

Explanation of Actions

Special Actions

Move

When you take a move action, you can move up to your speed. Move actions cost progressively more action points as you take them; the first one costs 1, the second 2 and so on.

Use Item

You can use an action to make use of an item in your possession. The amount of action points required for this varies depending on the item; it is usually a standard action.

Use Power

You can use a combat power or magic spell available to you, consuming action points as specified in the power's description. Most powers can be used as a standard action, but some may also require a full action.

Use Skill

On occasion, you may wish to take an action in combat that requires a skill roll (such as using Acrobatics to run over a cable, using Shop to restart a stuck mechanism, etc.) The GM adjudicates the number of action points using a skill requires depending on the situation.

Minor Actions

Minor actions cost 1 AP each to perform.

Brace

You can brace a heavy weapon to stabilize it. This can mean propping it against a stable surface, or taking a more stable position to fire it from. Once you have braced a heavy weapon, you remain braced until you move it from the braced position. While you have your heavy weapon braced, you can fire it normally without the penalty that would otherwise apply to heavy weapons.

Command

If you are controlling a summoned creature, you can command it to take an action on your turn. The creature will follow your instructions to the best of its ability.

Disengage

When you are in melee combat, you can disengage to move one square in any direction of your choosing. This movement does not provoke attacks of opportunity.

Draw/Stash

As a minor action, you can draw a weapon or item you have equipped to wield it, or you can stash a weapon or item you are currently wielding.

Drop Prone

You can drop prone as a minor action. Doing so increases your evasion by 1 point. While you are prone, you can only crawl to move, reducing your land movement speed to half.

Take Aim

You can take aim at a target to increase your accuracy against it. When you do so, you can make your next ranged attack against the target with +2 automatic successes.

Standard Actions

Attack

You use an attack power. The default attack power available to every character is the Basic Attack described above. Other attack powers granted by advances or other abilities may be used instead.

Stand Up

If you are prone, you can stand up as a standard action.

Dash

You break into a sprint, moving up to double your movement speed. Unlike a normal move action, a Dash must be in a straight line. Movement during a Dash provokes opportunity attacks as normal.

Dismember

You mutilate the corpse of a fallen Deathless in an adjacent square, delaying their spot-revival. See *Death and Revival* for the full rules.

Full Actions

Charge

To take a charge, declare a target you can see. You must move toward that target in a straight line, moving up to twice your speed and ending your charge directly adjacent to your target. At the end of the charge, you can use a melee attack power. You gain a +4d power bonus to your Martial characteristic when you make attack rolls during a charge.

Saving Throws

Many effects and status conditions last until the affected creature "saves" against them. A saving throw is a simple roll made at the end of the affected creature's turn: roll 3 dice. If 2 or more dice show successes, the saving throw passes and the effect ends. If fewer than 2 successes are rolled, the effect persists until the creature's next turn, when they may try again.

Cover saves use the same mechanic but with a different success threshold depending on the type of cover (see Cover).

Note that a saving throw is not the same as a **resistance check**. A resistance check uses a specific characteristic (such as Stamina or Potential) against a difficulty set by the power. Resistance checks are made when the effect is first applied, to determine whether it takes hold at all. Saving throws are made afterward, at the end of each turn, to end an ongoing effect.

Status Conditions

Battles are fought with vicious means, and in the course of a fight, characters can not only suffer damage, but may be afflicted with status conditions as well. A list of them follows:

Blinded

A blinded character cannot see. While they are blinded, they lose their perception bonus to their Evasion and make all attack rolls at a -4 penalty.

Disoriented

A disoriented character does not know their position relative to their surroundings. Every time a disoriented character attempts to move, they must roll a scatter die. On a 10, they go in the direction of their choosing; otherwise, they move in the direction of the scatter die.

Stunned

A stunned character cannot take any actions. While Stunned, a creature is also Exposed.

Vulnerable

Attacks against a vulnerable creature deal their maximum damage.

Dazed

A dazed creature loses 1 AP and has their evasion halved.

Exposed

An exposed creature cannot take reactions and their dodge rating becomes 0.

Panicked

A panicked creature is in thrall to its fight or flight reflex. On its turn, it must use all its AP either to attack the object of its fear (it may use powers to do so) or to run away from it; it cannot do both or take any other actions.

Staggered

A staggered creature is both vulnerable and exposed.

Shred (x)

A shredded creature loses x armor. Unless otherwise specified, this effect lasts indefinitely (or at least until repaired).

Disrupt (x)

A disrupted creature loses x ward.

Slowed (x)

A slowed creature's movement speed is reduced by x.

Still

A still creature cannot expend focus. Any ability that would require focus cannot be used.

Prone

A prone creature has +1 Evasion against ranged attacks but −1 Evasion against melee attacks. A prone creature can only crawl, reducing its movement speed to half. Standing up from prone requires the Stand Up action (2 AP).

Immobilized

An immobilized creature cannot move by any means, including teleportation. It can still take all other actions normally.

Restrained

A restrained creature cannot move, takes a −2 penalty to Evasion, and makes all attack rolls at −2d.

Frightened (of X)

A frightened creature takes a −2d penalty on attack rolls and cannot willingly move closer to the source of its fear.

Weakened

A weakened creature makes all attack rolls at −2d.

Dominated

A dominated creature acts under the controller's direction on the controller's turn. It can only take basic actions (move, basic attack). At the end of each of the dominated creature's turns, it may attempt a saving throw to end the effect.

Exhausted

An exhausted creature takes a −2d penalty on all checks and has its movement speed halved.

Poisoned

A poisoned creature is suffering from a toxin. The specific effects of being Poisoned (ongoing damage, penalties, etc.) are defined by the power or effect that inflicted the condition. Poisoned can be removed by the Cleansing Light prayer, the Antidote recipe, or other effects that specifically remove the Poisoned condition.

Diseased

A diseased creature is afflicted by a magical or mundane illness. The specific effects of the Disease are defined by the power that inflicted it. Unless otherwise specified, healing received by a Diseased creature is halved. Disease can be removed by the Cleansing Light prayer or other effects that specifically remove Disease.

Bleeding

A bleeding creature has an open wound that continues to deal damage. The specific ongoing damage is defined by the power that inflicted the condition. Bleeding can be removed by any healing effect, by the Cleansing Light prayer, or by an Alchemy check (difficulty set by the GM).

Burning

A burning creature is on fire. The specific ongoing Thermal damage is defined by the power or effect that caused the condition. A burning creature or an adjacent ally can spend 1 AP to attempt to extinguish the flames (saving throw). Burning can also be removed by full immersion in water or similar effects.

Exploration

Ših karimmi, amawai, amawai
Kuyāni yān za urviranzā mai
Ašatawhānt hižung-čissa fīryai
Narwiv yāwhīyav šiyawa kawhai

We miss you, our homeland
How long we have not seen
Your cold snow-tipped mountain peaks
Shining silver against the blue expanse

— The Song of the Lost

The world of Ashen is vast and dangerous. Between battles, characters must navigate hostile terrain, endure the elements, manage their resources, and contend with the consequences of their immortal nature. This section provides rules for everything that happens outside of structured combat.

Overland Movement

Characters traveling overland cover distance based on their mode of transportation and the terrain they are crossing.

BASE TRAVEL SPEEDS

Mode	Distance/Day	Notes
On foot	40 miles	Standard marching pace
Mounted	80 miles	Horse or equivalent beast of burden
Vehicle (ground)	100 miles	Cart, carriage, or motorized ground vehicle
Skimmer	250–500 miles	Magical/mechanical hover vehicle; speed varies by model
Airship	300–600 miles	See Airship Combat section for details

TERRAIN MODIFIERS

Terrain	Speed Modifier	Examples
Road/Easy	Normal	Paved roads, open plains, well-maintained paths
Medium (no roads)	-25%	Light forest, grassland without paths, gentle hills
Difficult	-60%	Swamps, mountain passes, dense jungle, rubble-choked ruins
Harsh	-90%	Vertical climbs, the Thorn Forest, active volcanic terrain

Forced March

Characters can push beyond a normal day's travel (typically 8 hours of movement). For each additional hour of travel, each character must make an Endurance check (difficulty 4, increasing by 1 per additional hour). On failure, the character gains the Exhausted condition until they complete a rest.

Navigation

When traveling off established roads, the party must designate a navigator who makes an Investigate check at the start of each day. The difficulty depends on the terrain and conditions:

- Open terrain with clear landmarks: 2
- Forest or hills with limited visibility: 4
- Swamp, dense jungle, or featureless desert: 6
- Inclement weather: +2 to difficulty
- No map or prior knowledge of the area: +2 to difficulty

On failure, the party veers off course, losing 25% of the day's travel distance. On a critical failure (0 successes), the party becomes lost and must spend the following day reorienting.

Terrain

Terrain Types

Open terrain includes plains, roads, and cleared areas. Movement is unimpeded and visibility is excellent.

Forest provides natural concealment but slows movement. Light forest is medium terrain; dense forest is difficult terrain. Visibility is limited to short range.

Mountain terrain ranges from medium (foothills, established passes) to harsh (cliff faces, high peaks). Altitude above the treeline imposes a -1d penalty on all physical checks unless the character is acclimatized.

Swamp is difficult terrain. Characters must make Endurance checks (difficulty 4) each day of travel through swamp or risk contracting disease.

Desert is medium terrain by day and presents extreme heat hazards. Characters without adequate water must make Endurance checks (difficulty 4, increasing by 1 per day) or become Exhausted.

Arctic terrain is medium to difficult. Extreme cold requires adequate clothing or shelter; without it, characters take ongoing cold damage (GM-adjudicated).

Urban terrain varies. Intact cities are easy terrain on streets, but ruined or contested urban areas may be difficult terrain due to rubble, barricades, or hostile inhabitants.

Terrain Hazards

Difficult and treacherous terrain affect both tactical and overland movement. See *Difficult and Treacherous Terrain* in the Combat chapter for the full rules.

The Fog

The Fog is the defining feature of the world of Ashen. It is the raw power of creation, seeping from wounds torn in the fabric of the universe during the cataclysm. Devoid of the divine will that once guided it, the Fog is unpredictable and dangerous — spawning creatures, warping life, and saturating the land with ambient magical energy. It is called the Fog because in areas where it is dense, it clouds the air much like natural fog, reducing visibility — but the two are distinct phenomena and can coexist.

The Fog varies in density across the world. Its density determines what creatures inhabit an area, what technology functions there, and how dangerous it is for mortals and Deathless alike.

Fog Density

Clear: A Clear is a region mostly free of the Fog, though it may see occasional episodes of elevated density, almost like weather. Ambient magical energy is low and everything functions normally. Magitek devices that depend on elevated Fog to operate will not function in a Clear. Magicsense and other means of detecting magic work exceptionally well here, as the Fog does not provide magical "background radiation" to obscure individual auras. Clears are where most mortal settlements are found.

Light Fog: There is some constant ambient magical power, but settlement is still mostly safe. The Fog can occasionally become dense, at which point it may cause unpredictable magical effects or spawn monsters. This is the

condition across most of the world outside the Clears. Magicsense functions normally.

Dense Fog: The Fog is constantly roiling and produces magical effects. These areas are rife with monsters and supernatural phenomena. Visibility is reduced to short range at best, imposing heavy concealment beyond 5 squares. Only the Fogborn — humans mutated over generations of exposure, recognizable by their heterochromatic eyes (one always yellow) and various small deformities — can live here long-term without suffering ill health. Navigation is difficult; unshielded technological and magical navigation aids are subject to interference, and Eerie and Occultism checks take a -2d penalty due to the overwhelming ambient magic. The ambient magical power is so great that magitek devices equipped with the right harvesting technology can run without any external power source, drawing what they need from the environment. This includes magitek power plants, which is why the immortal orders frequently vie for control of such areas despite their dangers. Dense Fog can occasionally intensify to Extreme Fog for a time.

Green plants cannot survive in areas of permanent Dense Fog, as the light-blocking effects make photosynthesis impossible. In their place, thaumatosynthetic flora — strange growths that feed on ambient magical energy rather than sunlight — dominate the landscape. The terrain itself is often warped: implausible weather, supernatural geological formations, and other phenomena that defy natural law are common.

Extreme Fog: These regions are so saturated with magical power that entering them is hazardous without special warding spells and devices. Visibility is reduced to near zero — heavy concealment beyond 2 squares, and total concealment beyond 5 squares. Navigation without shielded instruments is virtually impossible, and even shielded devices are unreliable. Magitek devices and spells may become overloaded and malfunction. Only the most terrifying Mist Creatures roam these areas, and even the Deathless tread here only under duress.

Fog Exposure

Mortals and Deathless who spend prolonged periods in Dense or Extreme Fog without adequate protection suffer the effects of Fog exposure.

- **Dense Fog — mortals:** After 1 week of continuous exposure, a mortal must make an Endurance check (difficulty 6) each day or gain the Exhausted condition. After 1 month, the mortal becomes gravely ill (Diseased condition, difficulty 8 to treat).
- **Dense Fog — Deathless:** Deathless are more resilient but not immune. After 1 month of continuous exposure, a Deathless character takes a cumulative -1d penalty to all checks (maximum -3d). Healing and regeneration are halved. After prolonged exposure (3 months or more), the Deathless begins losing 1 EP per week. These penalties persist until the character spends at least 1 week outside Dense Fog.
- **Extreme Fog:** Effects accumulate as Dense Fog, but on a timescale of hours rather than weeks. Mortals must check against Exhaustion after 4 hours; Deathless begin accumulating penalties after 1 day.

Adequate protection — such as warding rituals, sealed magitek armor, or Fog-shielded vehicles — can delay or prevent these effects at the GM's discretion.

Mist Creatures

The Fog spontaneously generates creatures from raw magical energy. These Mist Creatures range from minor nuisances in Light Fog to apex predators in Extreme Fog — denser Fog draws on a greater reserve of energy and produces correspondingly more powerful beings. Mist Creatures are not part of the ordinary flow of souls; they do not reincarnate and behave in spiritually distinct ways from mortal life.

Some Mist Creatures can survive in Clears, though most cannot long endure the absence of the Fog that sustains them. As a result, Clears are largely free of supernatural monstrosities — one of the chief reasons mortals cluster there.

The Fogborn

Humans who live in the Fog through generations are slowly changed by it, becoming the Fogborn. They are recognizable by their heterochromatic eyes — one of which is always yellow — and by various small physical deformities. Like Mist Creatures, the Fogborn exist outside the ordinary cycle of souls and are spiritually distinct from other mortals.

The Fogborn are often looked down upon by the unmutated races, especially other mortals. The Deathless tend to treat them no differently from ordinary mortals, though some may be ideologically motivated to do otherwise. Fogborn cannot become Deathless and are not available as a player ancestry.

Weather

Weather is determined by the GM or rolled randomly at the start of each day. Roll 2D6 and consult the appropriate climate table.

Temperate Climate

TEMPERATE CLIMATE ROLLS

2D6	Weather
2	Storm — heavy rain/snow, strong winds. Visibility reduced to short range. -40% travel speed. Ranged attacks at -2d.
3–5	Precipitation — rain or light snow. Light concealment at long range.
6–8	Normal — clear or partly cloudy. No effects.
9–11	Overcast — cloudy, mild. No mechanical effects.
12	Fog — heavy concealment beyond 5 squares. -25% travel speed.

Mountain Climate

MOUNTAIN CLIMATE ROLLS

2D6	Weather
2–3	Storm — blizzard or thunderstorm. Travel in harsh terrain becomes impossible. -60% in other terrain.
4–6	Showers — intermittent rain or sleet.
7–8	Normal — clear, cold.
9–10	Fog — as temperate fog.
11–12	Strong wind — ranged attacks at -2d. Flight-based travel at -25%.

Tropical / Swamp Climate

TROPICAL CLIMATE ROLLS

2D6	Weather
2–3	Thunderstorm — as storm, plus lightning hazard (GM-adjudicated).
4–6	Sweltering heat — Endurance check (difficulty 3) per 4 hours of activity or gain Exhausted.
7–8	Normal — hot and humid. No mechanical effects.
9–12	Rain — light concealment at long range. Swamp terrain becomes harsh.

Vision, Light, and Senses

Light Levels

Bright light is the default in open daylight, well-lit interiors, or within the radius of a strong light source. No penalties apply.

Dim light includes twilight, candlelight, moonlight, or the edge of a light source's radius. Dim light provides light concealment (-2d to hit targets in dim light from bright light). Scrutiny checks at medium range or beyond take a -2d penalty.

Darkness is the absence of light — underground, sealed rooms, moonless nights. Darkness provides heavy concealment (-4d to hit). Creatures without darkvision or another sense capable of replacing sight are effectively Blinded.

Special Senses

Darkvision allows a creature to see in darkness as if it were dim light, out to a specified range (typically 20 squares). Darkvision is monochrome and cannot perceive color. It does not function in magical darkness.

Lifesense allows a creature to detect the presence and location of living creatures within a specified range. Lifesense penetrates walls and obstacles but is blocked by more than 1 meter of solid stone or metal, or by effects that mask a creature's vital signs. Lifesense does not detect undead, constructs, or other non-living entities.

Magicsense allows a creature to perceive active magical effects, enchanted objects, and creatures with an active magical aura within a specified range. This is the sense used by the Eerie skill. Magicsense can determine the approximate tier and school of a detected effect with a successful Eerie check.

Tremorsense allows a creature to detect the location of creatures and objects in contact with the same surface (ground, floor, wall) within a specified range. Tremorsense is defeated by flight, levitation, or very light movement (Infiltration check vs. the detecting creature's Awareness).

Blindsight allows a creature to perceive its surroundings without relying on sight, through echolocation, magical awareness, or other means. Blindsight functions in darkness and is not affected by concealment, but is defeated by total cover. Range is specified per creature.

Concealment

Concealment represents visual obstruction that makes a target harder to hit.

- **Light concealment:** -2d to attack rolls against the target. Caused by dim light, light rain, smoke, or partial visual obstruction.
- **Heavy concealment:** -4d to attack rolls against the target. Caused by darkness (for creatures without darkvision), heavy fog, or dense smoke.
- **Total concealment:** The target cannot be targeted by attacks that require line of sight.

Cover

Cover represents physical obstruction between an attacker and a target. When a creature behind cover is hit by an attack, they make a cover save (roll 3 dice) before the attack is resolved. If the save succeeds, the attack misses.

- **Light cover:** Save succeeds on 3 or more successes. Examples: low walls, thin pillars, sparse vegetation.
- **Normal cover:** Save succeeds on 2 or more successes. Examples: solid walls with firing slits, overturned tables, doorways.
- **Heavy cover:** Save succeeds on 1 or more successes. Examples: fortified positions, arrow slits, thick barricades.
- **Total cover:** The creature cannot be targeted directly while behind total cover. The creature must leave total cover to attack.

Types of Transportation

On foot is the default mode of travel. Characters on foot can navigate any terrain passable to a humanoid and carry their own equipment.

Mounted travel uses horses or other beasts of burden. Mounted characters double their base travel speed on roads and open terrain. Mounts can carry approximately 200–300 lbs depending on size and breed. Mounts require food and water and may panic in combat without training.

Ground vehicles include carts, motorized carriages, and armored transports. They offer higher capacity and speed on roads but are restricted to terrain the vehicle can physically traverse. Fuel-cell-powered vehicles require regular refueling.

Skimmers are magical or magitek hover vehicles that travel at high speed above the ground. They can cross most terrain types but are affected by severe weather and cannot operate in enclosed spaces. Skimmer speed varies by model (250–500 miles/day).

Airships are large flying vessels capable of long-distance travel above most hazards. See the *Airship Combat* section for rules regarding airship encounters.

Disease, Hunger, and Exhaustion

Disease

Diseases can be contracted from environmental hazards (swamps, contaminated water), from creatures (venomous bites, plague carriers), or from magical effects (the Diseased condition). A contracted disease follows this progression:

1. **Exposure:** The character is exposed to a disease source. They must make an Endurance check against the disease's difficulty or become Diseased.
2. **Diseased:** The character gains the Diseased condition. The specific effects are determined by the source (see *Status Conditions*). Unless otherwise specified, healing received by a Diseased creature is halved.
3. **Treatment:** Disease can be treated with an Alchemy check (difficulty = the disease's difficulty), the Antidote recipe (for toxin-based diseases), the Cleansing Light prayer, or other curative effects.

Hunger and Thirst

Deathless characters are more resilient than mortals but are not immune to deprivation. A character that goes without adequate food or water suffers the following effects:

- After 3 days without food: the character gains the Weakened condition.
- After 5 days without food: the character gains the Exhausted condition (stacks with Weakened).
- After 1 day without water in normal conditions (or 4 hours in extreme heat): the character gains the Exhausted condition.

These conditions persist until the character eats or drinks adequately.

Exhaustion

Exhaustion can result from forced marches, sleep deprivation, environmental exposure, or running out of resources. The Exhausted condition (-2d on all checks, half movement speed) persists until the character completes a rest.

Essence as a Survival Resource

Essence Points (EP) are the fundamental resource that limits Deathless characters over extended expeditions. EP is spent to fuel powers, revive from death, and recover during rests. Characters recover only 3 EP per day of rest, and scarce consumable items are the only way to accelerate this recovery.

Managing EP is the central survival challenge: a party that burns through EP in combat may lack the resources to revive fallen members or recover from injuries during travel.

Currency and Economy

Feathers (ƒ)

The universal unit of account in the world of Ashen is the **Feather** (ƒ) — literal metallic angel feathers that are occasionally found in the ruins of the old world. Their scarcity, durability, and the impossibility of forging counterfeits make them an ideal currency. Feathers are accepted everywhere, though remote settlements may prefer barter for everyday transactions.

Purchasing Power Guide

ITEM / SERVICE

Approximate Cost	Simple meal at a tavern
ƒ 2	Comfortable lodging (1 night)
ƒ 5	Fuel cell recharge (standard vehicle)
ƒ 20	Vehicle rental (1 day)
ƒ 50	Passage on a skimmer (short journey)
ƒ 100	Passage on an airship (long journey)
ƒ 500	Horse (trained riding horse)
ƒ 300	Mechanical repair (minor)
ƒ 30	Mechanical repair (major)
ƒ 200	Medical treatment (professional)
ƒ 50	Information (street level)
ƒ 10–50	Mercenary hire (1 day)
ƒ 100	Skilled artisan labor (1 day)
ƒ 30	

For equipment prices, see the *Equipment Tables* section.

Lodging and Resting

Short Rest

A short rest takes approximately 1 hour and requires a reasonably safe location. During a short rest, a character may spend EP to recover:

- **1 EP:** Recover HP equal to 25% of maximum HP.
- **1 EP:** Recover Focus equal to 50% of maximum Focus.

A character may spend multiple EP during a single short rest. This is the only way to spend EP for recovery outside of powers or items.

Long Rest

A long rest takes 8 hours (at least 6 hours of sleep and up to 2 hours of light activity such as keeping watch). At the end of a long rest:

- The character recovers all HP and Focus (this costs EP as with a short rest, but the full recovery is automatic).
- The character recovers 3 EP naturally.

Resting Conditions

Comfortable rest requires adequate shelter (inn, building, or camping kit in fair weather). A comfortable rest provides full short or long rest benefits.

Rough rest occurs without adequate shelter — sleeping on bare ground, in extreme weather without protection, or in a hostile environment. A rough rest provides only the benefits of a short rest, regardless of duration.

Blessed ground — certain locations saturated with ambient magical energy (leyline nexuses, ancient temples, sacred groves) provide additional benefits. When resting on blessed ground, a character recovers 1 additional EP. The GM determines which locations qualify.

Name	Pin	Stated Purpose	Aligned Deities
Black Guard	A fortress gate superimposed on a balance	Maintenance and policing of the Black Bazaar	???
Children of the Flame	An eternal flame	Maintaining and expanding the Clears	The Sun Life-Giver
Dragon Guard	A shield bearing the silhouette of a dragon's head	Restoring a world fit for dragons	Vrtra Dragon-Father
Dragon Slayers, Most Fraternal and Knightly Order of	A dragon impaled upon a spear	laying monsters and making the world safe for humans	The Crown Lawgiver
Heirs of the Night	A sword with bat wings	Make the world a paradise for creatures of the night	The Moon Who-Reflects-In-Blood
Keepers of the Door	Two keys crossed over a gate	Discovering and safeguarding secrets	Once-Was Way-Knower
Lantern, Order of the	A stylized lantern	Escaping the trap of Purgatory	The Watchman
Listeners, The	A dream-catcher with antlers	Restoring the boar-mother and the primal spirits	The Boar-Mother
Mortefactors, Most Ancient and Noble Order of	A crossed scythe and bird wing under a human skull	Studying the curse of the undying and helping those afflicted by it	The Ferryman
Never-Still, The	A hand holding a heart	Restoring the vitality of the faerie realm	The Lion-Head, Might-Be Queen of Summer
Patients, Vatic Order of	A hand with the index and middle finger extended, thumb, ring and pinky folded, and an eye in the middle of the palm	Cultivating the art of clairvoyance	The Glory Resplendent, Might-Be Fateweaver
Perfectors, The	A bridge build of gears	Fashioning an orderly, mechanical world	Third
Silent Crow, Brotherhood of the	The skull of a crow	Restoring the cycle of death and rebirth	The Queen of Silence
Waiting Fangs, The	A dagger piercing the skull of a snake	Self-defence	???
Witnesses of the End	An hourglass	Complete the ending of the world	She who waits Beyond
Free Agents	A sword crossed with a feather	--	–

Table 1: List of Factions

Death and Reincorporation

The rules for dying and reviving in the moment of combat are covered under *Death and Revival* in the Combat chapter. This section covers what happens to a Deathless character when spot-revival is not an option — when their EP is depleted, when they choose not to spend it, or when their body has been destroyed.

Soul Anchors

Every Deathless character has a **soul anchor** — a location their essence is bound to. A character can bind to a new soul anchor by resting there and performing a brief binding ritual (10 minutes, no check required). Each character can have only one active soul anchor at a time. By default, a character's soul anchor is the last settlement where they completed a long rest.

Reincorporation

If a Deathless character dies without reviving on the spot, their essence travels to their soul anchor and slowly reincorporates there. The process takes 3 to 7 days, during which the character recovers only 1 EP per day (instead of the usual 3). Once they have accumulated 5 EP, they reincorporate at the anchor with 1 HP and no Focus.

Effects That Prevent Revival

Certain powers and effects can delay or prevent revival entirely. A creature affected by an effect that "prevents revival" cannot spend EP to revive, and does not begin reincorporating until the effect ends. The *Noble Eightfold Blade* and *World Serpent's Embrace* are examples of such effects.

Airship Combat

Airship combat rules are in development and will be included in a future version of the rulebook. For the playtest, the GM may adjudicate airship encounters using the standard combat rules adapted to the scale of airship engagements.

Setting GM Guide

Designing Creatures

This section provides guidelines for creating enemy creatures for use in combat encounters. Creatures in Ashen use the same mechanical framework as player characters: they have attributes, characteristics, derived statistics, equipment (or natural equivalents), and powers.

Creature Stat Blocks

A creature stat block should include the following:

- **Hit Points (HP):** How much damage the creature can sustain.
- **Focus Points (FP):** The creature's reservoir for powers. Creatures that rely purely on physical attacks may have low or no FP.
- **Armor:** Physical damage reduction, whether from natural hide, worn armor, or construction.
- **Ward:** Magical damage reduction, from innate magical resistance or protective enchantments.
- **Evasion:** How difficult the creature is to hit. Derived the same way as for characters: half the creature's Dodge rating (rounded down), modified by armor or natural agility.
- **Action Points (AP):** Almost always 4, the same as player characters.
- **Movement Speed:** 2 + the creature's Speed rating, as for characters.
- **Main Attack Characteristic:** The dice pool the creature rolls for its primary attacks (Martial for melee combatants, Marksmanship for ranged, a casting characteristic for spellcasters).
- **Resistance Characteristics:** The creature's Stamina, Potential and Grit ratings, used to resist powers and effects.
- **Attacks and Powers:** The creature's available actions, including base weapon damage and any special powers.

Encounter Balance

A fight is balanced when the **action economy** is roughly equal on both sides. On a featureless battlefield where both sides can fully employ their abilities, a group of enemies equal in number to the player characters — each enemy being of the same tier as the party — constitutes a fair fight.

When the number of enemies differs from the number of players, the creatures must be adjusted:

- **Fewer enemies than players:** The creatures need higher HP, better defenses, and stronger powers to compensate for being outnumbered. A single "boss" creature facing a full party should have dramatically more HP and access to multi-target or area powers to offset the action economy disadvantage.
- **More enemies than players:** Each creature should be weaker than a same-tier PC — lower HP, simpler attack options, and fewer powers. Minion-type creatures may have only a single attack and minimal HP.

Stat Guidelines by Tier

The following table provides baseline statistics for a standard creature at each tier. These values represent a creature roughly equivalent to a player character of the same tier wearing medium-weight equipment.

CREATURE STAT GUIDELINES

Stat	T1	T2	T3	T4	T5	T6
HP	20–25	30–40	45–60	65–85	90–120	120–160
FP	13–18	20–30	30–45	45–65	65–90	90–130
Armor	5	8	10	13	17	22
Ward	4	5	8	10	13	17
Evasion	2–3	3–4	4–5	5–7	7–8	8–9
Main Attack	5–7	7–9	10–12	13–15	15–17	16–18
Primary Resistance	4–6	6–8	8–11	11–14	14–16	16–18
Damage (per hit)	7–10	10–14	14–18	18–23	22–29	27–35

Use the lower end of each range for more fragile or evasion-oriented creatures (rogues, casters, skirmishers) and the higher end for tougher brutes and tanks.

The Role of Powers in Creature Design

The relationship between armor values and base damage shifts dramatically across tiers, and this has major implications for how creatures should be designed.

Low Tiers (T1–T2): Restraint

At Tiers 1 and 2, base weapon damage comfortably exceeds typical armor values. A T1 creature dealing 8 damage against a target with 5 armor still lands 3 points per hit — meaningful against a 20 HP character. Basic attacks are effective, and most creatures at these tiers can function with simple attack options.

Powers must be used with caution. A 200% damage power at T1 deals 14–20 damage, which can drop a player character in a single hit. Creatures at these tiers should use high-damage powers sparingly, or telegraph them so players have a chance to react. Reserve 200% powers for tough or elite enemies, and avoid 300% entirely — it is almost always an instant kill.

Mid Tiers (T3–T4): Transition

At Tiers 3 and 4, armor begins to absorb a significant fraction of incoming damage. A T3 creature dealing 16 damage against 10 armor lands only 6 points — survivable, but slow to kill a 50 HP character through basic attacks alone. Creatures at these tiers need at least one or two 200% powers to threaten well-armored characters, and should begin to have access to effects that degrade defenses (Shred, Disrupt) or bypass them (penetration, damage types that target the weaker of armor or ward).

High Tiers (T5–T6): Necessity

At Tiers 5 and 6, armor and ward values approach or exceed base damage. A T5 creature dealing 25 damage against a target with 17 armor lands only 8 points per hit — a character with 100+ HP can shrug off basic attacks almost indefinitely. Without 200–300% powers, creatures at these tiers simply cannot threaten well-equipped player characters.

High-tier creatures *must* have a toolkit that includes some combination of:

- **High-percentage powers:** 200–300% damage to punch through defenses.
- **Defense degradation:** Shred and Disrupt effects to erode armor and ward over the course of a fight.
- **Armor bypass:** Penetration, effects that ignore armor entirely, or damage types that target the weaker defensive stat.
- **Multi-hit attacks:** Multiple smaller hits apply armor separately per hit, but can overwhelm through volume — and each hit can carry riders (conditions, ongoing damage).
- **Qualitative effects:** Conditions like Exposed, Vulnerable, or Staggered that strip defensive layers and set up devastating follow-up attacks.

This mirrors the design of player-facing powers at these tiers: the tier guidelines note that T5–T6 power comes from qualitative shifts, not raw damage multipliers.

Creature Roles

When designing encounters with multiple creatures, it helps to assign each creature a combat role. The stat guidelines above represent a balanced baseline; roles shift the emphasis:

- **Brute:** High damage and HP, low Evasion and Ward. Relies on raw physical power to overwhelm opponents. Armor near baseline, few or no magical abilities. Simple but dangerous.
- **Knight:** High HP, Armor and Ward, lower damage. A defensive frontliner that holds ground and protects other creatures. May have abilities that punish enemies for ignoring it (opportunity attacks, auras, taunt effects).
- **Skirmisher:** High Evasion and Movement Speed, lower HP. Hits and runs, uses positioning to avoid retaliation. May have abilities that trigger on movement.
- **Artillery:** High damage at range, low HP and Evasion. Dangerous if left alone, fragile if engaged in melee. Needs other creatures to screen for it.
- **Controller:** Moderate stats across the board, but access to area powers and conditions. Shapes the battlefield rather than dealing raw damage.
- **Caster:** High FP and casting characteristics, lower physical stats. Uses spells or powers as primary offense. Ward above baseline, Armor below.
- **Elite:** A creature designed to face multiple PCs. Higher HP (1.5–2x baseline), access to more powers, and possibly extra AP or reactions.
- **Minion:** A creature designed to be fielded in numbers greater than the party. Minimal HP (half baseline or less), one basic attack, no powers. Compensates with action economy.

Boss Creatures

A true boss is a creature designed to face an entire party alone or with only a handful of minions at its side. Bosses are fundamentally different from standard creatures: they must combine multiple roles — dealing damage, absorbing punishment, and disrupting the party's plans — all in a single stat block. A boss that can only do one of these things will be quickly neutralized by a coordinated party.

Stat Adjustments

A boss should have significantly above-baseline statistics. As a starting point:

- **HP:** 2–3x the baseline for its tier. A boss that dies too quickly is anticlimactic; err on the side of durability.
- **Defenses:** Armor, Ward and Evasion should all be at or above baseline. Bosses cannot afford a glaring defensive weakness that the party can exploit to trivialize the encounter.
- **Resistance Characteristics:** Above baseline across the board. A boss that can be reliably stunned or dominated in the first round is not a boss for long.
- **Attacks and Powers:** A boss needs a diverse toolkit. It should have at least one high-damage single-target attack, one area or multi-target power, and one disruptive ability (a condition, a forced movement effect, or something that changes the battlefield). At high tiers, defense-degrading effects (Shred, Disrupt) are essential to prevent the fight from stalling.

Action Economy

The most critical challenge in boss design is the action economy. A single creature with 4 AP facing a party of four characters with 4 AP each is outnumbered four-to-one in available actions. Without compensation, the boss will be locked down by conditions and destroyed before it can act meaningfully.

At low tiers (T1–T2), simply increasing the boss's AP to **5–6** can be sufficient. The party's powers are limited in scope, and the extra actions let the boss attack, move, and use an ability each turn without feeling overwhelming.

At higher tiers, raw AP increases are not enough — the party has access to powerful conditions and combination attacks that demand the boss be able to act outside its own turn. Two mechanisms address this:

Legendary Action

Once per round, after another creature's turn ends, this creature may take a single action costing up to 2 AP.

This gives the boss one extra action per round at a time of the GM's choosing. It is appropriate for mid-tier bosses (T3–T4) and for high-tier bosses that are accompanied by a few supporting creatures.

Greater Legendary Action

Whenever another creature completes its turn, this creature may take a single action costing up to 2 AP.

This gives the boss an action after *every* other creature's turn — potentially 4 or more extra actions per round against a full party. This is appropriate for the most powerful high-tier bosses (T5–T6) that are meant to face a full party alone. Greater Legendary Actions make a creature extremely dangerous and should be paired with careful HP tuning to avoid fights that drag on too long.

Design Considerations

- **Condition immunity:** Bosses should be immune to at least Dominated, and may be immune to Stunned as well. Being fully locked out of actions for even one round can be catastrophic for a solo creature. Consider granting resistance (automatic saves at the start of the boss's turn) to other disabling

conditions rather than full immunity, so that the party's control abilities still feel impactful.

- **Phased encounters:** A boss with 3x baseline HP can feel like a slog. Consider breaking the fight into phases — at certain HP thresholds, the boss changes behavior, gains new powers, or the environment shifts. This keeps the encounter dynamic and gives the party a sense of progress.
- **Minion support:** Even a boss designed for solo play benefits from 2–3 minions. Minions occupy the party's attention, provide targets for area powers (making the players choose between hitting the boss and clearing adds), and help the boss's action economy without requiring Greater Legendary Actions.

Awarding Legendary Rewards

Legendary items, powers, and advances (see *Legendary* in the Basic Rules chapter) are among the most significant rewards a GM can offer. Because they are quest-bound and extraordinary by definition, they require more thought than standard loot or level-up choices.

When to Award Legendary Rewards

Legendary rewards should mark turning points in the campaign — moments that change who a character is or what they can do. Good occasions include:

- **Completing a major story arc:** Defeating a campaign-defining threat, fulfilling a prophecy, or resolving a mystery that has driven the plot for multiple sessions.
- **Character milestones:** A character confronting their past, unlocking a latent ability tied to their origin, or earning the trust of a powerful patron.
- **Discovering something ancient:** Entering a ruin no one has breached in centuries, recovering a weapon from a fallen hero, or making contact with a forgotten power.

The pacing of legendary rewards should follow the arc of the campaign:

- **Tiers 1–2:** Legendary rewards should not feature at all. Characters at these tiers are still finding their footing, and the extraordinary nature of legendary rewards has no baseline to contrast against. Let the players discover what "normal" looks like before breaking the rules.
- **Tiers 3–4:** Legendary rewards should be very rare — at most one per character across both tiers, and many characters may receive none. At these tiers, legendary weapons and armor do not yet exist; the most powerful generic equipment reaches tier 4 without requiring masterwork or legendary status. Any legendary rewards at these tiers should be limited to advances, powers, or artifacts that do not directly affect a character's combat statistics — a prophetic vision, a pact with a powerful entity, or a strange relic whose purpose is not yet clear.
- **Tiers 5–6:** Legendary rewards become more frequent as the campaign reaches its climax. This is where legendary weapons and armor enter play (legendary items exist only at tiers 5 and 6), and where legendary powers and advances can represent the culmination of a character's arc. A character might receive two or even three legendary rewards across these tiers.

Legendary Items

A legendary item should feel like it has a history. Give it a name, a backstory, and at least one trait that makes it behave differently from anything the players could buy or craft. The item's legendary trait (which does not count against its enchantment slots) is the hook: it should do something no ordinary enchantment can replicate.

When placing a legendary item in the world, consider:

- **Foreshadowing:** Mention the item before the players find it — in lore, in an NPC's story, or as a rumour. The discovery is more satisfying when the players recognise what they've found.
- **Cost of acquisition:** The quest to obtain it is part of the reward. A legendary weapon found in a chest with no effort feels less legendary than one pried from the hands of a dying guardian.
- **Enchantment slots:** A legendary item found early in its story may have empty enchantment slots. Letting a player fill those slots over time — finding the right enchantments, seeking out the right artisans — extends the reward across multiple sessions.

Legendary Powers and Advances

Unlike items, legendary powers and advances are intrinsic to a character. They represent something the character *becomes*, not something they *have*. This makes them deeply personal rewards, and they work best when tied to a character's arc.

Some principles:

- **Tie it to the character's story:** A legendary power is most compelling when it grows out of something the character has struggled with or worked toward. A psychic who has been haunted by visions of a past life might unlock a legendary Time power when they finally confront that memory.
- **Rarity, not uniqueness:** Legendary powers and advances need not be strictly one-of-a-kind. A small group of beings might share a legendary trait — the six constructs built by a goddess, the last three knights of a fallen order. What matters is that it cannot be learned from a book or purchased with experience points.
- **Mechanical restraint:** A legendary power should be strong, but its strength should come from doing something *different* rather than simply doing more damage. A power that ignores a fundamental rule (bypasses resistance, acts outside the normal turn order, affects a type of target that is normally immune) is more interesting than one that deals 400% damage.

Designing Equipment

This section provides guidelines for designing new weapons, armor, catalysts, and other gear, as well as for balancing existing equipment across tiers.

Weapon Damage by Tier

Table 2 gives canonical damage values by tier, weight class, and variance. Variance describes the shape of the damage distribution: **LV** (low variance) has a high floor and a low ceiling, suited to reliable and precise weapons; **MV** (medium variance) is the standard for most weapons; **HV** (high variance) has a low floor and a high ceiling, suited to brutal or unpredictable weapons.

This leads to the following average damage by tier (MV):

Tier	Light LV	Light MV	Light HV	Medium LV	Medium MV	Medium HV	Heavy LV	Heavy MV	Heavy HV
0	4+D3	3+D4	2+D6	5+D3	4+D4	3+D6	6+D3	4+D6	3+D8
1	6+D3	4+D6	3+D8	8+D3	6+D6	5+D8	11+D3	8+D8	6+D12
2	7+D4	6+D6	4+D10	11+D4	9+D8	7+D12	15+D4	12+D10	9+2D8
3	11+D4	9+D8	7+D12	15+D6	12+D10	9+2D8	20+D6	16+D12	12+2D10
4	14+D6	12+D10	8+2D8	19+D8	16+D12	12+2D10	25+D8	20+2D8	15+2D12
5	17+D8	14+D12	11+2D10	23+D10	20+2D8	15+2D12	30+D10	24+2D10	18+3D10
6	21+D10	18+2D8	14+2D12	27+2D8	24+2D10	18+3D10	35+2D6	29+2D12	22+4D10

Table 2: Weapon Damage by Tier

Tier	Light Armor	Light Ward	Light Bulk	Med Armor	Med Ward	Med Bulk	Heavy Armor	Heavy Ward	Heavy Bulk
0	2	2	1	3	2	2	6	4	3
1	3	3	1	5	4	2	8	6	4
2	5	4	1	8	5	3	11	8	4
3	8	5	2	10	7	3	15	10	5
4	12	9	2	19	12	3	25	20	5
5	11	8	2	15	10	4	24	16	6
6	14	11	2	19	13	4	30	20	7

Table 3: Armor Scaling

DAMAGE AVERAGES

Tier	Light	Medium	Heavy
0	5.5	6.5	7.5
1	7.5	9.5	12.5
2	9.5	13.5	17.5
3	13.5	18.0	23.0
4	17.5	22.8	28.8
5	21.2	28.5	35.0
6	26.8	35.2	41.5

The die progression used across the table is D3, D4, D6, D8, D10, D12, 2D8, 2D10, 3D8, 3D10, 3D12, 4D10, 4D12, with average values of 1.5, 2.5, 3.5, 4.5, 5.5, 6.5, 9, 11, 13.5, 16.5, 19.5, 22, 26 respectively.

Ranged Weapons

Ranged weapons follow the same damage table as melee for their weight class, with a few adjustments:

- **Single-shot weapons** deal damage at tier+1 (e.g., a T2 single-shot rifle uses T3 damage values). This compensates for the inability to make multiple attacks per round.
- Weapons with very long range may have slightly lower damage.
- Weapons with area effects (cone, blast) may have lower per-target damage.
- **Anti-vehicle weapons** (e.g., rocket launchers) are a separate category — they can only target size 3+ creatures and have extreme damage values outside the normal scaling.

Special Weapon Patterns

- **Split damage weapons** (e.g., Hoarfrost): the listed damage is dealt twice — once reduced by Armor, once by Ward. The effective total is 2× the listed damage, but both defenses apply. These weapons appear weaker on paper but perform strongly against balanced targets.
- **High-penetration weapons**: may have lower base damage as a tradeoff. Penetration bypasses Armor directly, so low damage + high Pen can outperform high damage + no Pen against armored targets.
- **Silvered or special-material weapons**: may trade damage for keywords or penetration that bypass specific resistances.

Armor Scaling by Tier

Table 3 gives the average values stats for armor by weight class and tier. Modifiers follow the armor's weight class: light armor grants +1 to +2 Evasion, medium armor grants 0 to +1, and heavy armor imposes –1 to –4. Higher-tier armor within a weight class may improve evasion slightly compared to lower-tier examples.

Charge (Magical Encumbrance)

Charge is the magical equivalent of Bulk. A character has both a Bulk capacity (derived from Strength and Endurance) and a Charge capacity (derived from

Tier	Diff.	Magn.	Cost (ƒ)	Casting Time	Scope	Identity
1	3–4	2–3	50–200	5–10 min	Single target	Local effect
2	5–6	4–5	200–500	10–30 min	Small area	Moderate duration
3	7–8	6–7	500–1500	30 min–1 hr	Large area	Lasting effect
4	9–10	8–9	1500–4000	1–4 hours	Transformation	Permanent minor effects
5	11–12	10–12	4000–10000	4–12 hours	Reality-altering	Permanent major effects
6	13+	13+	Priceless	1+ days	Legendary	Campaign-defining

Table 4: Ritual Tier Scaling

Attunement). When designing items, assign Charge according to their magical intensity:

- **Non-magical items** (mundane weapons, basic armor): Charge 0.
- **Lightly magical items** (enchanted weapons, warded armor): Charge roughly half Bulk.
- **Heavily magical items** (catalysts, reliquaries, magical robes): Charge equal to or greater than Bulk. Such items may have Bulk 0 but high Charge.

The underlying design principle is that physical warriors invest in Bulk capacity, casters invest in Charge capacity, and hybrid builds need both. Equipment should reinforce that tradeoff rather than paper over it.

Price Scaling by Tier

Approximate price ranges in feathers (ƒ):

PRICE SCALING

Tier	Weapons	Armor	Catalysts	Consumables
0	0–50	0–50	–	10–50
1	100–500	100–500	200–600	50–250
2	500–1500	500–1500	600–1500	150–500
3	1500–3500	1500–3000	1500–3000	300–1000
4	5000–8000	5000–6500	3000–6000	500–2000
5	8000–15000	8000–12000	6000–10000	1000–5000
6	Unique	Unique	Unique	2000–10000

At T6, standard weapons, armor, and catalysts leave the commercial market entirely — such items are unique or priceless, obtained through quests or legendary rewards rather than purchased.

Weapon Keywords

The following keywords appear on weapons throughout the rulebook. When designing a new weapon, prefer an existing keyword over a bespoke rule unless the mechanical effect is genuinely new.

- **Heavy:** Must be braced before firing. Firing without bracing is hip-firing, which imposes a penalty.
- **Rapid Fire:** +2 automatic successes when the target is within half the weapon's range.
- **Assault:** Hip-fire penalty halved (–1 instead of –2 for single shots; –2 instead of –4 for auto).
- **Sidearm:** Draw or stow as a free action once per turn. Can be drawn even when a hand is occupied by a two-handed weapon.
- **Burning:** Target catches fire on hit, taking ongoing Thermal damage (save ends).
- **Explosive:** Deals damage in a blast radius.
- **Jet:** Propelled projectile.
- **Overload:** Carries a risk of overheating or malfunctioning.
- **Poisonous (N):** Target must pass a D(N) Stamina check or become Poisoned.
- **Parry +Nd:** Adds +N dice to parry checks made with the weapon.
- **Powered:** Requires a power source or charge.
- **Reliable:** Reduced malfunction chance.

Designing Rituals and Recipes

This section provides guidelines for designing new rituals and alchemical recipes. Rituals and recipes occupy a different design space from combat powers: they are slow, expensive, and often transformative, and their balance is driven by cost and narrative stakes rather than by the action economy.

Tier Scaling

Each point of power available to the ritual beyond its magnitude reduces the difficulty by 1, to a floor equal to the ritual's tier. This lets well-prepared casters perform rituals above their comfortable skill level, at the cost of accumulating reagents, influence, or assistants.

Sacrifice Types

A ritual's sacrifice is the resource it consumes. The appropriate type depends on tier and on the nature of the effect.

- **Components** (T1–T4): money and materials. A standard cost with no lasting impact beyond the price. Components are consumed whether or not the ritual succeeds.
- **Essence** (T3–T5): the caster takes strain or a long-lasting debuff. Used for rituals that channel dangerous forces. The debuff persists for days or weeks, representing a physical or spiritual cost paid by the caster personally.
- **Influence** (T4–T6): requires a concentration of specific aspects, either in the environment or in sacrificed objects. A ritual requiring Mist influence of magnitude 5, for example, must be cast in a strongly magical environment (a leyline, an ancient temple) or the caster must sacrifice a magical object

that provides that level of aspect resonance. Influence is consumed: the environmental attunement fades, or the object is destroyed.

Aspect Requirements

Not every ritual demands aspect resonance, and lower-tier rituals should avoid it entirely so that they remain accessible to anyone with the skill and materials.

- **T1–T3:** no aspect requirements.
- **T4:** may require one aspect as Influence. Without the required aspect, difficulty increases by +2.
- **T5–T6:** require one or two specific aspects as Influence, provided by environment or sacrificed objects.

The aspects are Ash (destruction, desolation), Crown (law, domination), Forge (crafting, heat, origin), Key (opening, summoning), Mist (magic, the sublime essence), Scarab (rebirth, cycles), Skull (death, the end of things), Moon (mind, matter), and Maiden (nature).

Skills

Three skills cover all rituals and recipes, and they are not interchangeable:

- **Ritual** governs arcane magic and the structured traditions of Psychic practice. It is systematic and reproducible; a failed check wastes materials but carries predictable consequences.
- **Occultism** governs divine magic and the esoteric Psychic domains (Fate, Void). It relies on communion with entities rather than formula, and failed checks may have unpredictable or dangerous consequences.
- **Alchemy** covers every recipe — potions, poisons, reagents, and explosives. Ritual and Occultism do not apply to alchemical work.

Design Checklist

When designing a new ritual or recipe, verify each of the following before placing it in play:

1. Difficulty and magnitude fall within the tier's band.
2. Sacrifice type is appropriate to the power level.
3. Casting time is proportional to the effect.
4. Effect description is clear and has measurable outcomes.
5. Failure consequence is defined (or the ritual uses the standard "components lost" failure).
6. Skill is specified (Ritual, Occultism, or Alchemy).
7. Aspects are required only at T4 or higher.
8. Difficulty modifiers are listed for rituals with variable scope.
9. The ritual fills a narrative or mechanical niche not already covered by a combat power.

Universal Reagents

Alchemical reagents are the raw material of most recipes. Readily obtainable universal reagents cap at magnitude 6, corresponding to T3. The **Philosopher's Reagent** recipe (T5, Alchemy) produces magnitude-8 reagents, and anything beyond that is unique or legendary and must be found or quested for. This cap is a hard balance lever: it prevents high-tier recipes from becoming routine, and gives the GM a natural hook for high-tier alchemy plots.